



Dr. S. MUTHULEKSHMI, Dr. K. DEEPA

HALLMARKS OF BRANDING

CHIEF EDITORS

Dr. S. MUTHULEKSHMI

M.Com., M.Phil., MBA., Ph.D., DAT., ADIT

Assistant Professor in Commerce

Department of Commerce

KUMARAGURU COLLEGE OF LIBERAL ARTS AND SCIENCE

COIMBATORE

Dr. K. DEEPA

M. Com., M.Phil., SET., Ph. D

Assistant Professor of Commerce

KUMARAGURU COLLEGE OF LIBERAL ARTS AND SCIENCE

COIMBATORE

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EDITOR'S MESSAGE

Branding has become the cornerstone of business success in today's competitive marketplace. A brand is not just a name or a logo; it is a powerful identity that defines an organization's vision, values, and promise to consumers. In an era where consumers are more informed and selective, businesses must craft unique and compelling brand strategies to build trust, loyalty, and recognition.

This edited volume, *Hallmarks of Branding*, brings together insightful research and perspectives from scholars and industry experts on various dimensions of branding. From brand identity and positioning to consumer perception and brand equity, this book explores the fundamental elements that shape successful brands. The articles in this volume provide valuable insights for academicians, marketers, entrepreneurs, and policymakers who seek to understand and navigate the ever-evolving world of branding.

It is indeed a privilege to present this collection of scholarly contributions that enrich the discourse on branding. We are confident that this book will serve as a valuable resource for those who wish to delve deeper into the art and science of building strong brands.

Dr. S. Muthulekshmi & Dr. K. Deepa

CONTENT

S.NO	TITLE	PAGE NO
1	YOUNGSTERS FASCINATE TOWARDS LOUIS VUITTON IN THE EMERGING FASHION WORLD.- Dr. L. A. Razia Fathima, Sneka. M, Suvetha. R.	1-10
2	INVESTIGATING CONSUMER PREFERENCE TOWARDS ADIDAS FOOTWEAR IN SOUTH COIMBATORE.-Dr. T. Usha Rani, Bhuvaneshwari. P., Arockiya Aishwarya. B.	11-22
3	A STUDY ON CONSUMER SATISFACTION TOWARDS RAYMOND BRANDS IN COIMBATORE CITY. Dr. S. Muthulekshmi, Swathi. L.	23-33
4	EXPLORING CONSUMER PREFERENCES FOR TITAN WATCHES: A COMPREHENSIVE STUDY.- Dr. L. A. Razia Fathima, Kabila. S, Inu Shree. S.	34-42
5	UNVEILING THE BRAND REVOLUTION WITH AUGMENTED REALITY EXPERIENCES.- Dr. N. Sumathy, Asha. S, Muskan Chandak	43-53
6	CUSTOMER SATISFACTION AS A KEY DRIVER OF SREE ANNAPOORNA GOWRISHANKAR'S SUCCESS IN THE COMPETITIVE HOTEL INDUSTRY. - Dr. N. Sridevi, Aishwarya. G	54- 68
7	ELECTRIC CARS: AN ANALYSIS OF TATA MOTORS AND THEIR STRATEGIC APPROACH TO PROMOTE E-CARS. - Dr. N. Manicka Mahesh, Praneeta. R, Niveetha. V	69- 78
8	A STUDY ON THE FACTORS INFLUENCING CUSTOMER PREFERENCES TOWARDS H&M BRAND IN COIMBATORE CITY. - Dr. N. Sumathy, Jayashree. S, Swathi. L.	79- 87
9	STRATEGIC APPROACHES AND CONSUMER PERCEPTIONS IN RELATION TO BRAND MILTON: A STUDY ON MARKETING STRATEGIES, BRAND POSITIONING, AND CONSUMER BEHAVIOR. - Dr. K. Deepa, Nivetha S, Pavithra Manoharan.	88- 97
10	EXPLORING SUSTAINABLE INNOVATIONS: APPLICATIONS OF COCONUT SHELL IN PRODUCT DEVELOPMENT - Dr. N. Sridevi, Netthra P S, Pratosh K	98- 110

11	A COMPARATIVE STUDY ON FILPKART AND SHOPSY IN INDIA. - Dr. Reshmi A Rajan , AnishhFathimaa A, Amirrdhavarsa P. M.	111- 119
12	A STUDY ON BRAND POSITIONING AND CONSUMER PERCEPTION TOWARDS MAMAEARTH PRODUCTS.- Dr. S. Muthulekshmi, Sniktha.S, Shamiksha.S.T.	120- 128
13	BRAND VOICE AND PERSONALITY IN THE CONTEMPORARY WORLD.- Dr. Reshmi A RajanVibeesshini. D,	129- 134
14	EXPLORING THE SUSTAINABLE AND VIABILITY OF ARECA PLATES AS AN ECO-FRIENDLY ALTERNATIVE TO DISPOSABLE TABLEWARE. - Dr. K. Deepa, Praanesh. R, Ashwin. C. P	135- 146
15	A STUDY ON AN EXAMINATION OF HOW MAGGI REPOSITIONED ITSELF AFTER THE BAN - Dr. T. Usha Rani, Jaganath G, Midunarakavi S	147- 154
16	THE IMPACT OF BRAND CONSISTENCY ACROSS PHYSICAL AND DIGITAL CUSTOMER TOUCHPOINTS -Dr. N. Manicka Mahesh, Santhosh MM, Lokshika S.	155 - 165

**YOUNGSTERS FASCINATE TOWARDS LOUIS VUITTON IN THE EMERGING FASHION
WORLD**

Dr. L.A. Razia Fathima, Assistant Professor, School of Commerce, Kumaraguru College of Liberal Arts and Science, Coimbatore

Ms. Sneha M, B. Com PA, School of Commerce, Kumaraguru College of Liberal Arts and Science, Coimbatore

Ms. Suvetha R, B. Com PA, School of Commerce, Kumaraguru College of Liberal Arts and Science, Coimbatore

ABSTRACT

Louis Vuitton is the most popular brand in the world. It has a huge brand image around the world. To be more precise youngsters are mostly attracted towards the product. In this research article, the summary of Louis Vuitton is discussed more clearly and the marketing strategies of the company are also discussed. Young generation people are eager to know about the products and also they are very much interested in the brand. We have analysed all these things in the survey and the analysis of the survey also describes the same. The advertising campaign of the company is also done in a luxurious way that is it advertises its products with the top celebrities in the world. The reason behind this chase is the brand image that it possesses in the fashion industry.

Keywords: Louis Vuitton, youngsters, brand, fashion etc.,

INTRODUCTION

Louis Vuitton is one of the French primarily based international LEADING FASHION HOUSES. It manufactures numerous merchandises like purses, accessories, shoes, watches, and jewellery. Louis Vuitton is ready in fifty countries with over 460 stores worldwide. This analysis concerns the distinctive options of the merchant also the market methods used by Louis Vuitton to market this product. This company was based in the year 1854 in Paris by Louis Vuitton in baggage and animal skin merchandise search. Later it became one of the highest and most extremely complete within the city. The mission statement of Louis Vuitton is to 'represent the foremost refined qualities of western "art Diamond State Vivre" which implies the art of living around the world.

Today this complete has not solely restricted to its style however additionally it's concerned with the production of numerous merchandises in fashion, accessories, shoes, bags, jewellery, watches, media, wine, and different areas of the large trend indicators. The rationale behind this successful luxury complete is that it's the 55-fashion show. This leading garment industry has been in a very smart position with a purported name and it's a proud home luxury complete go into its own distinctive brand deoxyribonucleic acid. As this is a high most luxury complete its stand distinctive in each side. To be a lot specific its target customers – Louis Vuitton has separated its customers into 2 segments i.e. flush middle-aged girls from

thirty-five to fifty-four years recent and upmarket young modern feminine adults aged from eighteen to thirty-four who have income and square measure complete aspirants. This text showcases the methods employed in their company and their distinctive disapproval methods. The individuality of this complete is the final camp-made quality of its merchandise. If we glance at the complete temperament of Louis Vuitton it is very comfortable and classy, modern, and stylish that attracts the young fashionable individuals within the rising fashion world.

A robust complete identity should capture its excellence as well as its distinctive temperament, aura, and angle so that suits its measurements ally themselves with a specific cause or outlook. This specific complete identity is captured by Louis Vuitton with no doubt. This specific complete doesn't do any selling strategy they solely produce merchandise that square measure exceptional in their style and acquisition. Each and every great precedence of Louis Vuitton is severally camp made with utmost care.

OBJECTIVE

- ❖ To explore the distinctive options in Louis Vuitton merchandise.
- ❖ To understand the market methods used by Louis Vuitton to promote its Products.

As we are all aware about the luxurious brand Louis Vuitton, have we ever thought of how it's marketed throughout the world? Though it's a luxury brand it has its own features and set of principles which are followed by the corporate itself. The market success behind LV is its unique principles. We are all attentive to the 4ps of the market i.e. Product, Price, Promotion, and Place.

This LV has laid down separate principles for every Ps of the market. To be clearer it's nearly 10 plus principles for the merchandise, 5 plus principles for a price likewise for others also. Those principles are unique, and it talks about the world within which the corporate should follow the principles. And also, it's laid down separate principles which have done perfectly that's why the merchandise Louis Vuitton is successful within the market.

SWOT ANALYSIS

STRENGTH

Strengths are defined as what each business does best in its gamut of operations which may provide it a favourable position over its competitors. The subsequent are the strengths of Louis Vuitton:

- **Strong association with quality:** Within the luxury segment customers are always fussy about the standard of products that they use and are willing to pay a premium for it. Louis Vuitton products have always been the benchmark in quality and style for luggage. The strong association with quality is LV's biggest strength.
- **Brand Recognition:** The Louis Vuitton monogram is high in recognition and thus people favour carrying LV monogrammed luggage since it's related to status and sophistication in society.

- **Top celebrity endorsements:** Louis Vuitton has always been powered by the largest names in the show biz who endorsed the brand and carried it during public appearances. A number of their top endorsers include Scarlett Johansson, Uma Thurman, Angelina Jolie, and Muhammad Ali.
- **Wide network:** Louis Vuitton has around 1, 21,289 employees globally making it one of the top employers in companies coping with luxury goods. The corporate sells its products through its owners of stores, high-end retail chains, and its websites the brand is sold in additional than 50 countries across 460 outlets.
- **Exclusive Merchandise:** Louis Vuitton Vuitton's of his or her personalized luggage options which are monogrammed to point to their label. Their exclusive brands will guarantee that your luggage stands except the gang and isn't carried by anyone else.
- **Top Designers:** the look team at Louis Vuitton comprises top designers around the world.

WEAKNESS

Weaknesses are accustomed sit down with areas where the business or the brand needs improvement. A number of the key weaknesses of Louis Vuitton are:

- **Excessive centralization:** Louis Vuitton is understood to be a troublesome employer and their specialization in exclusivity makes their patent or copyright most of their designs and they depend on centralized decisions which bring down their market.
- **Lack of sensitivity to foreign cultures:** Louis Vuitton is French in styling and style and also the brand is far closer to accepting other designs and is additionally not sensitive to trends in foreign countries.
- **Over-Reliance on Japanese Market:** Japan is one of Louis Vuitton's biggest markets and quite 85 a hundred percent of Japanese women own an LV product. This has reduced the flexibility of the corporate to seem at other markets.
- **Exorbitant Pricing:** Louis Vuitton may be a luxury brand and a basic offering from the corporate costs about 1500 USD. This makes it impossible for the masses to buy an LV bag or suitcase and thus the corporate targets a distinct segment market.

OPPORTUNITIES

Opportunities visit those avenues within the environment that surrounds the business on which it can capitalize to extend its returns. A number of the opportunities include:

- **Growing market potential:** the world marketplace for luxury goods is estimated at around 42 billion dollars with a rate of growth of 4 percent each year. This might be a large opportunity for luxury merchandise companies.
- **Increase in the number of working women:** the necessity for status symbols is growing in the workplace as more women enter there. This creates a major opportunity for Louis Vuitton in its prime segment which is formal luggage options.

- **Rise in per capita income:** Most countries across the planet have seen a major increase in per capita income with the result that income is indicating a pointy increase moreover. This is often expected to form a surge in demand for non-essential items and luxury goods.

THREATS

Threats are those factors within the environment that may be detrimental to the expansion of the business.

- **Counterfeiting:** the largest threat that luxury goods face today is that of counterfeit products within the market. The presence of counterfeits not just gives the brand a negative image but also dilutes the market share
- **Managing multinational customization:** The success of Louis Vuitton in their ability to form exclusive merchandise and this suggests that they might also customize for individual cultures. Their team which mostly comprises Europe designers will find this a large challenge.

REVIEW OF LITERATURE

To understand consumer behaviour towards luxury brands, especially Louis Vuitton: This research made close descriptive research on Louis Vuitton which is shortly termed as LV. This LV could be a leading fashion house around the world. This research mainly focused on the competitors of LV its strength, weaknesses, threats, and opportunities across the globe. The data gained through this research are accustomed understand how Louis Vuitton can expand its market in India by overcoming the challenges faced there. To find the challenges faced by them, this research used primary and secondary data to know consumer preferences. The first data were collected through an off-the-cuff interview with company executives and a questionnaire for patrons. The secondary data collected were utilized to collect qualitative data-related topics. The info was collected with the help of a questionnaire to judge the knowledge of the consumers of the brand. After the completion of the research, they concluded that in India LV has to provide more variety and customer satisfaction services so the shoppers get the identical experience that they get abroad.

Anastazja Magdalena Kasztalska (2018), in his study entitled Louis Vuitton As An Example Of The Old And Modern In The Same Time Luxury Brand In The Eyes Of Its Clientele states that this research focused on the fashionable and proportional font of LV whether it's changed or not how it's attracting its consumers. Louis Vuitton could be a brand that has existed for an awfully and it's the right example to visualize and develop itself per the wants of contemporary consumers. The findings of this text show that when a brand changes but saves its main features that comes from its history it can gain more income. Louis Vuitton can generate income through the collaboration with young artists who lead the corporate to success within the market of luxury fashion. The aim of this research is that the of this Vuitton Brand use identical methods since years per years and that they work well perfectly by increasing the income of the brand. Luxury brands need to change and develop to become modern brands. Louis Vuitton belongs to

such a quiet brand the corporate is ready to use its potential to develop its position in the market which results in long and turbulent history. Louis Vuitton is additionally ready to use successfully the method of manual production of its products that has been developed for hundreds of years. Most significantly, Louis Vuitton cooperates with young, very talented designers who give modernity to the classic products of the brand. The corporate actively cooperates with celebrities from around the world who are successful and powerful within the world of music and film and who are icons for several children as this brand gains new loyal consumers. A luxury brand shouldn't only exist, it must still change and redefine well-known concepts while respecting its history and therefore the way of creating its products. There are only a few luxury brands within the world which their past and history with the longer term, new trends, and growing expectations of their clients.

Yanzi Li & Sarah Mousseaux (2013), in their study entitled “Luxury Fashion Brands On Social media: A Study Of Young Consumers’ Perception” states that the execution of this examination expands the consciousness of the worth of extravagance style brands in using web-based entertainment as a correspondence channel to arrive at youthful purchasers all around the world. It gives a general comprehension of youthful purchasers' view of extravagance design brands via online entertainment concerning the geographic social foundation, disposition towards new extravagance, and favoured method of contact. Both various decision questions and open inquiries showed up in the review meaning to investigate youthful buyers' viewpoints on extravagance brands with regards to web-based entertainment. Concerning youthful buyers in the entirety of their variety, online entertainment presence assists accumulate fast, dependable, and forward-thinking brand data. Youthful customers exhibit a rising interest in reliable data concerning extravagance design brands, thusly, online entertainment can be a helpful way for tracking down data, because of its ability to produce communication among clients and brands quickly. Finally, they noticed the propensity of youthful customers to use online entertainment for making and sharing their extravagant image insights. Online entertainment could be viewed as a compelling method of correspondence for extravagance design brands as it assists with laying out a close-to-home connection between customers and brands.

RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

In this research, we used both qualitative and quantitative research methodology. Qualitative research methodology is used to collect, compare, and analyse large descriptive data from the sample. Quantitative research methodology collects the data through quantitative and close-ended questions and the data is analysed using statistics, mathematical and computerized tools. In this research, we conducted a survey on the likes and dislikes of the customers regarding the brand and how much they are aware of the product Louis Vuitton by using a structured questionnaire and data was collected from a sample of 50 respondents

from Coimbatore city. Coimbatore city is the perfect place to analyse about the youngsters mindset on the brand as the city is the educational hub and Manchester of Tamil Nadu.

And also a complete study was made to deeply understand about marketing strategies they use to attract young customers. Further, we came to know about the strength, weaknesses and opportunities, and weaknesses of the company Louis Vuitton. We have also gone through some literature regarding the attraction towards the brand and the success behind the brand. From that, we have the success that though the brand has a high market value among other products customers are in rush to buy those products because of their unique collection and the promotion they made using their top celebrities in the industry. Not only these two but also the brand image it owns in the market and the quality it has in the product capture the youth youngster eye in the fashion world. Only in this way the young customers are attracted to the brand.

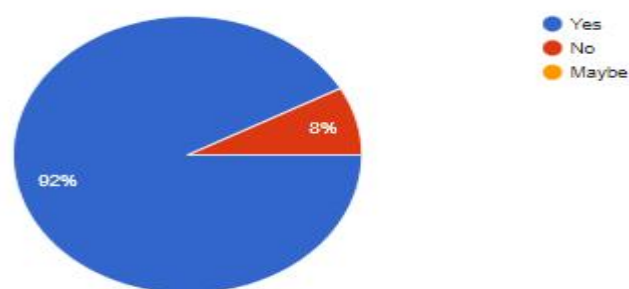
DATA REPRESENTATION AND ANALYSIS

The survey conducted gave us an overall review and awareness of the product brand in the fashion industry. Most people are aware of the brand Louis Vuitton. And few people are interested in knowing about the product. Through the survey, we analysed that the reason behind the attraction of the product is their brand image, customized product, and handmade quality. Among the young generation, few people have purchased the product. We have also analysed that many people are interested in purchasing their handbags, watches, and shoes. From the research, it is easy to examine that most of the products of Louis Vuitton are to the notice of the youngsters and they are very much interested in purchasing those products. As the survey clearly tells the reason behind such eagerness for purchasing those products is the brand image it possess, the quality it has, and its customized product. And the main added advantage of this brand is the fashion show and it's marketing through the top most celebrities around the world. The findings were then presented in graphs and pie charts as appropriate with explanation being given in prose thereafter.

Primary Data Analysis

Have you heard about Louis Vuitton

50 responses

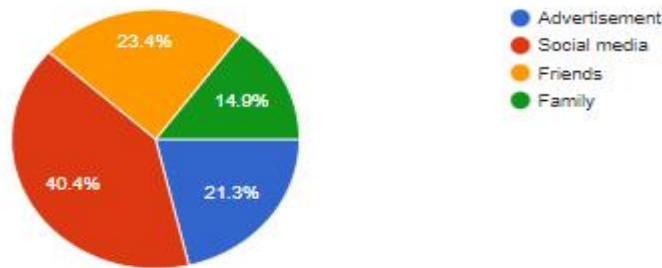


Source: Primary Data.

The pie- chart clearly shows that 92 Percent of the people have heard about the brand Louis Vuitton. And only few people was not aware of that.

Source of Awareness about the Louis Vuitton

47 responses

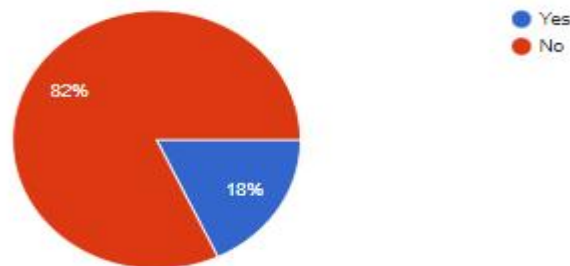


Source: Primary Data.

The chart shows the source from where people heard of this brand Louis Vuitton. It shows that through social media 40.4 Percent people and next to that through friends 23.4 Percent and through ads 21.3 Percent have known about the brand. In case of family it is comparatively less.

Have you ever purchased Louis Vuitton Product?

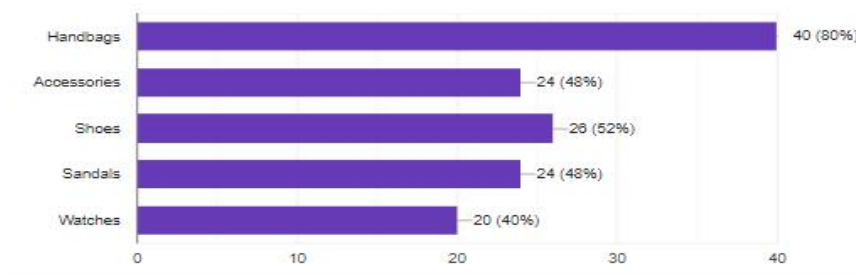
50 responses



Source: Primary Data.

The chart depicts that 82 Percent of the people have not purchased the product only out of 50 people 18 Percent have purchased the product. Through this we can clearly analyse that most people are aware of the brand but in that only hand few have purchased the product.

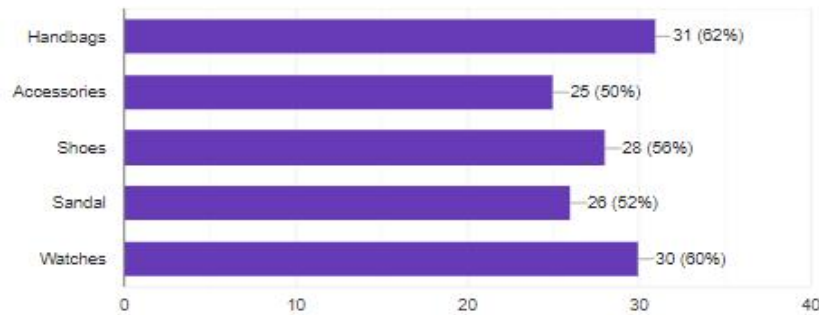
Louis Vuitton Product Awareness - 50 responses



Source: Primary Data.

This bar graph explains that in the Louis Vuitton brand products how many products are known by the people. And 80 Percent people are aware of the product Handbags and next to that 52 Percent of the people are aware of the shoes and accessories and sandals stand equal in 48 Percent. Compared to other products LV watches are comparatively less which is 40 Percent.

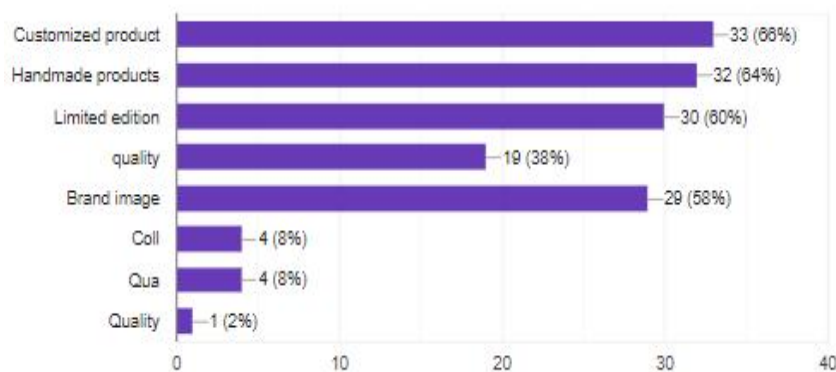
Louis Vuitton Product preference -50 responses



Source: Primary Data.

Apart from the products they were aware of we also raised a question, what products they are interested to buy. The above bar graph clearly explains that about 62 Percent of people are interested to buy the LV handbags and next to that i.e. 60 Percent of the people are interested in their Watches. Only little different it makes for the other products.

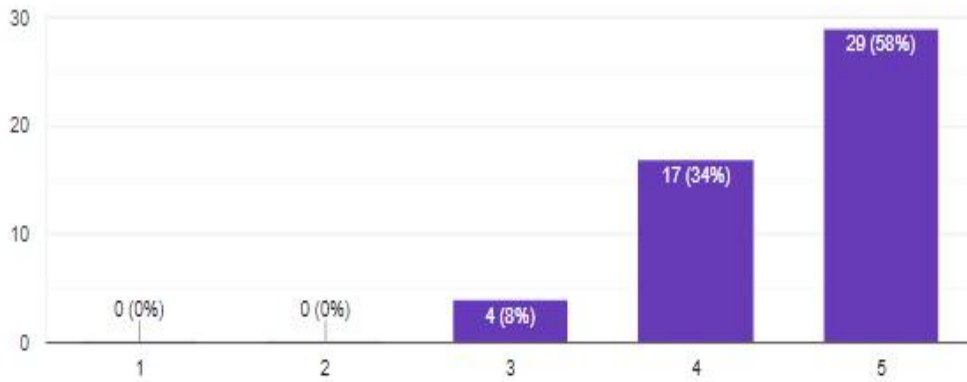
How are you attracted to the product? - 50 responses



Source: Primary Data.

This above bar graph replicate the responses of how people are attracted to the brand. It's clear that 66 Percent of people are attracted to their customised products and 64 Percent people are attracted towards their handmade products. And there is a close difference between the brand image and the limited edition. Only 8 Percent of people prefer the collection and the quality.

Rate the Louis Vuitton product - 50 responses



Source: Primary Data.

We have asked the people to rate the product Louis Vuitton. The bar graph clearly explains that 58 Percent people rated 5 out of 5 and 34 Percent people rated 4 out of 5 and only 8 Percent of the people rated 3 out of 5.

RECOMMENDATIONS

The company should consider the likelihood to develop online shops. It should also specialise in diversification and further expansion. The corporate should invest in R&D to make truly unique products which may diminish counterfeiting. And also it should scrutinize the folks that are middle-aged and per their needs and income they have to manufacture the merchandise. They also have to increase their ad blitz within the fashion world. Louis Vuitton is also one in all the most important companies within the world, but changes within the consumer market may put the company's position within the market in tragedy. To be able to remain at the highest, the corporate has to adapt to the changes within the market to achieve a competitive edge over its competitors.

1. The corporate has to not only target the Japanese market but rather shift its focus to other parts of the globe.
2. The corporate must improve in their marketing strategies so that they can reach as many as customers all over the world from middle aged to higher level and make aware of their product

CONCLUSION

Louis Vuitton is one in every of the foremost famous and successful brands within the world. It's famous for its quality and exclusivity. The history of the corporate suggests that the most important values of its business are creativity, expansion, quality, and luxuriousness. It's possible to notice that Louis Vuitton remains one in all the foremost successful companies within the world market. Its products are still seen as luxury items for a special club of chosen. The corporate has implemented numerous effective strategies, and it can remain the leader. Louis Vuitton strives to keep up its creative momentum and search excellence, with relation to its products likewise as its distribution. They're equally dedicated to the event of the standard of its network of stores. It continues to strive for exceptional venues that provide its customers with a singular experience. Louis Vuitton isn't just another bag, shirt, or apparel company. It's a

way of life that's ever-changing with the planet, which keeps the brand staying collectively of the foremost desirable luxury brands in the world. With good values toward the purchasers, the corporate doesn't need an advanced advertising strategy to remain within the consumers' minds. And, perhaps, that's the most effective tactic.

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INVESTIGATING CONSUMER PREFERENCE TOWARDS ADIDAS FOOTWEAR IN SOUTH COIMBATORE.

Dr. T. Usha Rani, Assistant Professor, School of Commerce, Kumaraguru College of Liberal Arts and Science, Coimbatore.

P. Bhuvaneshwari, B. Com PA, Department of Commerce, Kumaraguru College of Liberal Arts and Science, Coimbatore.

Arockiya Aishwarya, B. Com PA, Department of Commerce, Kumaraguru College of Liberal Arts and Science, Coimbatore.

ABSTRACT

This research study examines the consumer preference for Adidas footwear in the South Coimbatore region. The objective is to gain insights into the factors influencing consumers' choice when it comes to Adidas footwear products. The study comprises of both primary and secondary data. Through the analysis of the data collected, including the demographic information and purchasing behaviour, the research aims to provide valuable information and purchasing behaviour, the research aims to provide valuable information to Adidas and other stakeholders in the footwear industry. The findings of the study will contribute to a deeper understanding of consumer preferences in the South Coimbatore market and assist in the formulation of targeted marketing strategies for Adidas products in the region.

KEYWORDS: Consumer Preference, Footwear, Adidas Brand

INTRODUCTION

The footwear industry is highly competitive, and brands constantly seek to understand consumer preferences to stay ahead in the market. Adidas, a renowned global sportswear brand, has a significant presence in South Coimbatore, where consumers have a diverse range of choices when it comes to footwear. This research study aims to investigate and analyse consumer preference towards Adidas footwear in the South Coimbatore region.

The objective of this study is to gain valuable insights into the factors that influence consumers' choices when it comes to Adidas footwear products. By understanding consumer preferences, Adidas can tailor its marketing strategies to cater to the specific needs and demands of consumers in this market. Furthermore, the findings of this research will be beneficial not only to Adidas but also to other stakeholders in the footwear industry seeking to enhance their market presence in South Coimbatore.

The study involves both primary and secondary data. Primary Data has been collected with a structured questionnaire from the samples, who are Adidas consumers in South Coimbatore. Secondary data has been collected from various journals, books, magazines and internet. The data so collected has been analysed using appropriate statistical methods such as Percentage Analysis, Fried Manns Rank Test and Chi-Square Test.

The research's objectives include understanding the level of satisfaction of consumers towards Adidas footwear, identifying the reasons for consumer's preference for Adidas products and analysing the factors that could potentially hinder consumers from purchasing adidas footwear.

By delving into consumer preferences and the factors driving their purchasing decisions, this study will contribute to a deeper understanding of the South Coimbatore market's dynamics concerning footwear. It will enable Adidas to develop targeted marketing strategies, product improvements and customer-centric initiatives, thus enhancing their competitive advantage in the region.

OBJECTIVES OF THE STUDY

1. To understand the level of satisfaction of consumers towards Adidas Footwears.
2. To know the reasons for the purchase preference of consumers towards Adidas Footwears.
3. To analyse the factors that prevents consumers from buying Adidas Footwears.

REVIEW OF LITERATURE

Vladimir Matovic and et.al (2019) says that Brands Nike and Adidas are considered competitors because both companies produce sports shoes, clothes and equipment and are leading in the global market. The subject of this work is analysis of the impact of brands on consumers' willingness to buy brands like Nike and Adidas, as well as examining the similarities and differences between the brands and their positioning in the global market. The purpose of this work is reflected in increasing the level of awareness of the importance that the companies in BiH build a strong brand as one of the prerequisites for good positioning on the market, and about the impact of the brand on consumers 'inclination to purchase specific products. The specified subject and aim of this research have set up guidelines to define the main hypotheses that the citizens of the municipality of Foca believe that brand has a significant impact on them when purchasing athletic shoes, apparel, and equipment, and to prefer shopping Nike better than Adidas brand. The research was conducted by a variety of techniques and methods of scientific research.

Mahila M and Dr. M. P Kumaran (2021) reveals that Sport shoes are devised for the purpose of sports and other forms of physical activities like jogging, cycling and sports activities etc. But nowadays it is also used by the people as a casual wear too. Due to this situation the manufacturing of the sport shoes is heavily concentrated and the various companies with their specific brands of the sports shoes emerge in the market with heavy competition. Awareness regarding health benefits of physical activities is increasing day-by-day among youths, health-conscious adults and even with school children. So, it makes them to go for best sport shoes. Based on these facts more and more companies are entering into the market of sports shoes with their specific brands along with the factors such as price, style, product quality, durability, variety, and they attract the consumers through advertisements. So, it tends the consumers to go for the particular brand. Nike, Adidas, Reebok, and Puma are one of the top 10 sports shoes brands in India. This

study indicates that, most of the customer were satisfied towards specific brands of the sports shoes with respect to the chosen factors and the consumer behaviour on sports shoes is also good.

STATEMENT OF THE PROBLEM

The problem addressed in this research study is to investigate the consumer preference towards Adidas footwear in the South Coimbatore Region. The study aims to understand the level of satisfaction of consumers with Adidas footwear, identify the reasons for their preference for Adidas products, and analyse the factors that may hinder consumers from purchasing Adidas footwear in the market.

RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

The present research study involves both primary and secondary data. Primary Data has been collected with a structured questionnaire from the samples, who are Adidas consumers in South Coimbatore. Secondary data has been collected from various journals, books, magazines and internet. The data so collected has been analysed using appropriate statistical methods such as Percentage Analysis, Fried Manns Rank Test and Chi-Square Test.

LIMITATION OF THE STUDY

This study is conducted in South Coimbatore region, which may or may not be suitable for any other regions.

DATA ANALYSIS AND INTERPRETATION

Data Analysis and Interpretation of the study has been processed with the help of Excel. Percentage Analysis, and Charts are used to depict the data for better understanding. With the interpretation and analysis key findings are thereby generated and few suggestions for improvement has been recorded. This has also contributed to conclude the study by highlighting the key areas of the research.

DEMOGRAPHIC PROFILE OF THE RESPONDENT

The study investigates the demographic profile of the respondents, focusing on gender distribution and age groups. This data provides valuable insights into the composition of the sample population and is crucial for understanding the broader implications of the study's findings.

Sl. No	GENDER	NO. OF RESPONDENTS	PERCENTAGE
1	Male	25	41.6
2	Female	35	58.4
Sl. No	AGE	NO. OF RESPONDENTS	PERCENTAGE
1	Below 15 years	1	1.66
2	15-30 years	50	83.33
3	30-45 years	4	6.6
4	Above 45 years	5	8.33

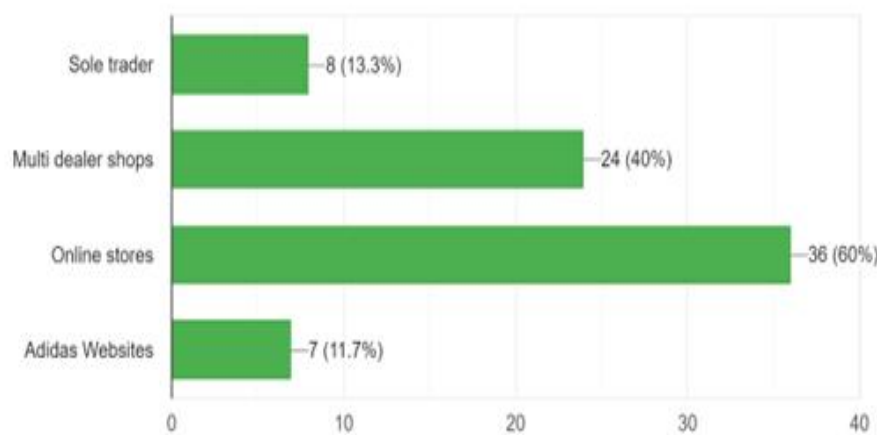
Source: Primary Data.

The majority of the respondents were female, comprising 58.4 percent of the sample population, while males constituted 41.6 percent. This gender distribution suggests a balanced representation, allowing for a comprehensive assessment of perspectives.

The largest age group represented was respondents between 15-30 years, accounting for 83.33 percent of the samples. The age groups 30-45 years and above 45 years were relatively smaller, constituting 6.6 percent and 8.33 percent respectively. The age group below 15 years had the smallest representation at 1.66 percent.

PURCHASE PLACE OF ADIDAS BRAND

The purchase place of Adidas products can vary on the consumer's preferences, location, and the brand's distribution channels.



Source: Primary Data.

It is clear from the above chart that 60 percent of the respondents purchase through online stores and only 11.7 percent purchase from the Adidas Websites.

PERIOD OF PURCHASE FROM ADIDAS

This study examines the patterns of purchase frequency among respondents, focusing on the period at which they acquire items. The data collected sheds light on the preferences and behaviours of the surveyed population regarding their buying habits.

S.No	PERIOD OF PURCHASE	NO. OF RESPONDENTS	PERCENTAGE
1	Half-yearly	2	3.3
2	yearly	8	13.3
3	When needed	50	83

Source: Primary Data.

Half-yearly category accounts for 3.3 percent of the respondents, indicating a relatively infrequent buying pattern, where purchases occur twice a year. This may suggest a preference for bulk or seasonal shopping. 13.3 percent of respondents make purchases on a yearly basis. This suggests a less frequent buying habit, possibly reserved for special occasions or big-ticket items. The majority, constituting 83 percent of respondents, make purchases on an as-needed basis. This indicates a pragmatic approach, with consumers acquiring items based on necessity rather than a fixed schedule.

FREQUENCY OF PURCHASE OF FOOTWEAR

This study examines the purchasing frequency of respondents, focusing on how often they engage in buying activities. The data collected provides valuable insights into the patterns and behaviours of the surveyed population with regards to their purchasing habits.

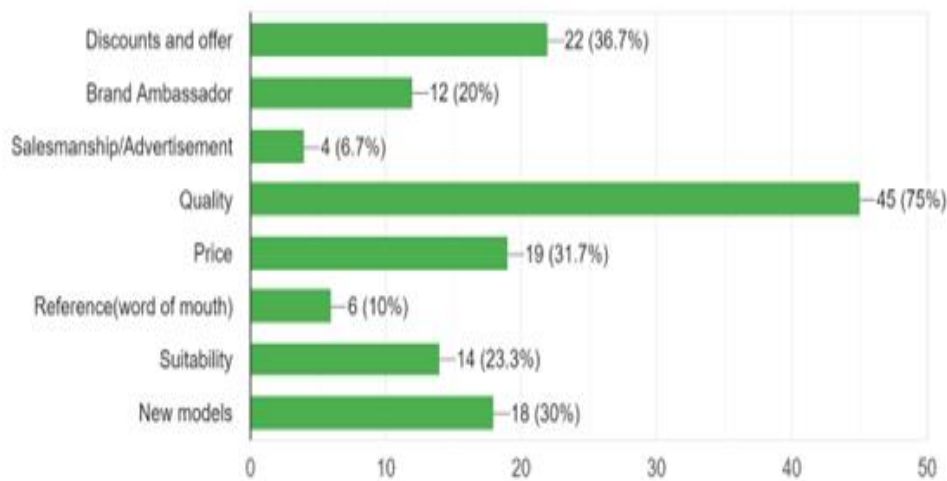
S. No	FREQUENCY OF PURCHASE	NO. OF RESPONDENTS	PERCENTAGE
1	Once	15	25
2	Twice	20	33.3
3	Thrice	9	15
4	4 and More Times	3	5
5	Nil	13	21.66

Source: Primary Data.

25 percent of the respondents indicated that they make purchases only once. This suggests a relatively infrequent shopping pattern, possibly indicating a preference for bulk buying or shopping for specific occasions. 33.3 percent of respondents reported making purchases twice. This indicates a moderately frequent shopping habit, possibly aligned with regular shopping needs or preferences. 15 percent of respondents indicated that they make purchases three times. This suggests a slightly more frequent shopping pattern, possibly indicating a preference for regular replenishment of goods or a specific routine. 5 percent of respondents reported making purchases four times or more. This indicates a relatively high frequency of shopping, possibly suggesting a regular shopping routine or lifestyle. 21.66 percent of respondents indicated that they do not make purchases. This could imply that this group does not engage in regular buying activities, or they rely on non-traditional methods of obtaining goods.

FACTORS INFLUENCING THE PURCHASING DECISION

There are various factors which influence the purchasing decision while purchasing from a particular brand. Let analyse the influential factor of the surveyed population while purchasing from a brand from the chart below.



Source: Primary Data.

It is clear from the above chart that 75 percent of the respondents says that they are influenced by the quality of the products and 23.3 percent are influenced by sustainability of the product and only 6.7 percent are influenced by Advertisement of the product.

PREFERENCE FOR OTHER BRANDS

The study examines the respondent preferences towards the other brands than adidas, focusing on whether they change preference towards any other brand or stick on the same brand.

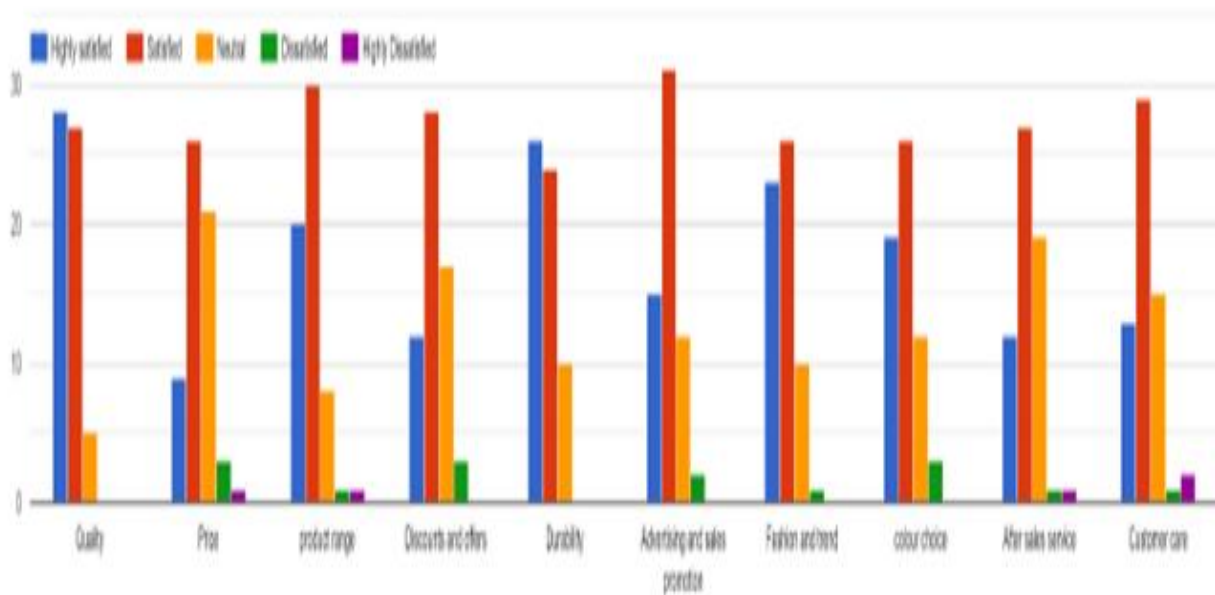
S. No	PREFERENCE FOR OTHER BRANDS	NO. OF RESPONDENTS	PERCENTAGE
1	yes	18	30
2	No	16	26.66
3	Sometimes	26	43.33

Source: Primary Data.

43.33 percent of the surveyed population says that sometimes they have preference towards other brands, 26 percent of the respondents says that their preference does not change and will stick on to adidas brand no matter if other choice of brands are available.

SATISFACTION LEVEL ON ADIDAS FOOTWEAR

The below tables examine the various aspects of Adidas footwear which could be used to understand customer perceptions and strategies for enhancing customer satisfaction and loyalty for the Adidas brand.



Source: Primary Data.

The majority of respondents (28) are highly satisfied with the quality of Adidas footwear, with 27 more expressing satisfaction. A small proportion of respondents are dissatisfied or highly dissatisfied with the pricing. Overall, the data suggests that Adidas footwear receives positive feedback, particularly in terms of quality, product range, and durability. However, improvements are required in the areas such as pricing, after-sales service, and customer care.

PERCEPTION OF THE BRAND

The perception of a brand, including Adidas, is shaped by various factors and influences how consumers view and interact with the products.

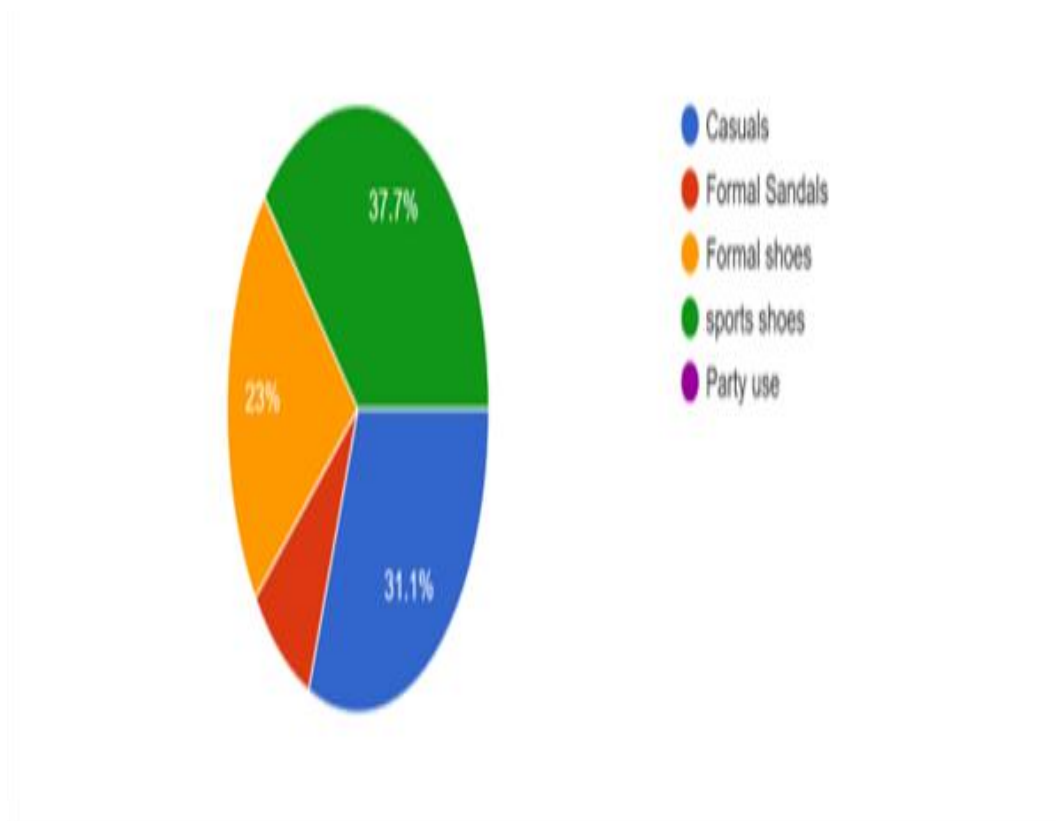
PERCEPTION BASIS	MEAN RANK	RANK
Unique sense of style	6.80	3
Variety	3.75	8
Comfortable	7.12	2
Affordability	4.58	7
Quality	7.59	1
Satisfaction	4.76	6
Prestige	5.04	4
Pleasure	4.98	5

Source: Primary Data.

The factor Unique Sense of Style is perceived to have a moderate rank (3) and an average mean rank of 6.80, Variety is ranked 8th and has a mean rank of 3.75, suggesting it is one of the lower-ranked factors, Comfortability has a relatively high rank of 2 and a mean rank of 7.12, indicating it is considered important. Affordability is ranked 7th with a mean rank of 4.58. Quality is perceived to be the most important factor, with a top rank of 1 and a mean rank of 7.59. Satisfaction has a rank of 6 and a mean rank of 4.76. Prestige is ranked 4th, with a mean rank of 5.04. Pleasure is ranked 5th and has a mean rank of 4.98. In summary, the table provides a comparative assessment of various factors based on mean ranks and specific ranks, with quality being perceived as the most important factor.

PREFERENCE ON THE VARIOUS ADIDAS FOOTWEAR

Consumer preferences for various Adidas footwear depend on individual tastes, needs, and lifestyle choices.



Source: Primary Data.

The Casual shoes are the most popular type, accounting for 37.7 percent of the pie chart. Formal sandals and party shoes are grouped together, making up 31.1 percent. Formal shoes make up 23 percent of the chart. Sports shoes are the least represented category, with only 10 percent.

IMPACT OF PRICE HIKE

This study investigates the impact of price hikes on consumer brand preferences. Understanding how respondents react to increases in prices provides valuable insights into their purchasing behaviour and brand loyalty in the face of economic changes.

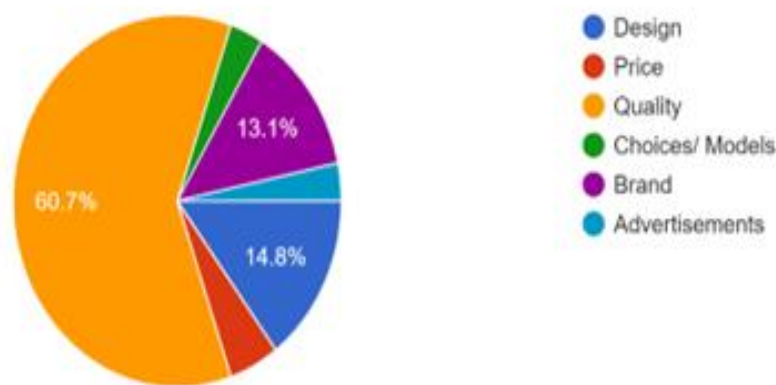
S.No	IMPACT OF PRICE HIKE	NO. OF RESPONDENTS	PERCENTAGE
1	Stick on to the same brand	26	44.3
2	Prefer cheaper brand	7	11.6
3	Prefer any other brand	27	45

Source: Primary Data.

The majority of respondents, constituting 44.3 percent, indicated a strong inclination to remain loyal to their current brand despite the price increase. This suggests a significant level of brand loyalty among this segment of the population. A smaller percentage, 11.6 percent expressed a preference for switching to a cheaper brand in response to price hikes. This group is price sensitive and prioritizes cost savings. A substantial proportion, 45 percent, stated a willingness to switch to a different brand regardless of price. This indicates a segment of consumers who are open to exploring alternatives based on factors beyond price alone.

FEATURE OF ADIDAS FOOTWEAR THAT IMPRESSED THE RESPONDENTS

The table explains the features of Adidas Footwear that impressed the respondents where different features like design, price, quality, choices, brand and advertisements are included.



Source: Primary Data.

The above table shows the percentages of valuable insights into the factors that resonate with consumers when it comes to Adidas Footwear. The high percentage for Quality indicates that this is a standout feature that Adidas should continue to prioritize and promote. Additionally, the positive perception of Design and Brands also suggests that aesthetics and brand reputation are important considerations for consumers.

FINDINGS

- The study demonstrates a significant presence of females in the respondent pool, indicating a growing interest and participation in the subject matter under investigation. This challenges traditional gender biases and highlights the need for inclusive research methodologies.
- The substantial representation of respondents between 15-30 years suggests a high level of engagement and interest among the younger population in the study's focus. This age group is likely to have a significant influence on trends and preferences within the subject area. The smaller representation of respondents in the 30-45 years and above 45 years categories indicate a potential gap in interest or accessibility among older demographics. Further research could be conducted to explore factors contributing to this trend.
- The study highlights a prevalent trend among respondents, with the majority opting to make purchases when the need arises. This pragmatic approach suggests a consumer base that values practicality and efficiency in their buying habits. The smaller percentages associated with half-yearly and yearly purchasing indicate that respondents generally do not engage in extensive pre-planned buying sprees. Instead, they tend to make purchases more sporadically.
- The data showcases a diverse range of purchasing habits among respondents, indicating that different segments of the population engage in shopping activities with varying frequencies. The highest percentage of respondents falls into the category of making purchases twice. This suggests that a substantial portion of the surveyed population engages in shopping activities with a moderate level of frequency.
- The data highlights a notable level of brand loyalty among respondents, with a significant portion opting to stick with their current brand despite price increases. This suggests that factors other than price play a significant role in their purchasing decisions. A smaller but still notable segment of respondents express a willingness to switch to cheaper brands in response to price hikes. This suggests that for some consumers, price is a critical factor in their purchasing decisions.
- Nearly half of the respondents are open to considering alternative brands, regardless of price. This indicates a segment of consumers who are receptive to trying new products or brands, potentially driven by factors such as quality, reputation, or other preferences.

SUGGESTIONS

- Understanding the preference for need-based purchasing can inform marketing efforts. Emphasizing practicality, quality and addressing immediate needs can be key points of focus in advertising campaigns.

- Retailers and businesses can adapt inventory management strategies to align with the consumer preference for need-based purchasing. Ensuring availability of essential items and providing options for more occasional shoppers may enhance customer satisfaction.
- While the majority of the respondents prefer need-based purchases, there is still a notable percentage who buy on a yearly basis. Creating special promotions or events around holidays or occasions can cater to this segment of the market.
- Understanding the range of purchasing frequencies can inform marketing strategies. Tailoring advertising efforts to cater to different segments.
- For brands looking to retain customer loyalty, it is crucial to communicate and reinforce the unique value propositions that extend beyond price, such as quality, customer service, or brand reputation.
- To cater to price-sensitive consumers, brands may consider implementing competitive pricing strategies or offering special promotions to provide cost-effective alternatives.
- Brands should focus on promoting their distinctive features, whether it's superior quality, innovative products, or a unique brand identity, to attract consumers who are open to exploring new options.
- Clear Communication about product benefits, quality, and any unique advantages can help educate consumers about the value they receive from the brand, beyond just the price point.

CONCLUSION

In conclusion, the investigation has provided valuable insights into the factors influencing consumer preference towards Adidas footwear in South Coimbatore. By leveraging these findings, Adidas can refine its marketing strategies and product offerings to better cater to the preferences and needs of the local consumer base, ultimately driving brand loyalty and market growth in this region.

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A STUDY ON CONSUMER SATISFACTION TOWARDS RAYMOND BRANDS IN COIMBATORE CITY

Dr. S. Muthulekshmi, Assistant Professor, Department of Commerce, Kumaraguru College of Liberal Arts and Science, Coimbatore.

Ms. L. Swathi, III B. Com PA, Kumaraguru College of Liberal Arts and Science, Coimbatore.

ABSTRACT

In this era Consumer satisfaction is the key to success. Consumer satisfaction is one of the most prominent features in all the field most commonly in food, clothing, and shelter. Constant innovation and improvement are particularly important for all the organization to sustain in the market with the growing competition. Customers are more calculative now a days and desire for maximum value for money not only desire but also the quality of the product also plays a significant role in satisfying the customers. This is an empirical study based on primary data and secondary data. the sample size of the primary data is 61 respondents. The data has been collected through questionnaires. Internet, books, and magazines are the sources of secondary data. the data collected have been analyzed using basic statistical tools such as tables, graphs, and charts.

Key words: consumer, consumer satisfaction, maximum value of money.

INTRODUCTION

The history of textile industry in India dates to the Indus valley civilization. Most commonly the textiles manufactured from animal hair, wool, cotton, and silk. Number of small kingdoms contributed to the development of textile industry in India over time. Silks were also manufactured during the reign of Mauryan dynasty were highly prized by romans, Chinese and other Asian merchants. India has the second largest manufacturing capacity in textiles globally and accounts for 13 Percent of the world's production of textile, fibre and yarn.

Raymond limited is the largest manufacturer of fabric in the world. It has over 60 Percent market share in suiting in India. It was incorporated as the Raymond woollen mill during the year 1925 near thane creek. an elderly mam by the name of Wadia had the foresight to show a modest woollen mill in backward region of thane, Maharashtra. In 1958 the first Raymond retail showroom, kings' corner, was opened at Ballard estate in Mumbai. in 1968, Raymond has set up a ready-made garments plant in thane. In 1979, a new manufacturing facility was set up at Jalgaon (Maharashtra) to meet the increasing the demand woollen fabrics. In 1986, they launched another brand-named park avenue, a collection of stylish wardrobes for men.

In 1990 Raymond opened its first international showroom in Oman. They entered in aviation industry in 1996. In 1999 luxury casual wear branded parx were introduced to provide customers with a variety of

semi-formal and casual clothing. Introduction of ready-to-wear clothing in 2008 which is known as Raymond ready to wear. The company launched smartest fabric in the world known as techno smart in 2016 and in the same year, new Raymond office was opened in Dubai. It had experienced its fastest ever retail expansion with 900 outlets in 500+ Indian towns. To fight against the covid, Raymond produced 'Vira safe', a highly effective anti-viral fabric. In two years, the Raymond is going to celebrate its proud 100th year. With first class quality and satisfaction.

STATEMENT OF THE PROBLEM

Companies make a variety of attempts to achieve their goals. Most businesses strive to turn potential clients into loyal patrons. These surveys were carried out to figure out consumer satisfaction with Raymond apparel in order to deliver the most benefits and convenience to the customers while making excellent use of resources. Fashion apparel industry is a very unpredictable one. But even in this unpredictable era the brand Raymond is going to step into 100th year in 2 years. In India it is at the development stage, where new outlets come out very often. There is a high amount of struggle among the companies within the industry to stand out from the rest and to be the best of the country. People within Coimbatore area limits lead busy lifestyles and often seek for convenience.

OBJECTIVES

- To study the demographic profile of the respondents of Coimbatore city.
- To understand the factors which influence the purchase of Raymond cloths.
- To analyse the satisfactory level and preference of the consumers towards Raymond brand in Coimbatore city.

REVIEW OF LITERATURE

DR.N. VIJAITHA CHRISTY AND DR. ANGELINE SHEBA ALBERT (2019) This study helps in selecting the best and suitable cloths according to the customer preferences and satisfaction, also to study about buying behaviour of Raymond cloth in Coimbatore City. The present study was based on Occupation, age group, Gender, Purchase occasion, Preferring brand, Quality of Raymond clothes. The researchers have analysed through primary data by comprehensive interview schedule and secondary data have been collected from Books, Journals and Websites. This study was carried out for the period of one month. The data which were collected from the respondents were analysed by using Percentage, and Likert's scale analysis. These research gives to draw finding, suggestion, and conclusion on buying behaviour of Raymond Clothes.

Mrs. Pavithra Gopinath, Mr. Gokul (2023) Raymond Clothes offers a diverse range of products that cater to various occasions and personal styles. From impeccably tailored suits to casual wear and accessories, the brand caters to the modern man's every sartorial need. Whether it is a formal board room

meeting, or a casual weekend outing, Raymond Clothes seamlessly blends classic aesthetics with modern trends, creating timeless ensembles that exude confidence and charm.

RAHUL JHA, SUJOI MANDAL (2021) his study has been undertaken to investigate the determinants of stock returns in Karachi Stock Exchange (KSE) using two assets pricing models the classical Capital Asset Pricing Model and Arbitrage Pricing Theory model. To test the CAPM market return is used, and macroeconomic variables are used to test the APT. The macroeconomic variables include inflation, oil prices, interest rate and exchange rate.

RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

Research refers to the analytic examination which leads to collection of data, documentation of nagging information which analysis and interprets the data according to the suitable methodologies needed to gain knowledge. Research method is the way to scientifically solve the research problems. To achieve the aims of this paper, quantitative research was done. The aim of this paper is to find the consumer satisfaction, usage, factors influencing, Primary data for this study has been collected by a survey conducted among common people. The questionnaire has been used to collect the data. The sample size collected with the help of questionnaires is 60. Convenience sampling method is used in collecting data and it is the method of getting response from the people who is typically convenient.

DATA ANALYSIS AND INTERPRETATION

Data analysis is the process of transferring a data to discover the useful information and to draw conclusion. Data interpretation is the process of making sense out of collection of data that has been processed and the report of the study means that most critical aspects of the research paper. It constitutes to the overall conclusion of the study. Data analysis and interpretation has been processed with the help of tables, charts and pie diagram.

DEMOGRAPHIC PROFILE OF THE RESPONDENTS

Demographic profile of the respondents has been analyzed and interpreted to have better understanding on the respondents. This includes Age, gender, level of education, occupation and income of the respondents.

Table 1- Demographic Profile of the Respondents

S.NO	AGE	NO. OF RESPONDENTS	PERCENTAGE
1	Below 18	9	14.8
2	18-30	36	59
3	31-40	10	16.4
4	Above 40	6	9.8
	Total	61	
S.NO	GENDER	NO. OF. RESPONDENTS	PERCENTAGE
1	male	46	75.4
2	Female	15	24.6
3	Prefer not to say	nil	nil
	Total	61	
S.NO	OCCUPATION	NO. OF. RESPONDENTS	PERCENTAGE
1	Private Employee	16	26.2
2	Public Employee	6	9.8
3	Student	27	44.3
4	Entrepreneur	6	9.8
5	Others	6	9.8
	Total	61	
S.NO	INCOME	NO. OF. RESPONDENTS	PERCENTAGE
1	Below 10000	31	50.8
2	10000-20000	11	18
3	20000-30000	10	16.4
4	Above 30000	9	14.8
	Total	61	

Source: Primary Data

The table presents a comprehensive overview of survey responses categorized by age, gender, occupation, and income. In terms of age distribution, the majority falls within the 18-30 range, comprising 59 Percent of the total respondents, while those below 18, between 31-40, and above 40 account for 14.8 Percent, 16.4 Percent, and 9.8 Percent, respectively. Regarding gender, a significant majority are male at 75.4 Percent, with females constituting 24.6 Percent. The occupation data reveals that students form the largest group at 44.3 Percent, followed by private employees at 26.2 Percent, and a smaller percentage in public employment, entrepreneurship, and other occupations. Income-wise, more than half of the respondents earn below 10000, representing 50.8 Percent, while the 10000-20000, 20000-30000, and above 30000 categories make up 18 Percent, 16.4 Percent, and 14.8 Percent, respectively. This comprehensive breakdown of survey demographics provides valuable insights into the characteristics of the respondents, shedding light on patterns across age, gender, occupation, and income groups.

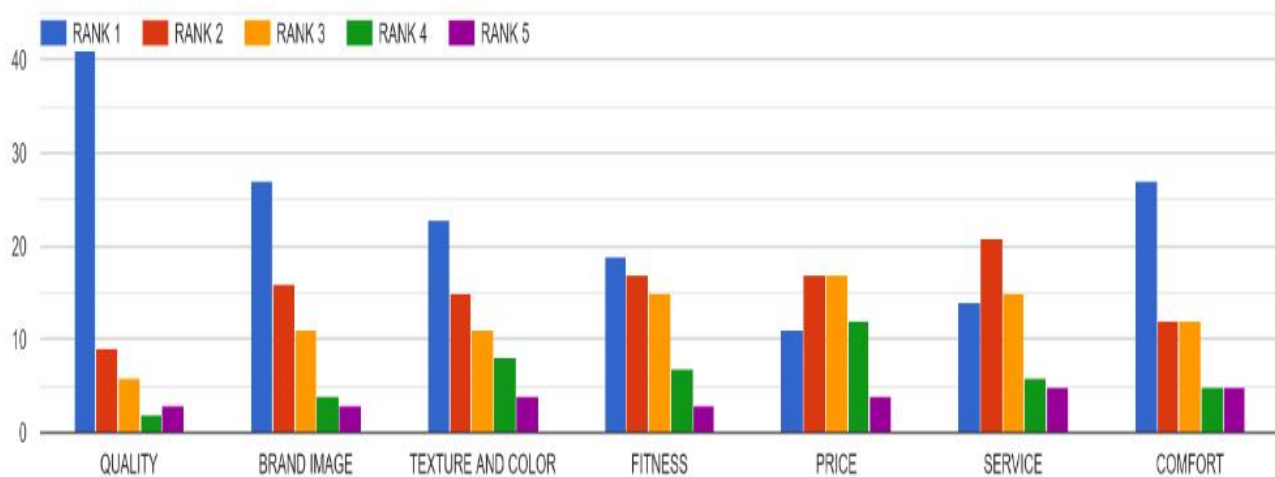
FEATURES INFLUENCING CUSTOMERS TO PURCHASE

The chart titled "Features Influencing Customers to Purchase," based on primary data, aims to provide insights into the key factors that play a significant role in influencing customer purchasing decisions. This

data is derived from a primary source, indicating that the information is collected directly from the target audience or customers. The chart is designed to illustrate and highlight the various features or attributes that hold sway over consumer choices during the decision-making process. By examining the data presented in the chart, businesses and stakeholders can gain a deeper understanding of the preferences and priorities of their target market, thereby informing strategic decisions related to product development, marketing strategies, and overall customer engagement.

Chart 1- Features Influencing Customers to Purchase

WHAT FEATURE INFLUENCED YOU TO BUY RAYMOND PRODUCT?



Source: Primary Data

The chart clearly depicts that 41 respondents ranked 1 are influenced to Raymond brand because of its quality. 27 and 23 respondents ranked 1 for brand image and texture and colour. 19 and 17 respondents ranked 1 and 2 to the most of fitness. 17 respondents ranked 2 and 3 for price. 21 respondents ranked 2 for service and 27 ranked 1 for comfort.

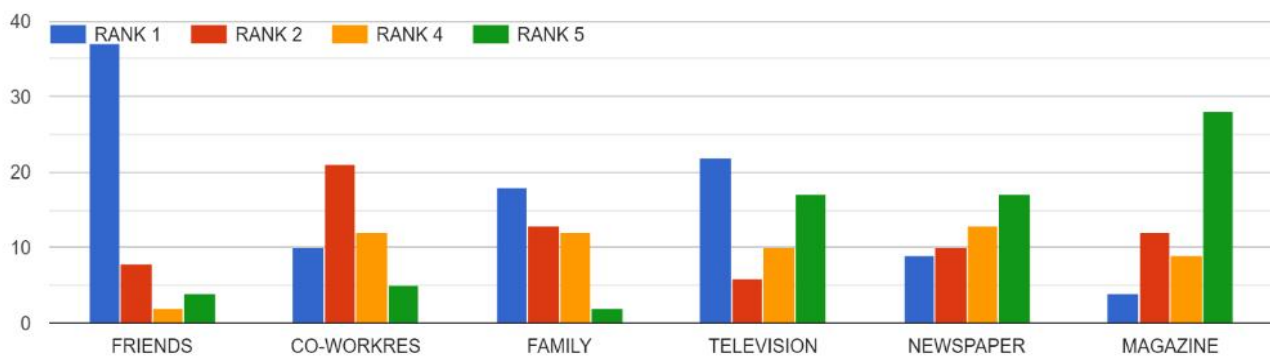
SEEKING INFORMATION OF NEW ARRIVALS

The chart titled "Seeking Information of New Arrivals," sourced from primary data, endeavours to elucidate the patterns and preferences of individuals in their pursuit of information regarding recently introduced products or services. Originating from primary data sources implies that the information is directly gathered from the target audience, ensuring a firsthand and authentic representation of consumer behaviour. This chart serves as a valuable resource for businesses and marketers aiming to comprehend the channels and methods through which potential customers seek details about new arrivals in the market. By

analysing the presented data, companies can tailor their communication strategies, advertising efforts, and promotional activities to align with the preferred information-seeking avenues of their target audience. Understanding how consumers stay informed about new offerings is essential for staying competitive and responsive to evolving market dynamics, making this chart a valuable tool for businesses keen on adapting to consumer preferences and enhancing their market presence.

Chart-2-seeking information of new arrivals.

HOW DID YOU CAME TO KNOW ABOUT NEW ARRIVALS OF RAYMONDS?



Source: Primary Data

The bar graph depicts that the 37 respondents ranked 1 and came to know about the new arrivals through their friends and 21 respondents ranked 2 for co-workers, 18 respondents ranked 1 for family, 22 respondents ranked 1 for television and 17 respondents ranked 5 for newspaper and 28 ranked 5 for magazine.

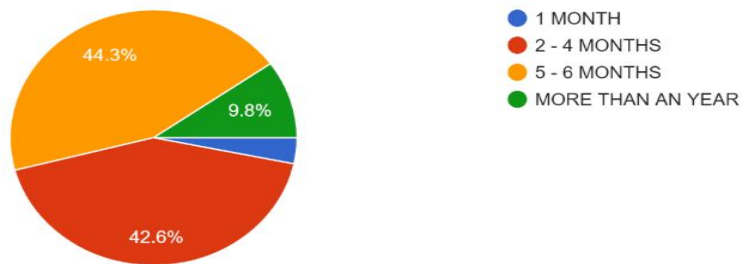
FREQUENCY OF PURCHASE

The chart titled "Frequency of Purchase," derived from primary data, provides a comprehensive overview of the purchasing behaviour exhibited by the target audience. Being based on primary data signifies that the information has been directly collected from the consumers, ensuring an accurate representation of their buying habits. This chart aims to shed light on the frequency with which individuals make purchases, offering valuable insights into consumer behaviour patterns. By examining the data, businesses and stakeholders can gain a nuanced understanding of how often their target market engages in buying activities. This information is instrumental in shaping marketing strategies, inventory management, and customer engagement initiatives. Whether customers make frequent or occasional purchases can have profound implications for businesses, influencing decisions related to product availability, pricing, and loyalty programs. As a result, this chart serves as a vital tool for organizations seeking to tailor their approach to consumer needs and preferences.

Chart-3-Frequency of Purchase

WHAT IS YOUR PURCHASE DURATION OF RAYMOND BRAND?

61 responses



Source: Primary Data

The above charts shows that 44.3 Percent and 42.6 Percent of the respondents purchase duration is 5-6 months and 2-4 months. The only reason for buying the brand is quality and brand image.

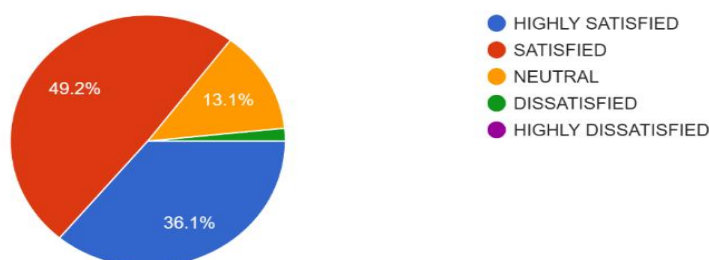
SATISFACTION LEVEL OF RAYMOND PRODUCTS

The chart titled "Satisfaction Level of Raymond Products," sourced from primary data, offers a compelling insight into the overall satisfaction levels of consumers with regard to Raymond products. The data strongly indicates that an overwhelming majority, specifically 85.3 Percent of the respondents, express a high level of satisfaction with Raymond products. This high satisfaction rate suggests a positive reception and contentment among consumers who have experienced the brand's offerings. The chart serves as a key metric for Raymond and other stakeholders, providing a clear indication of customer satisfaction, which is a critical factor in building brand loyalty and sustaining market success. This robust endorsement from the majority of respondents underscores the brand's ability to meet or exceed customer expectations, reflecting positively on the quality, performance, and overall appeal of Raymond products in the market. The chart thus becomes an invaluable resource for Raymond in gauging its performance and reputation among its customer bases.

Chart-4- Satisfaction Level of Raymond Products

ARE YOU SATISFIED WITH RAYMOND PRODUCTS

61 responses



Source: Primary Data

The above table strongly shows that 85.3 percent of the respondents are highly satisfied with the Raymond products.

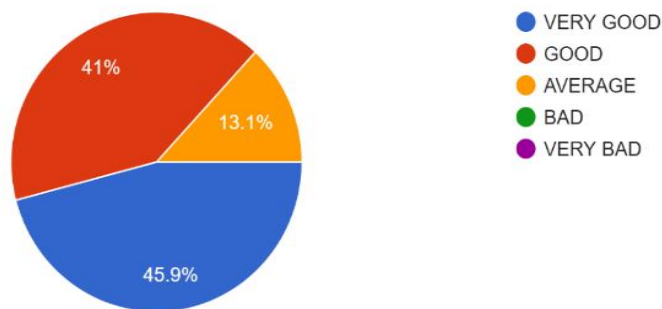
CONSUMERS PERCEPTION

The chart titled "Consumers' Perception," derived from primary data, provides a detailed breakdown of how consumers perceive the Raymond brand. The chart serves as a valuable tool for Raymond and other stakeholders, offering insights into the strengths and potential areas for improvement in the brand's image and perception among its target audience. Analysing consumer perceptions is essential for strategic brand management, as it influences decisions related to marketing strategies, communication efforts, and product positioning.

Chart-5- Consumers Perception

WHAT IS YOUR PERCEPTION ABOUT RAYMOND BRAND ?

61 responses



Source: Primary Data

According to the table, 45.9 Percent of respondents have an exceptionally good perception, while 41 Percent hold an average opinion, and 13.1 Percent fall within the category of other feelings. This data is crucial in understanding the qualitative aspects of consumer attitudes towards the Raymond brand. This chart, rooted in primary data, becomes a key resource for Raymond to tailor its strategies and initiatives in alignment with the sentiments and opinions of its consumers, ultimately contributing to the brand's sustained success in the market.

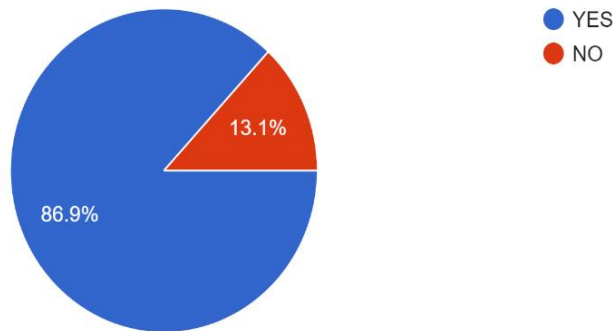
SOCIAL STATUS OF THE RESPONDENTS USING RAYMOND BRANDS

The chart titled "Social Status of Respondents Using Raymond Brands," sourced from primary data, offers valuable insights into the perceived correlation between the use of Raymond brands and an individual's social status. The accompanying pie charts distinctly illustrate that 53 respondents believe that the Raymond brand serves as an indicator of social status, while 8 respondents hold the contrasting view that it does not reflect social standing. This data provides a nuanced understanding of how consumers associate the Raymond brand with societal perceptions and personal image.

Chart-6- social status of the respondents using Raymond brands.

IN YOUR OPINION DOES THE RAYMOND WEARS SHOWS THE SOCIAL STATUS OF A PERSON

61 responses



Source: Primary Data

The above pie charts clearly shows that 53 respondents say that the Raymond brand shows the social status of a person, and 8 respondents say it doesn't show the social status of the people. The chart serves as a critical tool for Raymond and other stakeholders, offering key insights into the brand's symbolic value and its impact on consumer perceptions of social status. Such information is pivotal for marketing strategies, as it enables businesses to align their messaging and branding efforts with the aspirational or status-oriented elements associated with their products. Overall, this chart contributes to a comprehensive understanding of the role that the Raymond brand plays in shaping consumer perceptions related to social status.

FINDINGS OF THE STUDY

1. Most of the customers belongs to the age group of '18-30' years prefer to buy Raymond brands in Coimbatore city.
2. Maximum number of respondents uses Raymond brand.
3. Most of the consumer had particularly good belief and says that Raymond shows the social status of the people.
4. People say that the quality and brand image influence them in purchase of Raymond.
5. The sources by which the maximum number of respondents come to know about Raymond's fashion wear through friends.
6. Maximum number of the respondents are highly satisfied by the Raymond brands.
7. According to the respondents the image of the brand is positive.

SUGGESTION

1. As the consumers know more about the brands mostly from their friends only, the brand should advertise in more attractive way.
2. The company should mainly focus more on the comfort and service of Raymond cloths.

3. Some of the respondents feels that the price of the Raymond is high because the Raymond caters to upper and upper-middle class of urban society.
4. Develop targeted marketing campaigns that emphasize the key features and factors influencing the purchase of Raymond clothes as identified in the study. Highlighting these aspects can reinforce positive perceptions and attract a wider consumer base.
5. Invest in continuous product innovation to align with consumer preferences and stay ahead of market trends. Additionally, maintain a rigorous focus on quality assurance to ensure that products meet or exceed customer expectations.
6. Implement customer engagement initiatives, such as loyalty programs or exclusive events, to foster a stronger connection between consumers and the brand. Building a sense of community and loyalty can contribute to long-term customer satisfaction.

CONCLUSION

This study report is based on the consumer satisfaction towards Raymond brand at Coimbatore city. The main objective of this paper is to study the people, their preference and the satisfaction level. Most of the respondents likes and prefer Raymond brands due to its quality and its brand image. People use Raymond brand because it has social image, and they think that their social status will be enhanced. By this report most of the respondents came to know about the brand by their friends and television. It can be concluded by saying the male customers preferred Raymond cloths because of its better quality.

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EXPLORING CONSUMER PREFERENCES FOR TITAN WATCHES: A COMPREHENSIVE STUDY

Dr. L. A. Razia Fathima, Assistant Professor, Department of Commerce, Kumaraguru College of Liberal Arts and Science, Coimbatore.

Ms. S. Kabila, B. Com PA, Kumaraguru College of Liberal Arts and Science, Coimbatore.

Ms. S. Inu shree, B. Com PA, Kumaraguru College of Liberal Arts and Science, Coimbatore.

ABSTRACT

This research aims to explore the consumer landscape of Titan watches with a focus, on four objectives. Firstly, it seeks to understand how well known and recognized the Titan brand is among consumers giving us an idea of its prominence in the wristwatch market. Secondly, it aims to discover the features and attributes of Titan watches that resonate most with consumers providing insights into what drives their preferences. Thirdly the study aims to examine if pricing impacts consumer choices investigating whether consumers are willing to pay more for models or features. Lastly, it investigates how design, style, and aesthetics influence consumer decisions in favor of Titan watches. By conducting this analysis using a mixed-method approach that includes data from structured questionnaires and qualitative insights, from open-ended responses we hope to gather valuable insights that can guide marketing strategies and product development efforts for Titan in the highly competitive watch industry. Data was collected using a questionnaire method and analysis was done with the help of statistical tools.

KEYWORDS: Consumer preferences, Perceptions, Titan Watches, Brand awareness, Purchasing behaviour.

INTRODUCTION

Watches have turned out to be nearly a need for human beings, irrespective of the economic class they belong to. The watch industry the modern juncture is booming and achieving rapid growth in India. Many new brands with the latest technology have set the market leading to rising competitiveness in the industry. Titan Company Ltd. is an Indian consumer goods company that manufactures fashion add-ons which include watches, jewellery, eyewear, etc. It is a joint venture of Tata Group and TIDCO (Tamil Nadu Industrial Development Corporation) & is taken into consideration as Tata Group's largest consumer company. Titan's diverse brands reflect its wide-reaching presence in all categories, embodying the essence of customer-centric commitment. The main objective of the companies is to meet targeted customers and satisfy satisfied customers, and buyers with the effect of several influences on decision making on market productivity and purchase of products.

This study deals with how individuals, groups, and organizations choose, Buying and using experience and understanding of consumer behaviour to fulfil goods, services, ideas, or their needs and desires is never

easy with a brand reputation. The main idea of the Tata products and services produced in the country will strengthen our economy. By this, the Tata Products supply increases as well as the economy grows higher.

OBJECTIVES

- To Determine the level of brand awareness and recognition among consumers regarding Titan watches.
- To Evaluate the key features and attributes of Titan watches that are most important to consumers.
- To Understand how price influences consumer preferences for Titan watches and whether they are willing to pay a premium for specific models or features.
- To Investigate how the design, style, and aesthetics of Titan watches impact consumer choices.

SCOPE OF THE STUDY

The scope of this study revolves around the preferences of consumers regarding Titan wristwatches. Typically, companies seek insights into customer satisfaction levels and invest significantly in promoting their products. To assess the effectiveness of sales and understand consumer behaviour, a specific survey is conducted. If consumers are dissatisfied, there is a high likelihood they may switch to alternative products, making it challenging to regain their patronage and encourage positive word-of-mouth. The primary objective of this study is to ascertain the satisfaction levels of customers with Titan watches, aiming to enhance knowledge about wristwatches and elevate the brand value in the minds of customers.

REVIEW OF LITERATURE

Sachin Deshmukh(2019) This abstract delves into the complexities of consumer behaviour in marketing, emphasizing the challenge of understanding and satisfying diverse customer needs and desires. It underscores the influence of various factors on purchasing decisions and their impact on market productivity. The abstract also touches on the economic implications of local product and service production. Additionally, it highlights the dynamic nature of buyer behaviour, suggesting that external influences can lead to last-minute changes in decision-making.

Vishal T (2021) The literature outlines Titan Industries as a significant player in the global wristwatch market, ranking fifth worldwide. It is India's leading watch producer, operating under various brand names including Titan, Sonata, and Tanishq for jewellery. The company's diverse product range encompasses contemporary and traditional designs. With manufacturing facilities in multiple Indian locations and exports to over 30 countries, Titan is a prominent subsidiary of the Tata Group, showcasing its substantial presence in both domestic and international markets.

Sanjeevani Sharma, Ankur Undhad, DR. Jay Prakash (2023) The literature highlights the evolving role of wristwatches from utilitarian timekeeping devices to prominent fashion statements. It emphasizes the cultural significance attached to mechanical wristwatches in recent times, contrasting them with digital alternatives like mobile phones and pagers. The timepieces industry encompasses various forms such as wristwatches, desk clocks, alarm clocks, and wall clocks, with wristwatches dominating the market at 89

percent revenue share. The research aims to gauge consumer sentiment towards Titan Watches in Vadodara city, employing a convenient sample of 100 purchasers as primary data sources.

RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

In order to fulfil the objectives of this study, quantitative research was done. The scope of this paper is to recognize the Consumer Preferences for Titan Watches. The study was done by quantitative data through questionnaires. The scrutiny has been done using primary data from the survey of 60 respondents. Secondary Data has been collected from various books, journals and magazines.

DATA ANALYSIS AND INTERPRETATION

Data analysis and interpretation has been processed with percentage tools to exhibit the opinion of the sample regarding the Consumer Preferences.

DEMOGRAPHIC PROFILE OF THE RESPONDENTS

The respondents' demographic profile was analysed and interpreted to better understand them. This includes the Age, gender, and occupation of the respondents.

Table 1- Demographic Profile of the Respondents

S.NO	AGE	NO. OF RESPONDENTS	PERCENTAGE
1	Under 18 years	5	8.3
2	18-25 years	31	51.7
3	26-35 years	16	26.7
4	35-42 years	6	10
5	Above 45	2	3.3
	Total	60	100.0
S.NO	GENDER	NO. OF RESPONDENTS	PERCENTAGE
1	Male	31	51.7
2	Female	29	48.3
	Total	63	100.0
S.NO	OCCUPATION	NO. OF RESPONDENTS	PERCENTAGE
1	Student	30	50
2	Self-Employed	6	10
3	Private Employee	18	20
4	Entrepreneur	6	10
	Total	60	100.0

Source: Primary Data.

The table 1 depicts the demographic profile of the respondents. 51.7 percent of the respondents fall under the age group 18-25 years. A minimum of 3.3 percent of the respondents fall under the age category of

above 45 years. 51.7 percent of the respondents are male and only 48.3 percent of the respondents are female. 50 percent of the respondents are students and 6 percent of respondents are Self Employment and Entrepreneur.

FAMILIARITY WITH TITAN WATCHES

Familiarity and use of Titan Watches among the samples of Coimbatore have been analysed and depicted in the table below.

Table 2: FAMILIARITY WITH TITAN WATCHES

S.NO	OPTIONS	NO. OF RESPONDENTS	PERCENTAGE
1.	Very familiar	34	56.7
2.	Somewhat Familiar	26	43.3
3.	Not Familiar	0	0
	Total	60	100

Source: Primary Data

From the above table, it is clear that 56.7 percent of them are familiar with the brand as well as Titan Watches. Also the table clearly shows that none of the respondents are non-familiar with the Titan Watches.

PREFERENCE AMONG TITAN WATCHES

Understanding consumer preferences is crucial for Titan, a prominent player in the wristwatch industry. This study explores the preferences of consumers towards different categories of Titan watches.

Table 3: PREFERENCE AMONG TITAN WATCHES

S.NO	OPTIONS	NO. OF RESPONDENTS	PERCENTAGE
1.	Casuals	34	56.7
2.	Formal	40	66.7
3.	Smartwatches	18	30
4.	Sports	4	6.7
	Total	60	100

Source: Primary Data

From the above table, 66.7 percent of respondents prefer Formal Titan wristwatches. A minimal 6.7 percent of people prefer sports watches.

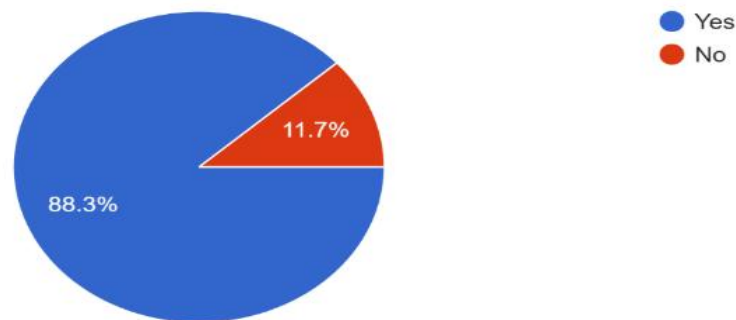
PURCHASE LEVEL OF THE WATCHES

Consumer purchasing behaviour is a critical indicator of market demand and brand preference. This study examines the purchase levels of Titan watches among consumers based on primary data collected.

Chart 4: PURCHASE LEVEL

Have you ever purchased a Titan watch?

60 responses



Source: Primary Data

The above charts show that 88.3 percent of the respondents purchased the wrist watches and a minimal 11.7 Percent of respondents they don't prefer to purchase.

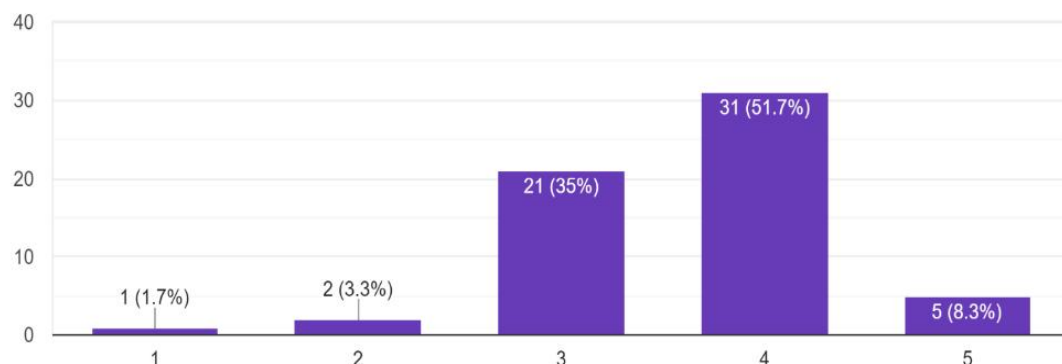
SATISFACTION LEVEL OF RESPONDENTS

Consumer satisfaction is a crucial metric for evaluating brand performance and customer loyalty. This study analyses the satisfaction levels of respondents with Titan watches based on primary data collected.

Chart 5: SATISFACTION LEVEL

If you own a Titan watch, please rate your overall satisfaction on a scale?

60 responses



Source: Primary Data

From the above chart, it is known that 51.7 percent of people rate 4 on the scale of 5 for overall satisfaction of the product.

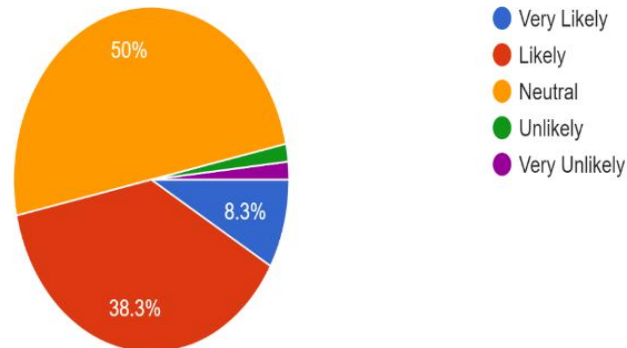
FUTURE PURCHASE

Anticipating future consumer behaviour is crucial for brands like Titan to strategize effectively and maintain market relevance. This study examines the future purchase intentions of respondents towards Titan watches based on primary data collected.

Chart 6: Future Purchase

How likely are you to consider purchasing another Titan watch in the future?

60 responses

**Source: Primary Data**

From the above chart, it is known that 8.3 percent of people consider purchasing the product for sure, 38.3 percent of people are likely to purchase the product and 50 percent of people may purchase the product in the future.

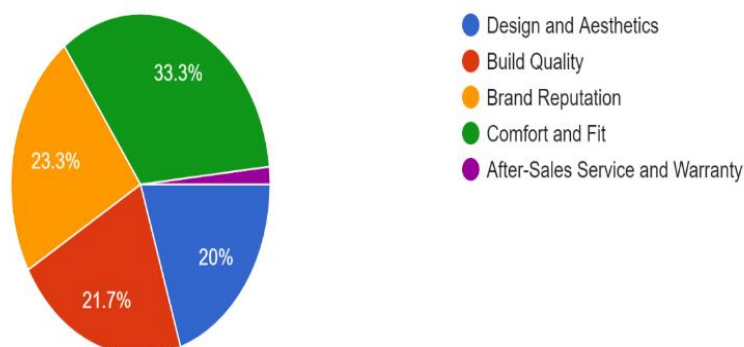
ASPECTS OF SATISFACTION LEVEL

Consumer satisfaction is intricately linked to various aspects of product performance and brand perception. This study examines the key aspects that contribute to the satisfaction level of respondents with Titan watches based on primary data collected.

Chart 8: Aspects

What aspects of the Titan watch you own do you find most satisfying?

60 responses

**Source: Primary Data**

From the above chart it is known that the satisfaction level is 33.3 percent from comfort and fit, 23.3 percent from the brand reputation, 21.7 percent from the quality, and 20 percent from the design and aesthetics of the product.

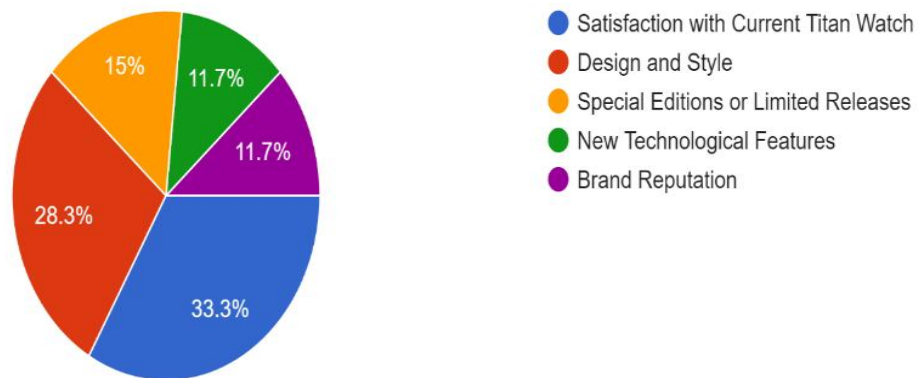
FACTORS INFLUENCE THE BUYER TO BUY IN THE NEAR FUTURE

Understanding the factors that drive consumer purchase decisions is essential for brands to effectively target and engage their audience. This study explores the key factors that influence buyers to consider purchasing products in the near future, drawing insights from general consumer behaviour and market trends.

Chart 9: Factors Influence

What factors would influence your decision to purchase another Titan watch in the future?

60 responses



Source: Primary Data

From the above chart it is known that the factors influencing to purchase titan watches in future can be 33.3 percent of current satisfaction provided by the company, 28.3 percent from design and style being provided, 11.7 percent from brand reputation and new technology features and 15 percent from special editions and limited releases produced.

FINDINGS

- The majority of participants in the "18-25" age group expressed a preference for owning and using Titan wristwatches.
- The primary sources through which the highest number of respondents learn about Titan watches are highly content with the brand, especially its design.
- Respondents perceive the brand's image as positive, based on their feedback.
- 60 percent of respondents are satisfied with their current Titan watch. This suggests that Titan watches are generally well-regarded by their customers.

- The top three factors that influenced respondents' decision to purchase a Titan watch were design and style (33.3 percent), brand reputation (25.0 percent), and special editions or limited releases (11.7 percent). This suggests that Titan's focus on design and branding is resonating with consumers.
- 68.3 percent of respondents are likely to consider purchasing another Titan watch in the future. This suggests that Titan is successfully building customer loyalty.

SUGGESTION

- Tailor marketing strategies to appeal to the "18-25" age group.
- Consider social media campaigns, collaborations, and events aligned with this demographic's interests.
- Optimize and expand channels where respondents learn about Titan watches.
- Invest in content creation emphasizing the brand's design and features.
- Capitalize on positive perceptions by incorporating customer testimonials, reviews, and success stories in marketing materials.
- Prioritize product quality and customer satisfaction, given the 60 percent satisfaction rate.
- Regularly seek feedback and make improvements to maintain and increase overall satisfaction.
- Invest in innovative designs and reinforce the positive brand image.
- Explore collaborations with designers, showcase limited editions, and highlight design stories.
- Implement programs for the 68.3 percent expressing likelihood to purchase another Titan watch.
- Include exclusive offers, early access to new releases, or personalized discounts to encourage repeat purchases and build brand loyalty.

CONCLUSION

The comprehensive study on Titan watches reveals key factors influencing consumer choices in the watch industry. Through a mix of quantitative and qualitative research, the study identifies brand reputation, design aesthetics, functionality, and price as pivotal in shaping preferences. Titan's reputation as a reliable and innovative brand stands out, influencing consumers. Design aesthetics, including style and uniqueness, are crucial, emphasizing the need to align products with fashion trends.

Functionality is highlighted, with consumers valuing watches that offer durability, water resistance, and technological features. Titan's pricing strategy is a key factor, with consumers seeking a balance between quality and affordability. The study suggests that Titan can capitalize on its strengths and address areas for improvement by focusing on quality, innovative design, and competitive pricing to maintain and expand market share. The insights gained are valuable for Titan and the watch industry, offering guidance to adapt to changing consumer preferences, enhance product offerings, and strengthen brand positioning in the dynamic market. Understanding and responding to consumer preferences will be essential for sustained success in the competitive watch manufacturing landscape.

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UNVEILING THE BRAND REVOLUTION WITH AUGMENTED REALITY EXPERIENCES

Dr. N. Sumathy, Professor & Head, Department of Commerce, Kumaraguru College of Liberal Arts and Science, Coimbatore.

Ms. Asha S, Undergraduate Scholar, Department of Commerce, Kumaraguru College of Liberal Arts and Science, Coimbatore.

Ms. Muskan Chandak, Undergraduate Scholar, Department of Commerce, Kumaraguru College of Liberal Arts and Science, Coimbatore.

ABSTRACT

In the ever-evolving landscape of consumer engagement and brand interaction, the integration of Augmented Reality (AR) has emerged as a revolutionary force, redefining how businesses connect with their audiences. This paper delves into the profound changes Augmented Reality (AR) experiences bring to brand engagement, aiming to uncover their impact on consumer perception. This study also conducts a comparative analysis with traditional marketing methods and AR experiences. This paper focuses on assessing user experience and satisfaction levels, we delve into the transformative potential of AR in shaping consumer attitudes towards brands. The study addresses the evolving preferences of modern consumers for personalised and interactive content, by exploring how AR changes according to these demands. By analysing user feedback, we assess satisfaction levels and overall experiences, providing valuable insights into how AR shapes positive brand attitudes. The research considers potential challenges and drawbacks associated with AR adoption, offering a comprehensive understanding of its impact on consumer perception. This study contributes to understanding the pivotal role AR plays in the brand revolution by unveiling the distinctive advantages of AR experiences, businesses can strategically leverage this technology to create memorable and impactful brand interactions with consumers.

KEYWORDS: Augmented Reality (AR), consumer engagement, brand engagement, consumer preference.

INTRODUCTION

In the dynamic landscape of modern marketing, brands are constantly seeking innovative ways to captivate audiences and differentiate themselves. One revolutionary avenue that has gained prominence is the integration of augmented reality (AR) experiences into brand strategies. This transformative approach allows businesses to break traditional barriers, offering consumers immersive and interactive encounters that extend beyond conventional marketing channels.

By seamlessly blending digital elements with the physical world, AR opens the door to a myriad of creative possibilities. This introduction sets the stage for a journey into the brand revolution propelled by augmented reality experiences. Through augmented reality experiences consumers can virtually try on products and select the product that best suits them. It is being applied by cosmetics, eyewear and clothing

industry. Augmented Reality also offers product visualization and tours that help in the construction industry. Overall through augmented reality many industries are trying to enhance customer experience.

OBJECTIVES OF THE STUDY

- To investigate how Augmented Reality experience impact consumer perception
- To conduct a comparative analysis between traditional marketing methods and AR experiences
- To assess user experience and satisfaction levels by analyzing feedback

SCOPE OF THE STUDY

Augmented Reality is an interactive experience that combines the real and virtual world. Slowly many companies are using augmented reality as a part of their marketing strategy. The scope of the study will include finding out the impact of augmented reality on customers. The demographic factors of customers are also considered. The study also focuses on the constraints faced by customers including privacy concerns. It also studies which form of advertisement is more effective.

REVIEW OF LITERATURE

Aathira Menon, Shreya Bhagat and Dr. Shakeel Iqbal, in their paper have analysed augmented reality in the fashion retail industry. They have identified the opportunities and challenges of introducing augmented reality in India. They have identified that it enriches customer experience and thereby increases customer loyalty. Primary collection of data was done by circulating questionnaires to people who had experience in online shopping and shopping through physical stores and a chi square test was conducted to test the hypothesis.

Pragya Jayaswal and Biswajita Parida, explores the landscape of Augmented Reality Marketing (ARM) through a mixed methods approach. Key findings include performance indicators, social and conceptual structures, evolution of ARM research, emerging trends, current hotspots, and future research directions. While acknowledging database limitations, the study offers valuable insights for AR developers and brand managers to inform strategic decisions in the evolving ARM landscape. The unique integration of methods contributes to a comprehensive understanding of this technology-led marketing field, marking a significant advancement in ARM scholarship.

RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

This study includes primary data as well as secondary data. For primary data, samples were gathered from respondents with the help of structured questionnaire. The samples were collected from 60 respondents who are consumers. For secondary data, information available in articles, papers and journals were used.

DATA ANALYSIS AND INTERPRETATION

The data has been collected from 60 respondents through a structured questionnaire and has been analysed using the percentage tool and has been interpreted below.

DEMOGRAPHIC PROFILE OF RESPONDENTS

Demographic profile of respondents is a description of their demographic background, and it plays an important role in understanding the respondents. Demographic variables in this study include age, gender, and educational qualification.

Table 1 - (i) Demographic Profile of Respondents basis Age Group

Age Group	No. of Respondents	Percentage
15-30	47	78.3
31-45	5	8.3
46-60	6	10
60 and above	2	3.3
Total	60	100

Table 1 -(ii) Demographic Profile of Respondents basis Gender

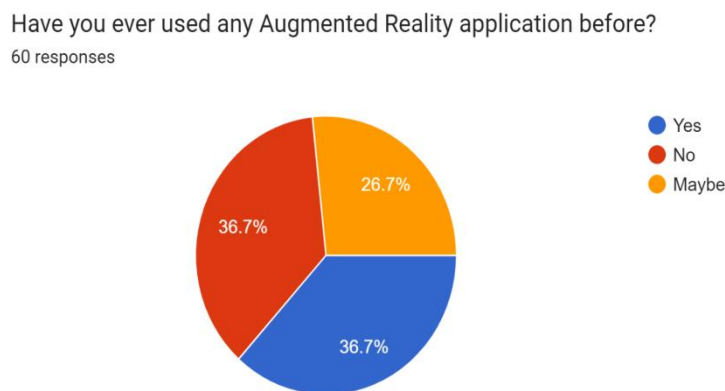
Gender	No. of Respondents	Percentage
Male	24	40
Female	35	58.3
Prefer not to say	1	1.7
Total	60	100

Table 1 - (iii) Demographic Profile of Respondents basis Educational Qualification

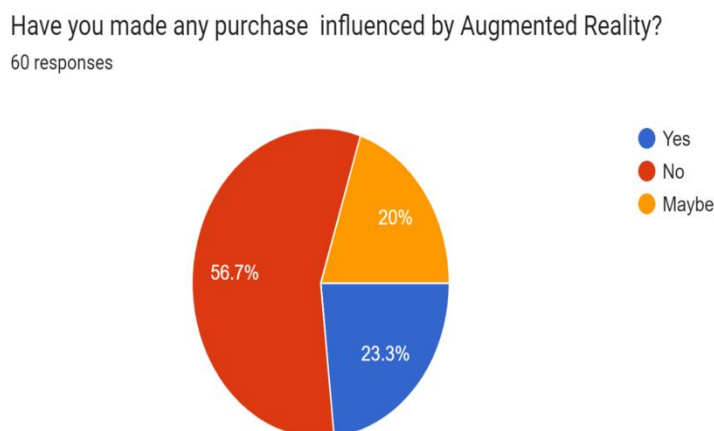
Educational Qualification	No. of Respondents	Percentage
12th grade or less	2	3.3
Undergraduate	39	65
Postgraduate	11	18.3
Others	8	13.3
Total	60	100

Source: Primary Data

From the above tables, it can be inferred that 78.3 percent of the respondents are under the age group 15-30. This data reveals that people belonging to this age group are aware about augmented reality earlier. There are 35 female respondents which implies that they have used augmented reality more compared to the male respondents. Further, 65 percent of the respondents' educational qualification is undergraduate which shows their interest in augmented reality.

RESULTS AND DISCUSSION**Exhibit 1 - Use of Augmented Reality****Source: Primary Data**

From the above chart it is evident that 36.7 percent of the respondents have used augmented reality earlier and the same percent have not used augmented reality. However, 26.7 percent of the respondents may have used augmented reality, either they do not recall it or they may have used it without knowing that it is AR.

Exhibit 2 - Impact of Augmented Reality**Source: Primary Data**

From the above chart it can be seen that 56.7 percent of the respondents feel that their purchase is not influenced by augmented reality offered by a brand, which implies that they consider other factors as well while purchasing a product. However, 23.3 percent of the respondents feel that they have been influenced by augmented reality to purchase a product. Further, 20 percent of the respondents feel that it may have an impact on their purchase.

Table 2 - Enhancing Buying Experience

Response	No. of Respondents	Percentage
Yes	28	46.7
No	10	16.7
Maybe	22	36.7
Total	60	100

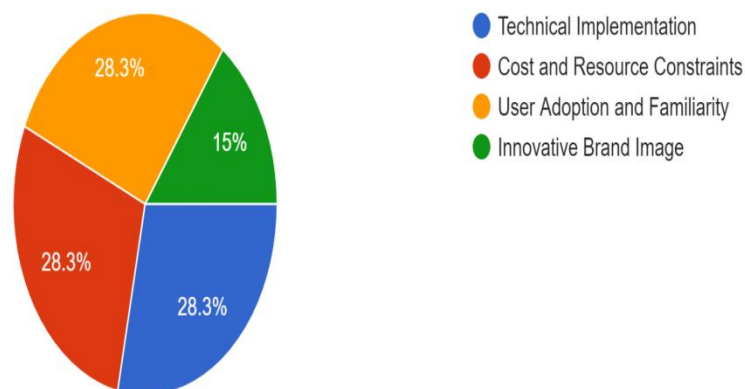
Source: Primary Data

From the above table it can be observed that 46.7 percent of the respondents feel that augmented reality can enhance their buying experience. While 36.7 percent feel that it may have an impact about 16.7 percent of the respondents find that augmented reality does not improve their buying experience.

Exhibit 3 - Challenges faced by Brands in adopting AR

Among the following what challenges arise for brands in adopting augmented reality experiences?

60 responses



Source: Primary Data

From the above chart it is observed that the main challenges for brands in adopting AR Experiences are user adoption and familiarity, cost and resource constraints and technical implementation followed by the

innovative brand image. The respondents have opted equally for the first three choices with 28.3 percent and followed by 15 percent for the last one.

Table 3 - Privacy Concerns

Response	No. of Respondents	Percentage
Yes	11	19
No	22	37.9
Maybe	25	43.1
Total	58	100

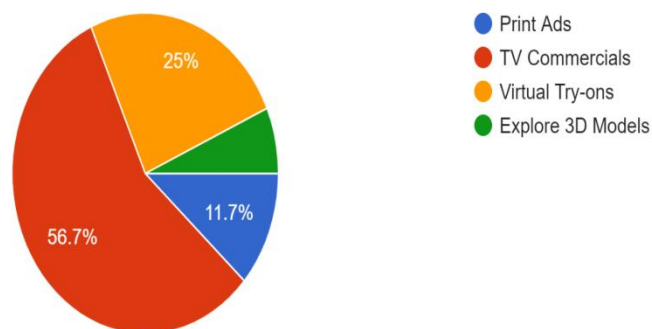
Source: Primary Data

From the above table it can be seen that while 43.1 percent of the respondents have responded that there may be privacy concerns due to augmented reality, 37.9 percent of the respondents do not find any threat to their privacy. However, 19 percent of the respondents are concerned about privacy due to augmented reality.

Exhibit 4 - The most Impactful Form of Marketing

Among the following, which form of marketing are you more likely to recall a brand?

60 responses



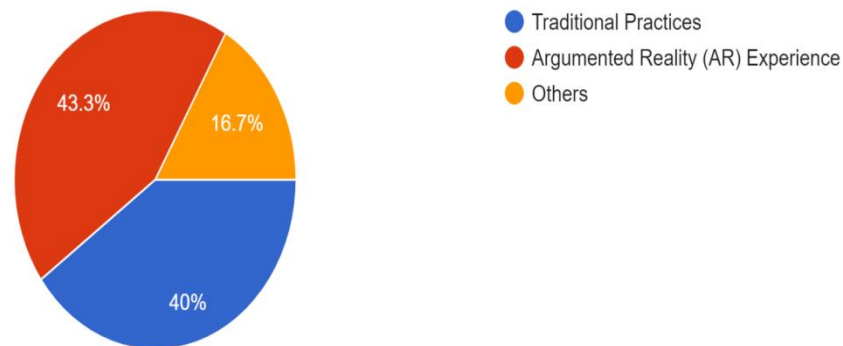
Source: Primary Data

From the above chart it can be observed that TV commercials have the most impact on the respondents as they are able to recall a brand, which is one of the major objectives of marketing. It is followed by virtual try-ons with 25 percent of the respondents feeling they can recall a brand based on virtual try-ons. Print Ads and 3D Models are recalled by 11.7 percent and 6.7 percent respondents which implies it has comparatively lesser impact.

Exhibit 5 - Traditional Practices or Augmented Reality Experience

Which of the following will provide you with more satisfaction as a customer?

60 responses

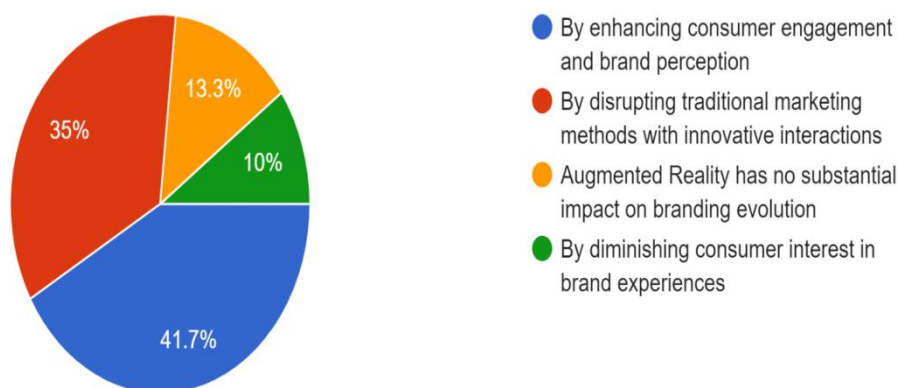
**Source: Primary Data**

From the above chart it is observed that consumers are most satisfied with augmented reality compared to the traditional practices, with 43.3 percent of respondents for Augmented Reality followed by 40 percent supporting Traditional Practices and 16.7 percent are satisfied with other technologies.

Exhibit 6 - Augmented Reality Revolutionizing Branding

How do augmented reality experiences contribute to ongoing revolution in branding?

60 responses

**Source: Primary Data**

From the above chart, it is observed that the respondents have opted the first option - By enhancing consumer engagement and brand perception as the contribution of AR Experiences towards the ongoing revolution in branding. Followed by - By disrupting traditional marketing methods with innovative

interactions with 35 percent, then option 3 - AR has no substantial impact on branding evolution with 13.3 percent and 10 percent for - By diminishing consumer interest in brand experiences.

Table 4 - AR impact on consumer loyalty

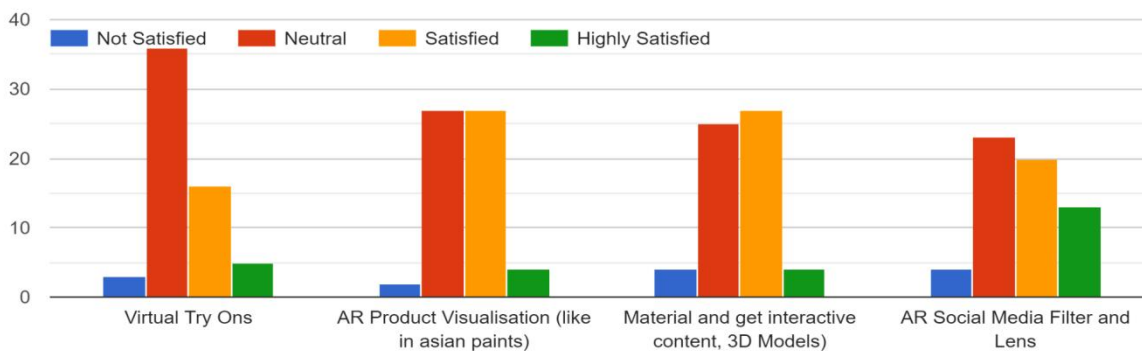
Response	No. of Respondents	Percentage
Yes	29	48.3
No	23	13.3
Maybe	8	38.3
Total	60	99.9

Source: Primary Data

From the above table it can be observed that 48.3 percent of the respondents have agreed that AR Experiences have an impact on consumer loyalty whereas 38.3 percent of the respondents have said that there may be a chance that AR Experiences have an impact on the consumer loyalty. Followed by 13.3 percent respondents who did not agree with the point.

Exhibit 7 - Augmented Reality Tools

Rate the following Augmented Reality tool based on your satisfaction.



Source: Primary Data

From the above bar chart, it can be observed that in the case of virtual try-ons about 36 respondents are neutral about their satisfaction from experiencing it. However about 16 of them are satisfied with it and 5 respondents are highly satisfied with virtual try-ons. A very small percentage of respondents are not satisfied with virtual try-ons.

In case of AR Product Visualisation maximum respondents are either neutral or are satisfied with it. Further 4 of them have found AR Product Visualisation highly satisfactory. 2 respondents are not satisfied with it.

3D models have provided a satisfying experience to maximum respondents and about 25 respondents are neutral about the same. Further, an equal number of respondents have found it either highly satisfying or are dissatisfied by the experience.

In AR social media Filter and Lens, it can be observed that most respondents are neutral about the same. However, a huge number of them are satisfied and highly satisfied from it. Only about 4 respondents are dissatisfied by it.

Overall, the respondents are highly satisfied from AR social media Filter and Lens, satisfied the most from 3D models and are neutral about virtual try-ons.

FINDINGS AND RECOMMENDATIONS

Based on the comprehensive analysis of the survey data, several key insights and trends emerge, shedding light on the adoption and perception of Augmented Reality Experiences , their impact, and users' preferences. The following recommendations and conclusions can be drawn:

- With 36.7 percent of the respondents who have used augmented reality and the same percentage who has not used it earlier, there is a great potential which has not been exploited. Brands should use it more and create an awareness about the same.
- It is found that 56.7 percent of the respondents have not made any purchase influenced by augmented reality experiences. It is a huge percentage hence brands must find out the reason for the same. They must understand customer preferences and continuously gather feedback from customers to improve. It is also seen that 20 percent of the respondents are not sure so they need to be educated regarding the same.
- With 46.7 percent of the respondents feeling that augmented reality enhances buyer experience, it needs to be used in a positive way and convert into sales. Ensure AR features are updated frequently, provide more personalised services. It is also observed that 16.7 percent of the respondents feel that it does not enhance their experience, address their concerns.
- It is found that 28.3 percent each of the respondents find that technical implementation, cost and resource constraints and user adoption and familiarity are the major concerns that may arise for brands in implementing augmented reality. Brands must invest in employee training, contact with tech experts and have various tests before it is launched. For cost constraints, consider prioritising AR features that are most important and are budget friendly. Also consider partnership and collaborations to share the cost with other brands. To enhance user adoption, user friendly features along with proper training must be launched.
- There is a positive sign that 43.1 percent of the respondents do not feel threatened by the privacy concerns due to augmented reality. However, 19 percent of them are concerned about it. Brands must clearly communicate their privacy policies, anonymize and secure the data and update protocols regularly.

- 56.7 percent of the respondents have admitted that they can recall a brand by seeing it on a TV commercial. Only about 25 percent can recall due to virtual try-ons. Therefore, virtual try on should be integrated with TV commercials. On TV commercials, the virtual try on feature of a brand must be promoted and it should continuously enhance its features.
- 43.3 percent of the customers have responded that they find augmented reality practices more satisfying than traditional practices. So this should be exploited in full. Further traditional practices must be modernised with changing customer needs. Set benchmarks for AR within or outside the organisation and continuously strive to innovate.
- 41.7 percent of the respondents feel that augmented reality can play a major role in enhancing customer experience. However, 13.3 percent feel that AR has no impact and 10 percent also feel that it diminishes customer interest and brand experience. Address their concerns and regularly refresh and diversify AR content to maintain excitement and curiosity. Gather continuous feedback and work on consumer preference.
- While 48.3 percent of the respondents feel that augmented reality can increase brand loyalty, 13.3 percent of them believe otherwise. Their concerns can be addressed by providing clearly the value propositions of augmented reality to them and seamlessly integrating it with overall brand experience.
- The respondents are highly satisfied from AR Social Media Filter and Lens, satisfied the most from 3D models and are neutral about virtual try-ons. However, with AR Product visualisation respondents are majorly either neutral or are satisfied with it. To address the neutrality of virtual try-ons, brands need to improve it further and diversify it. In case of AR Product visualisation brand needs to continue to refine what it is doing and address the issue of the 2 respondents who are dissatisfied. In case of 3D Models, monitor feedback areas for improvement and figure out the features that customers desire. Capitalise on the high satisfaction respondents derive from AR Social media filters and lenses. Overall use success stories or testimonials to build confidence among potential users and collaborate with other users and build a community with them.

CONCLUSION

In conclusion, this study underscores the transformative influence of Augmented Reality (AR) experiences on brand engagement in the dynamic landscape of consumer interaction. The comparative analysis with traditional marketing methods reveals the revolutionary potential of AR in reshaping how businesses connect with their audiences. This survey has uncovered valuable insights into the way individuals perceive and engage with Augmented Reality (AR) experiences revealing the transformative potential AR holds for reshaping brand interactions and fostering innovation in consumer engagement.

The results suggest a growing acceptance and potential for AR in influencing consumer behaviour and shaping positive brand attitudes, while also indicating the need for addressing challenges such as privacy

concerns and enhancing user experiences. Brands can strategically leverage the positive aspects of AR to revolutionise their engagement strategies, staying attuned to consumer preferences and continuously improving AR implementations.

While challenges such as user adoption, cost constraints, and technical implementation emerge, they are outweighed by the positive sentiments expressed by respondents regarding the influence of AR on purchasing decisions, buying experiences, and overall consumer satisfaction.

In essence, "Unveiling the Brand Revolution with Augmented Reality Experiences" concludes that AR is not merely a technological tool but a dynamic catalyst for brands to create memorable, interactive, and personalised interactions with consumers. As businesses navigate this transformative landscape, strategic integration of AR can unlock new dimensions in brand communication, fostering a paradigm shift in how consumers perceive and engage with brands in the modern era.

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**CUSTOMER SATISFACTION AS A KEY DRIVER OF SREE ANNAPOORNA
GOWRISHANKAR'S SUCCESS IN THE COMPETITIVE HOTEL INDUSTRY**

Dr. N. Sridevi, Assistant Professor, Department of Commerce, Kumaraguru College of Liberal Arts and Science, Coimbatore.

Ms. Aishwarya G, B. Com PA, Department of Commerce, Kumaraguru College of Liberal Arts and Science, Coimbatore.

ABSTRACT

Sree Annapoorna Gowrishankar has acknowledged the importance of customer happiness as a vital aspect in their successes. Customer satisfaction is a crucial component for success in the fiercely competitive hotel sector. The capacity to constantly meet and surpass customer expectations has emerged as a competitive advantage in a market where several hotels compete for the attention of discriminating clients. This abstract examines how important customer satisfaction was to Sree Annapoorna Gowrishankar's successes in the cutthroat hotel business. In the competitive hotel market, Sree Annapoorna Gowrishankar's success rests largely on its ability to satisfy customers. The hotel has been able to draw in, keep, and please customers because it recognizes the importance of meeting and exceeding their expectations. This has led to a devoted clientele, good word-of-mouth, and a competitive advantage. Sree Annapoorna Gowrishankar's dedication to client satisfaction has always been a major factor in the company's success and expansion in a market where consumer preferences and needs are always changing.

KEYWORDS: Customers Satisfaction, Sree Annapoorna Gowrishankar, Hotel Industry.

INTRODUCTION

One of the most well-known hospitality companies is Annapoorna Hotels, which is recognized for its outstanding lodging and eating options. Annapoorna Hotels has established a reputable name in the market by committing to offering cosy and reasonable accommodations. A strong brand management approach is the cornerstone of Annapoorna Hotels' success. The brand has built a solid following and a dedicated consumer base via careful planning and execution. Let's explore the main tenets of Annapoorna Hotels' brand management strategy. The first thing that distinguishes Annapoorna Hotels from other hotels is the distinctive brand identity it has created. The logo's eye-catching design, thoughtful colour scheme, and consistent typographic style all reflect its identity. With the help of these components, a unified and recognizable brand image that appeals to consumers is produced.

REVIEW OF LITERATURE

Dr. M. Kalimuthu (2018) in his article says that based on their level of satisfaction with reference, the aim of this study is to determine the demands and views of hotel customers. Coimbatore's Sree Annapoorna Sree Gowrishankar hotel chain. The level of customer satisfaction among the respondents has been compared and contrasted in many ways. The success of hoteliers depends on whether the hotel's

features met or exceeded guests' expectations. The Sree Annapoorna Sree Gowrishankar Group of hotels in Coimbatore then gained recognition.

Dr. M. KALIMUTHU, Dr. S .SIVARAMAN (2020) says that with respect to the Sree Annapoorna Shree Gowrishankar group of hotels in Coimbatore, the study has discussed multiple variations in customer satisfaction levels to discover the demands and perceptions of hotel guests based on their degree of satisfaction. Overall, the data analysis shown that the findings were accurate and provided a good indication of sampling efficiency. In order to attract and keep clients, hoteliers must develop successful marketing techniques that satisfy them on the first visit.

ANNAPOORNA'S TACTICS

- Annapoorna restaurant has taken a competitive position in the market by using its brand identity. The brand effectively communicated its value proposition by determining its unique selling propositions and target market.
- In order to ensure that visitors can enjoy special moments throughout their stay, Annapoorna restaurant takes pride in providing not just cosy lodgings but also a pleasant dining experience.
- Customer experience is key to brand management. A priority for Annapoorna restaurant is providing outstanding customer service and maintaining spotless amenities. Customers can rely on and refer others to the business because of its dedication to cleanliness, helpful employees, and an inviting environment.
- Annapoorna restaurant includes its marketing and advertising initiatives. The company uses a variety of tactics, including traditional advertising channels, digital marketing initiatives, and a strong social media presence, to reach its target demographic.
- By collaborating with tour operators and internet booking services, Annapoorna restaurants guarantees the highest level of accessibility and visibility to potential customers.
- Annapoorna restaurant also makes investments in extensive employee training programmes. The brand makes sure that the customer experience is similar across all of its sites by providing workers with the required training, education, and in-depth awareness of the brand values.

MARKET PROFILE TOWARDS OBJECTIVE SECTOR

- According to the restaurant's survey of its clients, particularly young professionals and families from the business community, there has been positive growth and tendency development in the area of international tourism.
- As a result, the Hotel Annapoorna's core target segment market consists of both domestic and foreign leisure and business travelers seeking top end hotel services.
- Similar to this, Hotel sree Annapoorna gowrishankar targets reputable corporate houses for holding events, meetings, and training programmes with its banquet and meeting facilities.

- Last but not least, upper-class families and nationalities who seek for luxury hotels and banquet services make up its target market based on lifestyle.
- Considering everything, Hotel Annapoorna presents itself as a premium brand, much like its target market.

ANNAPOORNA DEALT WITH THE FOLLOWING ISSUES

INCREASING COMPETITION

- The close competition in the hospitality sector is one of the main challenges Annapoorna Hotels faces in managing its brand. Customers have a wide range of options because new hotels and lodging options are always developing. By highlighting its distinct value offering and providing great guest experiences, Annapoorna Hotels can set itself apart from the competition.

ADAPTING TO CHANGING CONSUMER TASTES

In the hotel industry, customer expectations and tastes are constantly changing. Today's visitors demand individualized service, practicality, sustainability, and technological integration. In order to stay current with these shifting preferences, Annapoorna Hotels must modify the services and products offered under its brand. The business can adapt to the changing demands of its target audience by incorporating eco-friendly practices, adopting emerging technologies, and offering personalized experiences.

EMPLOYER BRAND ALIGNMENT AND TRAINING

Brand management includes internal stakeholders in addition to external ones. Making sure that its staff members at all levels adhere to the brand's values, vision, and service standards is a challenge for Annapoorna Hotels. Using employees as brand ambassadors can greatly improve consumer loyalty and happiness.

MAINTAINING CONSISTENCY

Annapoorna Hotels manages a number of properties in several cities, which can make keeping a consistent brand difficult. Building a strong and memorable brand identity requires consistency across all branding aspects, including the logo, design, service standards, and overall visitor experience. Nevertheless, keeping uniformity across all sites can be difficult, particularly when it comes to providing the same level of quality and service throughout several locations. These are some main issues that Annapoorna have.

OBJECTIVES

- To identify the consumers satisfaction level towards Annapoorna Products.
- To know the consumers perception on Annapoorna.
- To know the issues and problems faced by the customers that needs to be solved.

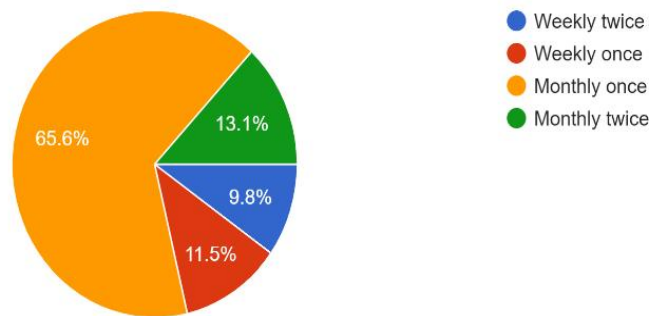
DATA ANALYSIS AND INTERPRETATION

Analyzing and interpreting customer satisfaction data can provide valuable insights into the success of a business-like Sree Annapoorna Gowrishankar in the competitive hotel industry.

FREQUENCY OF PURCHASE OF ANNAPOORNA PRODUCTS

The pie chart shows how often people purchase Annapoorna Products. The survey question was “How often do you purchase Annapoorna Products?”

How often do you purchase Annapoorna products?
61 responses



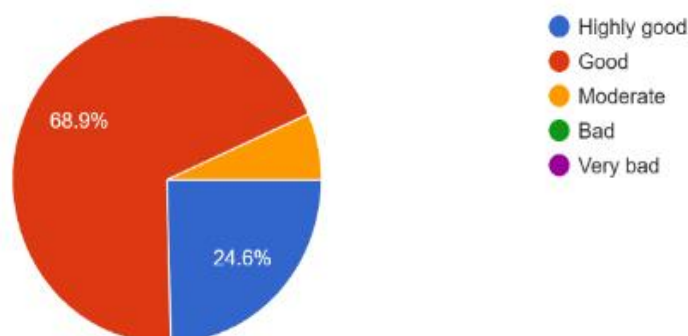
Source: Primary Data.

The majority of respondents purchasing Annapoorna items on a weekly basis, with 65.6 percent buying twice a week and 13.1 percent buying once a week. Monthly purchases are less common, with 11.5 percent purchasing twice a month and 9.8 percent purchasing once a month. Overall, the research reveals that Annapoorna clients have a high preference for weekly purchases.

QUALITY OF ANNA POORNA PRODUCTS

The chart depicts the quality of Annapoorna products as opined by the respondents of the study on the five point scaling as Highly Good to Very Bad based on their own experiences.

How would you rate quality of Annapoorna products?
61 responses



Source: Primary Data.

It shows a significant positive view of Annapoorna's product quality, with 68.9 percent ranking it as "highly good." This indicates that the brand has earned a reputation for expertise in this area. While 24.6

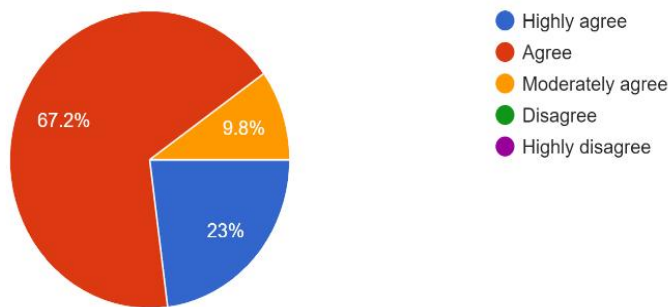
percent believe the quality is moderate, just a very small minority of 6.5 percent disagree. Overall, the data shows that Annapoorna's quality standards are well-regarded by its clients.

PERCEPTION OF ANNAPOORNA BRAND

The pie chart shows how people perceive the Annapoorna brand based on a survey question: "How do you perceive the Annapoorna brand?"

How do you perceive the Annapoorna brand?

61 responses



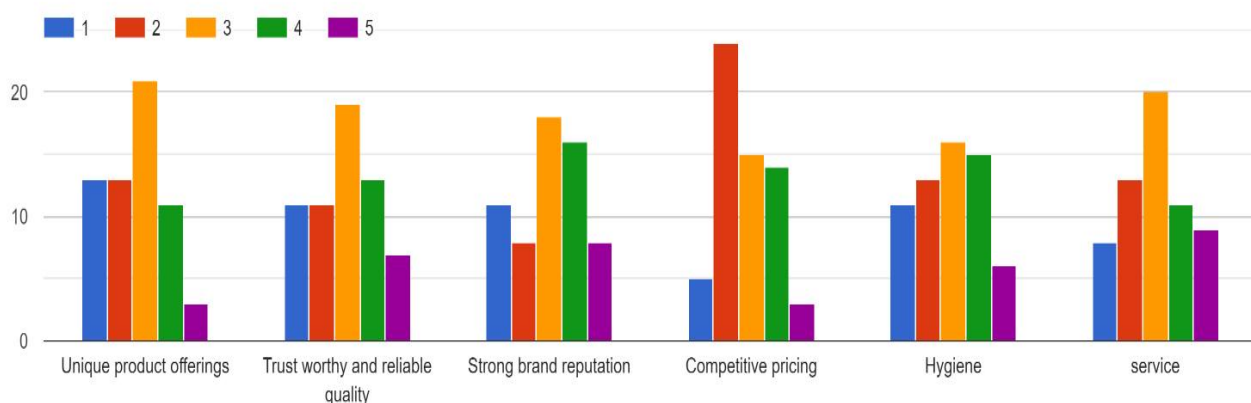
Source: Primary Data

The work shows that the Annapoorna brand has a very positive perception, with 67.2 percent of respondents strongly agreeing. This indicates that the brand has successfully established a positive image and reputation among its target demographics. While 9.8 percent agree moderately, a total of 23 percent disagree to varied degrees, showing areas for potential improvement in brand impression.

ANNAPOORNA BRAND UNIQUENESS FROM ITS COMPETITORS

The brand uniqueness of Annapoorna among its competitors are measured based on various factors and have been analysed in the table below.

How does the Annapoorna brand stand out from its competitors?



Source: Primary Data.

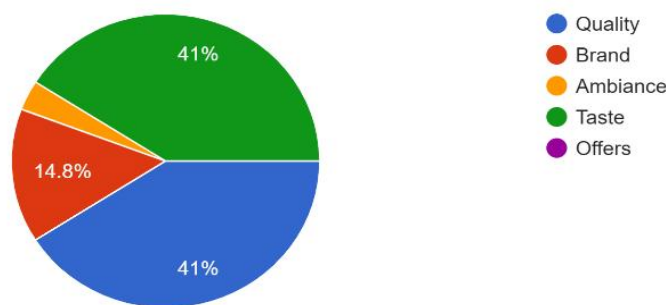
The bar chart evaluates the Annapoorna brand against its competitors on six different aspects: unique product offerings, trustworthy and reliable quality, strong brand reputation, competitive pricing, hygiene, and service. Each aspect is rated on a scale of 1 to 5, where 1 is the lowest and 5 is the highest. Annapoorna seems to be moderately competitive in terms of product offerings, pricing, and service, with opportunities for improvement in these areas. It is viewed positively for its hygiene standards and brand reputation, though not overwhelmingly so. Trustworthiness and reliability are perceived reasonably well, though there is still significant room for enhancement.

REASON TO PREFER ANNAPOORNA

The pie chart illustrates the reasons why respondents prefer the Annapoorna brand. The survey gathered 61 responses, breaking down the preference into five categories: Quality, Brand, Ambiance, Taste, and Offers. Each segment of the pie chart represents the proportion of respondents who selected each reason.

Why do you prefer Annapoorna?

61 responses



Source: Primary Data.

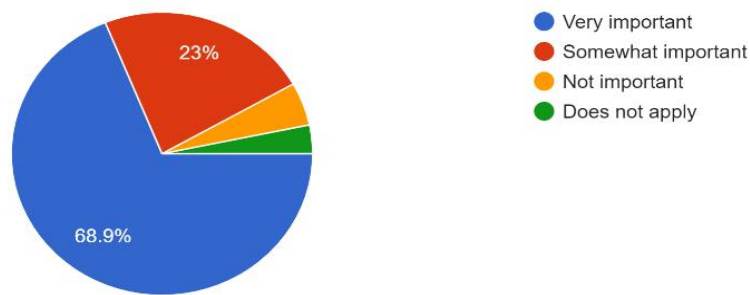
Quality is stated as the most important factor for preferring Annapoorna by 41 percent of respondents. Brand, ambiance, and flavour all have significant attraction, accounting for a large portion of the remaining preference. Offers had a smaller impact, persuading only 14.8 percent of respondents. Annapoorna's strong focus on quality and taste is clearly paying off, as these are the top reasons why customers choose the brand. However, to further differentiate itself from competitors and enhance customer satisfaction, Annapoorna might consider focusing on brand loyalty strategies and enhancing the in-store experience and promotional offerings.

PACKING AND DESIGN OF ANNAPOORNA PRODUCTS

The pie chart assesses the importance of packaging and design of Annapoorna products in the purchasing decisions of 61 respondents. The chart breaks down the responses into four categories: Very important, Somewhat important, Not important, and Does not apply.

How important is the packing and design of Annapoorna products in your purchasing decision?

61 responses



Source: Primary Data.

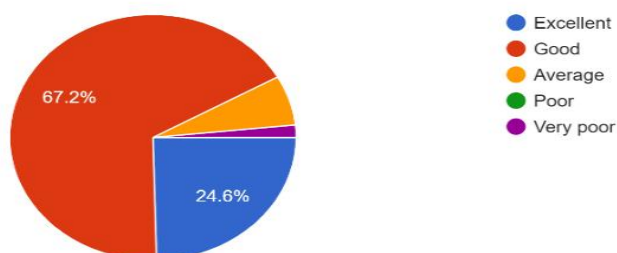
The packaging and design of Annapoorna items are very essential to 68.9 percent of respondents in their purchasing decisions. This emphasises the importance of visual attractiveness and presentation in influencing customer choices. While 23 percent believe these characteristics are somewhat important, only 8.1 percent believe they are not significant. This highlights the importance of Annapoorna continuing to invest in visually appealing and well-designed packaging in order to keep its competitive edge.

RATING THE CUSTOMER SERVICE PROVIDED BY ANNAPOORNA

Customer service is a vital aspect of any business, significantly influencing customer satisfaction and brand loyalty. For Annapoorna, understanding how customers perceive their service quality can provide valuable insights into areas of strength and opportunities for improvement. This analysis aims to evaluate customer ratings of Annapoorna's service, highlighting the effectiveness of their interactions, responsiveness, and overall customer experience.

How do you rate the customer service provided by Annapoorna?

61 responses



Source: Primary Data.

Annapoorna's customer service is an obvious strength, with 67.2 percent of respondents ranking it as excellent or good. This indicates that customers are very satisfied with the company's contacts with them. However, 24.6 percent rate the service as average or below average, indicating that there is space for

development in this area. Overall, the data reveals a mainly positive customer service experience, but it also identifies possible areas for improvement.

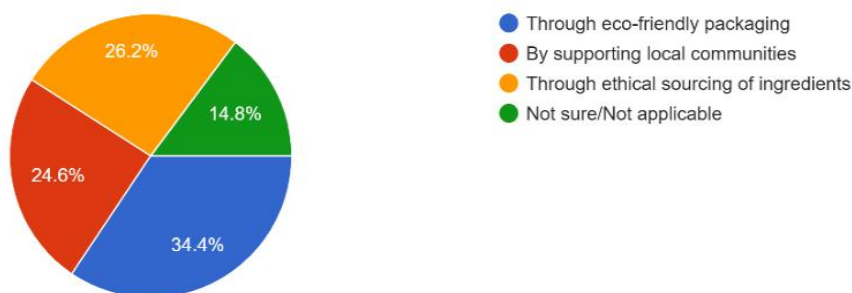
ANNAPOORNA'S COMMITMENT TO SUSTAINABILITY AND SOCIAL RESPONSIBILITY

In today's rapidly evolving market, companies are increasingly expected to take an active role in sustainability and social responsibility. Annapoorna is committed to these values, striving to make a positive impact on the environment and society. This commitment is reflected in their business practices, product offerings, and community engagements.

Annapoorna recognizes the importance of sustainable practices in preserving natural resources and ensuring the well-being of future generations. By prioritizing eco-friendly initiatives, such as reducing waste, sourcing responsibly, and minimizing their carbon footprint, Annapoorna demonstrates a genuine dedication to environmental stewardship.

How does Annapoorna demonstrate its commitment to sustainability and social responsibility?

61 responses



Source: Primary Data.

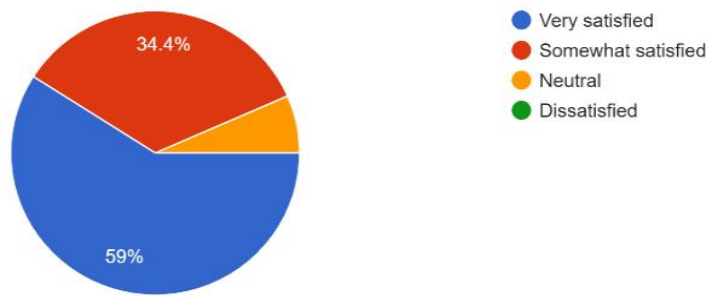
There are several ways that Annapoorna shows its dedication to sustainability and social responsibility, but the most well-known strategy is eco-friendly packaging, which was mentioned by 34.4 percent of respondents. Rewarding regional communities and procuring ingredients ethically are noteworthy endeavour, as acknowledged by 26.2 percent of participants. Nonetheless, a sizeable percentage, 24.6 percent, either do not think Annapoorna's efforts in this area are relevant or are unaware of them. This implies possible avenues for additional communication and improvement of these projects.

SATISFACTION TOWARDS ANNAPOORNA

Customer satisfaction is a crucial indicator of a brand's success and reputation. For Annapoorna, gauging customer satisfaction levels provides insights into how well their products, services, and overall brand experience meet customer expectations. Understanding these perceptions helps Annapoorna to maintain high standards and identify areas for enhancement, ensuring a loyal and content customer base.

Overall, how satisfied are you with Annapoorna as a brand?

61 responses



Source: Primary Data.

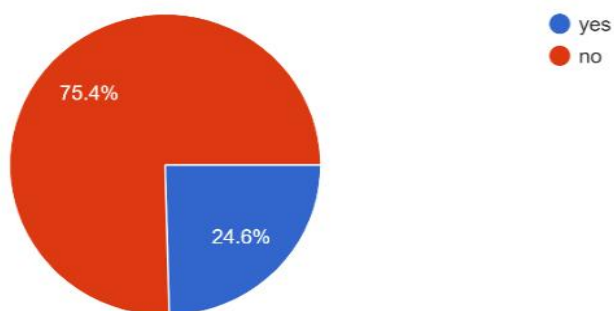
59 percent of respondents were very satisfied with Annapoorna as a brand. 34.4 percent of respondents were somewhat satisfied with Annapoorna as a brand. A small percentage of respondents were neutral or dissatisfied with Annapoorna as a brand. A majority of respondents are satisfied with Annapoorna as a brand.

USE OF DISCOUNTS AND SPECIAL OFFERS

In a competitive market, discounts and special offers play a significant role in attracting and retaining customers. For Annapoorna, implementing effective discount strategies and special promotions can boost sales, enhance customer loyalty, and differentiate the brand from its competitors. Understanding the impact and customer response to these offers helps Annapoorna optimize their promotional tactics for maximum benefit.

Did you use any discounts or special offers?

61 responses



Source: Primary Data.

The majority of respondents, 75.4 percent, did not use any discounts or special offers. This suggests that either the respondents were not aware of the discounts or offers, or they did not find them to be appealing.

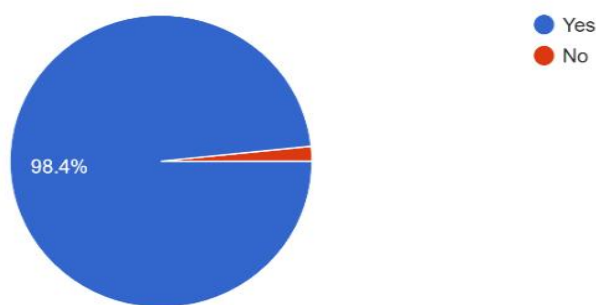
The remaining 24.6 percent of respondents did use discounts or special offers. This suggests that there is a segment of Annapoorna's customers who are responsive to discounts and promotions.

COMFORT AND CLEAN DINNING AREA

The dining environment is a pivotal aspect of the customer experience, especially for food and beverage establishments. For Annapoorna, ensuring a comfortable and clean dining area is essential in providing a pleasant and welcoming atmosphere that encourages customers to dine in and return. A well-maintained dining space not only reflects the brand's commitment to quality and hygiene but also significantly enhances the overall dining experience.

Was your dining area comfortable and clean?

61 responses



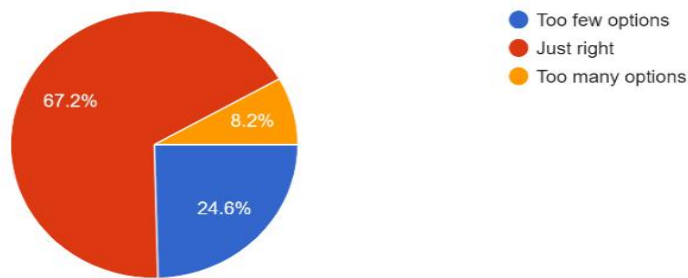
Source: Primary Data.

94 percent of Annapoorna's customers found their dining area comfortable and clean, indicating good dining experience. However, 6 percent reported unsatisfactory dining, suggesting room for improvement. Overall, customers are satisfied with Annapoorna's cleanliness and comfort.

MENU OPTIONS

The diversity and quality of menu options are key factors in attracting and retaining customers at any restaurant. For Annapoorna, offering a well-curated menu that caters to a variety of tastes and dietary preferences is essential to meet customer expectations and stand out in the competitive food service industry. A thoughtfully designed menu not only showcases the brand's culinary strengths but also ensures that every customer finds something appealing.

How would you rate the range of options on menu?
61 responses



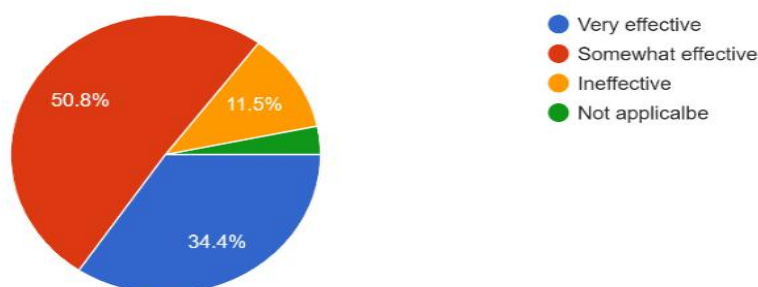
Source: Primary Data.

Most respondents (67.2 percent) felt there were too few options on the menu. A small percentage (8.2 percent) thought the number of options was just right. Almost a quarter of respondents (24.6 percent) felt there were too many options.

ANNAPOORNA'S MARKETING AND ADVERTISING STRATEGIES

In today's competitive market, effective marketing and advertising are vital for creating and maintaining brand awareness. For Annapoorna, a well-structured marketing strategy ensures that the brand not only reaches its target audience but also stands out in a crowded marketplace. By employing a mix of traditional and digital marketing techniques, Annapoorna can effectively communicate its value proposition, build a strong brand identity, and attract a loyal customer base.

How effective is Annapoorna's marketing and advertising in creating brand awareness?
61 responses



Source: Primary Data.

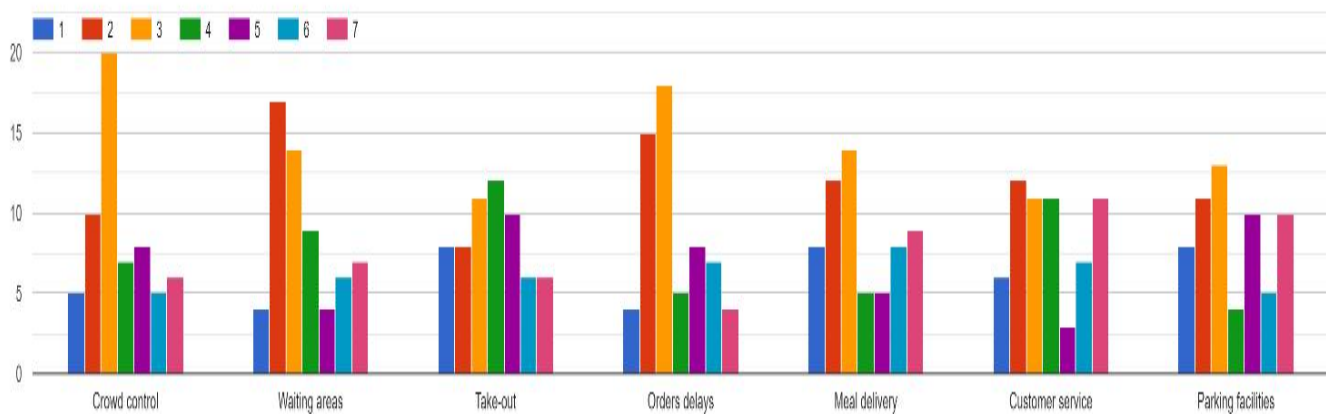
The majority of respondents (61 percent) found Annapoorna's marketing and advertising to be effective in creating brand awareness. However, 11.5 percent of respondents found it somewhat effective, suggesting some people are aware but not impressed. The smallest percentage (34.4 percent) found it either ineffective or not applicable, indicating some people are not aware of or dissatisfied with the company's marketing strategies.

ISSUES WITH ANNAPOORNA

Understanding customer satisfaction is crucial for any restaurant aiming to thrive in a competitive market. Annapoorna, a popular dining establishment, has recently conducted a survey to gauge customer sentiments and identify areas for improvement. This analysis delves into the findings of the survey, which reveal a nuanced picture of customer experiences.

The survey highlights that while a significant portion of customers are satisfied with their overall dining experience at Annapoorna, there are notable areas of concern. Factors such as cleanliness, food quality, and customer service have been rated positively by a substantial number of patrons. However, issues such as long waiting times, inconsistencies in food quality, and varying perceptions of cleanliness have also been prominently reported.

Rank the issues you had with Annapoorna in terms of their impact on customer satisfaction.



Source: Primary Data.

The majority of customers (40 percent) are generally satisfied with their dining experience at Annapoorna, with 30 percent expressing positive aspects like cleanliness, food quality, and friendly service. However, 30 percent reported negative factors, such as long waiting times (18 percent), inconsistencies in food quality (12 percent), and varying perceptions of environment and cleanliness (10 percent). Price and value (8 percent) were found to be affordable and worthwhile, while customer service (7 percent) was rated positively (5 percent). These findings highlight areas for improvement in Annapoorna's operations.

FINDINGS

- 67.2 percent of respondents said they trust the Annapoorna brand.
- The hotel Annapoorna receives 65.6 % visitors or shoppers each month.
- Customers prefer Annapoorna for its quality and flavour as much as for its brand.

- 3.3 Percent of respondents declare that the packaging and design of Annapoorna have no influence on their choice to buy.
- 49.2 percent individuals are likely to tell others about Annapoorna
- Customer satisfaction with Annapoorna is rated as outstanding by 24.6 percent consumers.
- 68.9 percent Consumers believe that the quality of the Annapoorna product is decent
- 50.8 Percent of respondents said that the marketing and advertising made by Annapoorna is very effective.
- 67.2 Percent respondents said that menu was quite just right.
- On the scale of 1-5, respondents reacted 4 out 5 for the cleanliness.
- 98.4 Percent of respondents felt comfortable and clean in dining area, remaining were not.
- 75.4 Percent of respondents said that they have used special offers and discounts offered by Annapoorna.
- Only 59 Percent respondents were satisfied with brand Annapoorna.
- 34.4 percent of Customers believe that Annapoorna better demonstrates its dedication to sustainability and social responsibility through eco-friendly packaging than ethical ingredient procurement
- The main factor that makes the Annapoorna stand out from other brands is its solid brand reputation.

SUGGESTIONS

- The improvement of the restaurant's atmosphere will draw customers and give it a more modern vibe.
- They have the ability to introduce some novel products that will make sense to both buyers and kids.
- If Annapoorna wants to attract a wider audience, they need somewhat raise the quality of their items.
- Some customers were only marginally satisfied with the Annapoorna brand, so they improved customer service and used environmentally friendly products to boost their brand value with them.
- Annapoorna may give discounts or additional offers to its consumers in order to improve their business.
- To satisfy the customers, Annapoorna should incorporate some of their suggestions, such as adding more menu selections if there are too few alternatives on the menu card.
- Customers believe that advertising and marketing are successful in raising awareness of Annapoorna so they may increase their own brand by using advertising.
- The majority of individuals in Annapoorna have problems with the parking facilities, thus they should take this into account and modify their parking facilities in order to satisfy their customers.

CONCLUSION

According to the study's outcomes, Coimbatore's Sree Annapoorna Gowrishankar has satisfied its patrons with its quality, flavour, brand, and menu. customers come in at least once a week because of the high quality, hygienic service they receive. People believe that taste is more important than a brand, therefore they can enhance their brand through advertising, product packaging, and product design. Although they provide good customer service, they should do better to protect their brand's reputation. Their dining room is more comfortable for their patrons, they may add additional offers to draw in more business. For cleanliness, the restaurant consistently receives high marks from its patrons. Due to its dedication to its customers, Sree Annapoorna Gowrishankar holds a unique position in the hotel sector.

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ELECTRIC CARS: AN ANALYSIS OF TATA MOTORS AND THEIR STRATEGIC APPROACH TO PROMOTE E-CARS

Dr. N. Manicka Mahesh, Associate Professor, Department of Commerce, Kumaraguru College of Liberal Arts and Science, Coimbatore.

Ms. Praneeta R, B.Com PA, Kumaraguru College of Liberal Arts and Science, Coimbatore

Ms. Niveetha V, B.Com PA, Kumaraguru College of Liberal Arts and Science, Coimbatore

ABSTRACT

Pollution is one of the serious issues arising among the nations. Emissions from the vehicle are the major cause for that. Reduce the fuel wastage and to secure the environment electric vehicles(cars)are being manufactured. Electric car is a promising technology which helps to achieve a sustainable transport sector due to low noise, less pollution, extremely low carbon emission and integration. Electric vehicles are believed to be an effective solution for reducing greenhouse gas emission. This includes an overview of electric cars as associated with charging mechanisms and energy storage. Over the long-term electric vehicles could be sustainable technological path. Electric cars are bringing new revolution in automobile industries and are much better in comparison of fuel vehicle present on the road due to its minimal maintenance and eco-friendly. We conclude that it is significant to consider electric cars' features with special reference to Tata company.

Keywords: Electric cars, pollution, fuel, charging mechanisms, sustainability

INTRODUCTION

The interest in electric and alternative fuel vehicles for private motor vehicles increased at the start of the twenty-first century because of growing concern over the drawbacks of vehicles powered by hydrocarbons, including the harm that these emissions cause to the environment, the viability of the current hydrocarbon-based transportation infrastructure, and advancements in electric vehicle technology. By the end of 2020, total sales of light-duty plug-in electric cars will have surpassed the 10-million-unit mark, surpassing the joint sales of all- electric automobiles and utility vans since 2010. As of September 2016, there were 4.8 million electric vehicles in operation worldwide.

RISE OF ELECTRIC CARS

The business and the government appear assured that work unit sales can solely go up within the years ahead. the world semiconductor shortage could spoil this dream, as EVs would like a lot of electrical and electronic elements than a traditional vehicle.

The good news is that demand can rise over consecutive few years, spurred partly by the pandemic. The Deloitte survey shows that forty fifth of Indian respondents commit to buy a vehicle within the wake of the Covid-19 pandemic as they are doing not wish to use public transportation. With the market growing, it's currently up to the govt. to seek out ways in which to create EVs enticing to the present new phase of first-time patrons. The business and the government appear assured that work unit sales can solely go up within the years ahead. the world semiconductor shortage could spoil this dream, as EVs would like a lot of electrical and electronic elements than a traditional vehicle.

The good news is that demand can rise over consecutive few years, spurred partly by the pandemic. The Deloitte survey shows that forty fifth of Indian respondents commit to buy a vehicle within the wake of the Covid-19 pandemic as they are doing not wish to use public transportation. With the market growing, it's currently up to the govt. to seek out ways in which to create EVs enticing to the present new phase of first-time patrons. Despite numerous hurdles, electrical vehicles square measure creating inroads into the Indian market. With state support and continued enthusiasm from automakers, this might otherwise be the year of the work unit in Asian country

Category-wise EV sales in India 2020-2021

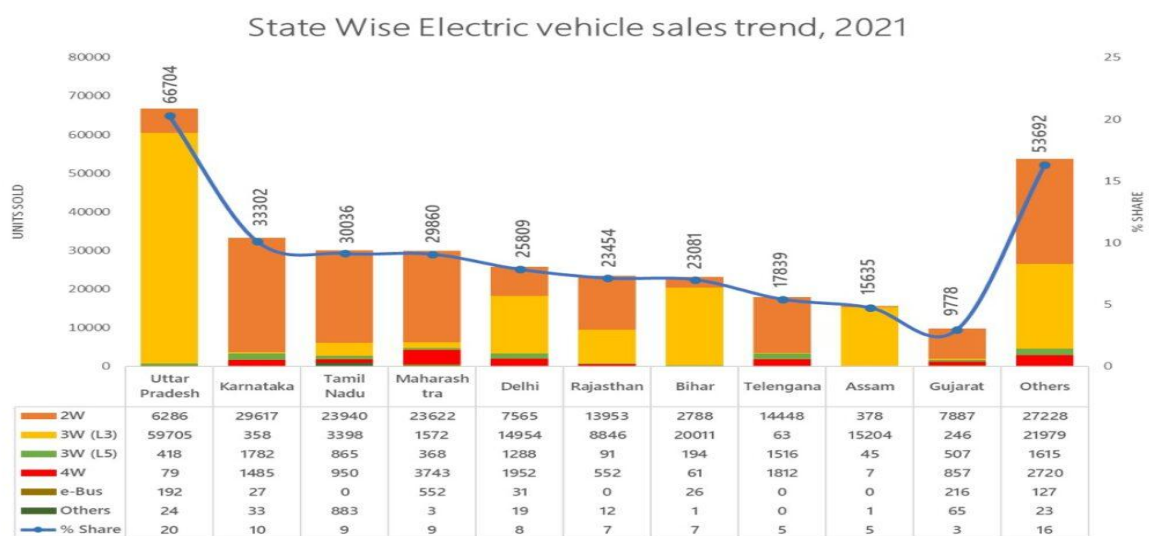


As

fuel costs skyrocket, there square measure rising considerations about the steep increase within the price of running gas and diesel vehicles. News reports from across the country tell of cab operators being unable to

afford to create ends meet, and prices} rising because of transportation costs are rising. Against this scene, there's some excellent news. electrical vehicles appear to be coming back into their own ultimately. The growth in hackney work unit sales is critical because of the arena is battling handicaps like absence of a sturdy country-wide charging network and distribution reach, a comparatively weak model line-up, inadequate element provider set-up, and slowly developing investment pipelines. According to the Society of makers of electrical Vehicles (SMEV), the sales of electrical cars in Asian country accumulated over the year by 109 Percent from two,814 units in 2019 to five,905 units in 2020. the bulk of over sixty fourth of the sales came from the Tata Nexon work unit, with a complete of three,805 units sold in 2020. The global electrical vehicle (EV) market is developing at a speedy pace. in line with work unit volumes, overall electrical vehicle reached a world share of eight.3 Percent (including battery electrical vehicles [BEVs] and Plug- in hybrid electrical vehicles [PHEVs]) in 2021 from four.2 Percent in 2020 with six.75 million vehicles on the road. this is often a rise of 108 Percent as of 2020. EVs square measure gaining attention across the world as they aid scale back emissions and depletion of natural resources. The Indian work unit market is additionally evolving quick as getting ready to zero.32 million vehicles were sold in 2021, up 168 Percent YoY. in progress electrical vehicle adoption in Asian country is predicated on the Paris agreement to cut back carbon emissions, to boost the air quality in urban areas and scale back oil imports.

FALL OF ELECTRIC CARS



In 2000, BHEL developed an eighteen-seater electric bus. Its electrical converter consisted of an AC Induction Motor and 96V Lead acid battery pack. Some 200 electric vans were built and run in Delhi, with monetary support from MNES. the key concern with these vehicles was their poor consistency, low life and extremely high cost of battery.

In 2001, Bajaj Auto Ltd, Pune, had also proved their 3-seater electric rickshaw. The vehicle used advance PMSM drive system. However, this product has not been commercially launched. REVA, Bangalore, entered the EV sector within the car industry with a vehicle developed by American company (Amerigo). About 3200 cars had been sold worldwide including approximately 1500 cars that had been sold in India, mostly in Bangalore city.

A new report says India will have only 50 million electric vehicles (EVs) on road by 2030 despite a ramp-up in domestic manufacturing, falling behind by 40 Percent on the cumulative sales projections by NITI Aayog. It also recommends policy measures to boost India's chances of realizing 80 million EV sales by 2030. India may only reach 50 million electric vehicle (EV) sales by 2030, falling behind by 40 Percent on the sales projections by the govt. of India's company NITI Aayog, in line with a fresh report by JMK Research and Climate Trends. The report authors project the sales shortfall after accounting for this electric mobility policies (FAME II and state policies) and even increased EV adoption in an exceeding few years as battery prices drop and native manufacturing ramps up. NITI Aayog had projected EVs to provide 30 Percent of recent private car sales in India, 70 Percent of economic cars, 40 Percent of buses, and 80 Percent of two and three-wheelers by 2030, driven by FAME II and other measures. In absolute numbers, this amounts to having 80 million electric vehicles on road by 2030. The JMK report projects electric two-wheelers (E2Ws) will grow at 57.86 Percent annually between FY 2022 and FY 2030 and account for 79 Percent of the entire EV sales within the analysis period. Compared to E2Ws, the report adds that the upper costs of E3Ws are a priority for his or her owners with low disposable incomes. this might cause E3Ws' low adoption rate within the approaching years.

The report projects a modest growth in E4W sales till FY 2025 because of charging infrastructure still being built up and most of the current product introductions primarily within the premium segment. After FY 2026, the market is predicted to grow annually at 52 Percent given the anticipated launch of mass segment e-cars, adoption of an increased number of E4Ws for fleet, and private charge point operators and e-car OEMs taking the lead in fitting semi-public charging stations. E-buses will witness high growth due to an increase within the number of tenders issued by the govt. and the private sector also entering the E-bus domain. The analysis further estimates India will need a minimum of two.05 million and three.9 million charging stations to support 50 million and 80 million EVs on road by 2030, respectively. this may be much over the charging stations planned during this era. The study "Accelerating transport electrification in India by 2030" was released at the EV Market Conclave organized by JMK Research in Indian capital. It also analyses all approved state EV policies and makes a robust case for better and more ambitious state targets to reinforce India's sales projections. While some states have defined targets as absolute numbers, others have defined a percentage of total vehicles, and some don't have any target defined in any respect. only few policies define targets for charging infrastructure or to convert

government-owned vehicle fleets to EVs. Moreover, most of the policies haven't got timelines till 2030. They currently only provide support till 2022 to 2026. “Progress on clean energy goals, as an example, renewable energy, happened the most amount due to state policies because it did because of regulation. In electric mobility similarly, the country needs rather more coordination. India has started on the right foot on e-mobility, with an enabling policy landscape and sales growing rapidly in few vehicle segments,” said Aarti Khosla, Director, Climate Trends. “However, we would like more coordinated efforts between states and centre, in defining targets and incentives that align with national ambition and policies, to not miss much greater target charging infrastructure and financial solutions for funding EVs.”. “Bridge the 40 Percent gap in realizing projected sales by 2030, India can put simple yet effective practices in place. All states must define clear targets for ramping up charging infrastructure, incentives alone aren't enough. this may be a prerequisite which will define adoption trends within the country. Following global examples, India should consider introducing mandates for 100 Percent electrification of state fleets and mandating a minimum of some percentage of auto aggregator fleets to be electric,” said Jyoti Gulia, founder and CEO, JMK Research & Analysis.

TATA MOTORS

Tata Motors was founded in 1945, as a locomotive manufacturer. Tata Group entered the commercial vehicle sector in 1954 after forming a venture with Daimler-Benz of Germany. After years of dominating the commercial vehicle market in India, Tata Motors entered the passenger vehicle market in 1991 by launching the Tata Sierra, an automobile vehicle supported the Tata Mobile platform. Tata subsequently launched the Tata Estate (1992; a car design supported the sooner Tata Mobile), the Tata Sumo (1994, a 5-door SUV) and therefore the Tata Safari (1998). Tata Motors Limited (TML), a \$42 billion organisation, is India's largest automobile company and could be a leading global manufacturer of cars, utility vehicles, buses, trucks and defence vehicles. Incorporated in India within the year 1945, Tata Motors could be a a part of the over \$100 billion Tata Group founded by Jamsetji Tata in 1868. Recognised for its world-class quality, originality, engineering and style excellence, the corporate is on the trail of shaping the long run of

Tata Motors has auto manufacturing and vehicle plants in Jamshedpur, Pant Nagar, Lucknow, Sanand, Dharwad, and Pune in India, similarly as in Argentina, South Africa, the uk, and Thailand. it's research and development centres in Pune, Jamshedpur, Lucknow, and Dharwad, India and Asian nation, the uk, and Spain. Tata Motors is listed on the BSE (Bombay Stock Exchange), where it's a constituent of the BSE SENSEX index, the National exchange of India, and also the NY exchange. the corporate is ranked 265th on the Fortune Global 500 list of the world's biggest corporations as of 2019.



TATA MOTORS- EV CAR

Ziptron is at the core of our Revolutionary Electric Vehicles. It encapsulates all the virtues of Tata Motors' Electric Vehicle Technology. This Technology is going to rapidly change the Misconceptions Around Electric Vehicles. Ziptron will show the world that Electric Vehicles are breathtakingly swift, incredibly silent, extremely pocket-friendly, and hassle-free to run. and while you're enjoying all these car-owner benefits, you save the world too.

**TATA TIGOR EV**

It is the largest EV service infrastructure software.

Over The Air software updates for telematics unit.

Safest electric sedan in India with 4-star GNCAP rating.

Built on the Ziptron EV platform, that has been driven and over 35 mn^ km in diverse Indian condition

Key features include remote commands, vehicle health ring, safety and security, driving and trip.

XPRES-T-EV

- This zero-emission electric car boasts of a fast-charging ability.
- This electric sedan in India boasts of a chrome ringed instrument cluster with a high resolution, segmented driver information system.
- Reliable architecture with Cocoon-like safety cell.
- Easy home charging from any 220 V 15 A AC socket.
- This electric sedan drives like an automatic car owing to its single speed transmission and Sports mode.



-

TATA NEXON EV

0-100 km/h in 9.9^ s

Smart watch integration

Remote command

- Intrusion alert
- Remote diagnostics
- Charge limit setting
- Geo fencing

BENEFITS OF TATA EV CARS

1. **Eco friendly** -TATA EVs can help in drastically reducing carbon footprint and scaling down on the emissions compared to the emissions from even the foremost eco-friendly petrol engines. With the depleting sources of non-renewable energy, switching to alternative sources could be a sensible solution and EVs may be a reliable future we will hunt to.

2. **Low running and maintenance cost** - Adopting TATA electric vehicle (EV) in situ of a standard vehicle will offer you great savings on its running and maintenance expenditures. A car with an interior combustion (IC) engine has more mechanical parts and more complexities thereby requiring increased maintenance costs. TATA

3. **EVs are easy and economical** to take care of thanks to their simple structure and functions. Another major advantage that TATA EVs provide over conventional vehicles is that the running cost. An EV gives more mileage during a single charge leading to lower running costs. Also, owning an EV will prevent from the concerns of fuel price hikes.

4. **Convenient charging at public charging stations and Home** - Refueling vehicle made easier with the convenient EV charging option at home! With the expanding network of public charging stations and battery swapping stations and residential charging infrastructure, charging electric vehicle isn't any more a hassle. you'll be able to connect your electric vehicle at your home for 8-10 hours for a full charge and prepared to induce moving again. TATA EVs also offer fast charging capabilities that enables quick charging within hr. Electric Vehicles including electric cars, electric scooters and electric buses also gives a simple driving experience. they're gearless that provide a simple drive and just a collection of buttons or pedals can cause you to operate the vehicle.

5. **Better resale value** - Second-hand TATA electric cars could be a great affordable option if people are looking to make the switch from petrol. It's worth remembering too the sale of new petrol and diesel vehicles will be banned from 2030.

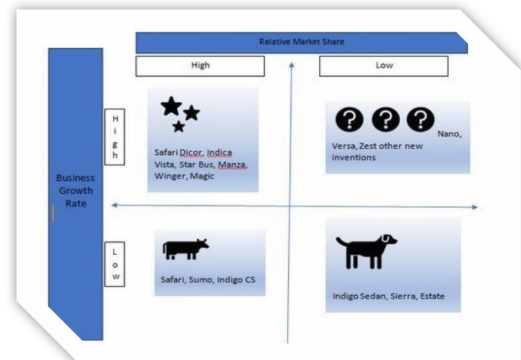
MARKETING STRATEGY OF TATA MOTORS

Competitive advantage in the Marketing strategy of Tata Motors-

The wonderful innovation and research and development at TATA Motors have founded an example for its competitors. With its various research centres across the country, the brand is functioning on the development of the engine efficiency, design, style and instrumentation of vehicles. Based in India is a

large competition for the corporate because it offers the brand low-cost labour base with the assistance which company not only targets the Indian market but also other emerging markets with an enormous range of economical segment vehicles.

2. BCG Matrix in the Marketing strategy of Tata Motors – Indica being the most preferred commercial vehicle features in the star segment along with Safari Dicor, Manza, Winger and Magic. With Safari, Sumo and Indigo CS being their cash cow, Nano& Zest still continues to be in question mark. segment



3. Brand equity in the Marketing strategy of Tata Motors – T ATA aims to fulfil the emerging needs of the car industry by arising with a brand new range of products. These products are manufactured with the aim of providing comfort, reliability, safety, capacity and value to the tip customers. so as to remain prior the competition, the corporate goes for huge investments within the area of development. TATA Nano carries a picture of the most affordable car within the world, TATA Ace is being introduced within the commercial vehicle marketplace for snatching the market share of its rivals. Another sporty vehicle Nexon with both diesel and petrol engine is additionally attracting customers already.

4. Customer analysis in the Marketing strategy of Tata Motors – Customers of TATA Motors are the low, middle groups who are looking to switch to 4-wheeler from 2-wheeler who are looking to purchase a car for a family purpose at affordable prices. Customers of the brand also include youth and high-class business professional who is looking for innovative, trending vehicles with world-class safety features.

WHICH COMPANY SELLS MOST OF THE E-CARS IN INDIA?

The Indian market has seen a slew of exciting EV launches from both traditional auto giants and evolving new players. Auto giants like Hyundai, Tata and MG have already made their mark within the Indian EV space whereas the country's largest automaker, Maruti Suzuki, is predicted to launch its first motorcar in India by 2025.

Tata presently sells most electric cars in India. the corporate reported the highest-ever annual EV sales of 19,106 units in FY22, up 353 per cent from FY21.

Tata presently offers two EVs in its line-up including the electrical variant of its successful compact SUV Nexon and Tigor EV. Tata are investing Rs 15,000 within the EV segment over the following five years. The investment is going to be wont to work up its EV production and launch new products within the market.

No	Electric Car Sales	Apr-22	Mar-22	Diff	% Growth MoM	% Share
1	Tata Nexon / Tigor	1,802	3,435	-1,633	-47.54	94.78
2	MG ZS EV	245	95	150	157.89	2.62
3	Hyundai Kona EV	23	18	5	27.78	0.50
4	BYD e6	21	18	3	16.67	0.50
5	BMW iX	17	9	8	88.89	0.25
6	Mahindra eVerito	13	18	-5	-27.78	0.50
7	Mercedes EQC	10	6	4	66.67	0.17
8	Audi etron	8	16	-8	-50.00	0.44
9	Porsche Taycan	4	3	1	33.33	0.08
10	Jaguar I-Pace	3	1	2	200.00	0.03
11	Others	4	5	-1	-20.00	0.14
-	Total	2,150	3,624	-1,474	-40.67	100.00

Tata Motors has revealed its sales figures for the month of June 2022. it's recorded its highest-ever monthly electric vehicle sales. In June 2022, Tata Motors managed to sell 3,507 EVs in India, registering a large 433 per cent YoY growth. Covid-19 and also the resultant lockdown slammed the brakes on the evolving EV ecosystem, particularly the event of charging infrastructure. All key growth segments — transport, mobility in cities and therefore the fleet segment — were impacted. But Tata's EV managed to crack the market and a decent number of individuals bought it amid the slowdown within the market. The Tata EV is that the country's first indigenously developed electric SUV. It comes with features sort of a powered sunroof, leatherette seats, auto headlamps with the follow-me-home feature, 7-inch Harman infotainment system for nice audio performance and a 7-inch digital instrument cluster. the electrical SUV is provided with safety equipment like dual airbags, ABS with EBD, corner stability control and sports a reinforced body part to shield occupants during accidents. As per the corporate, the Tata EV has been tested across 10 lakh km across the toughest terrains in India, covering high altitudes, unpaved roads, steep gradients and under extreme weather. By partnering with Tata Power, Tata Motors gets the good thing about the biggest public charging network in India. Tata Motors is functioning with other Tata Group companies including Tata Power, Tata Chemicals, Tata Autocomp, Tata Motors Finance and Croma, to form an e-mobility ecosystem called "Tata uniEVerse". Tata Motors is additionally collaborating with Tata Chemicals, to manufacture lithium-ion battery cells, additionally to exploring active chemicals manufacturing and battery recycling. The auto major is additionally working with Tata Autocomp for the localisation of battery pack assembly and motor assembly. Thus, Tata Motors

in conjunction with other Tata Group companies is that the only EV manufacturer in India to supply a whole end-to-end EV eco-system to the Indian customer.

CONCLUSION

The electric car market will definitely see a surge in the upcoming years. The coming decade is expected to be the ultimate decade for the future of E-Cars in India. In view of environment and surging price of fuel, the need for electric vehicles will increase. If proper infrastructure is provided and if it became affordable and access to every customers, the EV market might become one of the biggest industries in India.

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A STUDY ON THE FACTORS INFLUENCING CUSTOMER PREFERENCES TOWARDS H&M BRAND IN COIMBATORE CITY

Dr. N. Sumathy, Professor and Head, School of Commerce, Kumaraguru College of Liberal Arts and Science, Coimbatore

Ms. S. Jayashree, B. Com PA, Kumaraguru college of liberal arts and science, Coimbatore

Ms. L. Swathi, B. Com PA, Kumaraguru college of liberal arts and science, Coimbatore

ABSTRACT

Today, brands play an increasingly important role in our life. Brands can offer significant benefits to consumers. For example, a brand identifies the source of a product or service and helps consumers distinguish different brands and products. To firms, brands can supply many essential functions such as making the product handling simple and offering legal protection to the firm and its products. Therefore, most firms focus on brands to promote their development. They expend extra efforts to make a successful or worldwide brand. H&M is one of these companies that focus on brand development and extension. the brand H&M Globally as well as in relation to its recent entry in India. Since it has given consumers a new choice for fast fashion products. Also, globally leading this brand had been planning to enter India for the past few years and after its entry, it marked the first day of sales crossing 1.75 Crores showing the enthusiasm of the consumers towards the firm.

KEYWORDS: legal protection, enthusiasm of the consumer,

INTRODUCTION

Today, brands play an increasing important role in our life. Brands can offer significant benefits to consumers. For example, a brand does not only identify the source of a product or service, but also helps consumers distinguish different brands and products. To firms, brands can supply many essential functions such as making the product handling simple and offering legal protection to the firm and products. Therefore, most of firms focus on brands so as to promote the development of them. They expend extra efforts to make a successful or a worldwide brand. H&M is one of these companies that focus on brand development and extension.

H&M was founded in 1947 in Sweden and its main business is to sell clothes, accessories, footwear, and cosmetics in the world. H&M continuously pursues a successful and global brand. One of its business concepts is to work globally and enter into new markets in the future. Meanwhile, H&M entered the Chinese market in 2007. There are many challenges for H&M to develop its brand. In this thesis, we focus on how H&M develops its brand in general and opens up the market in China. There are many research papers on creating product brand, but we found that there is little study on how a specific company develops its brand. In our opinion, the branding process should be quite different because of the different

situations of each company. Accordingly, we will focus on a concrete company called H&M to conduct an in-depth study.

The reason for choosing H&M to develop our thesis is because of the personal interest. We have found that H&M's products are fashionable and are of good quality at a good price. We plan on exploring the brand development of H&M in this study and then evaluate its success.

OBJECTIVES

- To know the customers opinion on H&M brand
- To know the factors influencing the customer preferences
- To know the customer expectations on H&M brand
- To understand the factors which influence the purchase of H&M clothes.
- To study the awareness level of consumer on H&M on new rivals

REVIEW OF LITERATURE

Annisa Sanny and Muhammad Toyib Daulay (2022)¹This research used Partial Least Square (PLS) to test a relatively complex series of relationships. PLS is a tactic technique for testing and estimating causal relationships by integrating factor analysis and path analysis. Based on the results of the research, the R Square value has the effect of jointly or simultaneously X1 (Product Quality) and X2 (Brand Image) on Consumer Satisfaction or Y. the adjusted r square value is 0.611. So, it can be explained that all exogenous constructs (X1 and X2) simultaneously affect Y by 0.611 or 61.1 Percent. Because Adjusted R Square is stronger than 61 Percent, the effect of all exogenous constructs X1 and X2 on Y is strong.

Dr. Anshika Prakash and Srishti Gambhir (2019)²The paper aims to gain knowledge about the brand H&M and ZARA Globally as well as in relation to its recent entry in India. Since, it has given consumer a new choice for the fast fashion products. In the clothing industry firms compete successfully by applying different business-models. H&M and ZARA are two extremes in the clothing industry. H&M's business-model mainly focuses on outsourcing and ZARA's business-model mainly focuses on in-house production. Also, presence of its competitors from past few years has lead to a comparative study for the same. The prime aim of the paper is to study three things i.e., the brand, the consumer perception about H&M and ZARA and Comparison between both brands. It mainly focuses on Consumer preference of their brand.

Hanan Nakdali and Manzar Ahmed (2021)³This study is conducted to determine the relationship between unethical behavior and customer brand image. The main focus is to understand this relationship

¹ Analysis of Factors Affecting Consumer Satisfaction at H&M Medan Annisa Sanny and Muhammad Toyib Daulay| United International Journal for Research & Technology | Volume 03, Issue 03, 2022 | ISSN: 2582-6832

² A STUDY ON CONSUMER PREFERENCE OF H&M AND ZARA Dr. Anshika Prakash and Srishti Gambhir JETIR June 2019, Volume 6, Issue 6 www.jetir.org (ISSN-2349-5162)

³ UNDERSTANDING THE RELATIONSHIP BETWEEN UNETHICAL BEHAVIOUR AND CUSTOMER BRAND IMAGE: A CASE STUDY ON H&M Hanan Nakdali and Manzar Ahmed Vol. 18 No. 16 (2021)

regarding the clothing industry. The clothing industry is very wide, and nowadays fast and cheap production has become a trend in the clothes market. Previous study about the effect of unethical behavior on people and purchase choices was made, but no study was made focusing on the relationship of unethical behavior and brand image, nor did it focus on the clothing industry. The methodology used in this study is two focus groups, one conducted in Saudi Arabia and one conducted in Spain. The aim of choosing different countries is to see if cultural and social differences influence this topic. The results of this study prove that there is no direct impact of unethical behavior of brands on customer brand image. The results in both countries prove to be similar; therefore, social differences do not really have an influence in this matter. This study helps to understand consumer behavior and what priorities do consumers have when purchasing a specific brand.

RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

Research refers to the analytic examination which leads to collection of data, documentation of nagging information which analysis and interprets the data according to the suitable methodologies needed to gain knowledge. To achieve the aims of this paper, quantitative research was done. The aim of this paper is to find the consumer preference, usage, factors influencing, Primary data for this study has been collected by a survey conducted among common people. The questionnaire has been used to collect the data. The sample size collected with the help of questionnaires is 60.

DATA ANALYSIS AND INTERPRETATION

Data analysis is the process of transferring a data to discover the useful information and to draw conclusion. Data interpretation is the process of making sense out of collection of data that has been processed and the report of the study means that most critical aspects of the research paper. It constitutes the overall conclusion of the study.

DEMOGRAPHIC PROFILE OF THE RESPONDENTS

Demographic profile of the respondents has been analyzed and interpreted to have better understanding of the respondents. This includes Age, gender, level of education, occupation and income of the respondent.

TABLE-1-DEMOGRAPHIC PROFILE OF THE RESPONDENTS

S.NO	AGE	NO.OF. RESPONDENTS	PERCENTAGE
1	Below 18	5	8.3
2	18-30	21	35
3	30-40	23	38.3
4	40-50	8	13.3
5	Above 50	3	5
	Total	60	
S.NO	GENDER	NO.OF. RESPONDENTS	PERCENTAGE
1	Male	24	40
2	Female	36	40
	Total	60	
S.NO	EDUCATIONAL QUALIFICATION	NO.OF. RESPONDENTS	PERCENTAGE
1	Schooling	11	18.6
2	Ug	13	22
3	Pg	23	39
4	Others	12	20.3
	Total	60	
S.NO	OCCUPATION	NO.OF. RESPONDENTS	PERCENTAGE
1	Private employee	21	35
2	Public employee	7	11.7
3	professional	8	13.3
4	students	16	26.7
5	others	8	13.3
	Total	60	

Source: Primary Data.

The majority of respondents fall within the age groups of 18-40, comprising 86.6 Percent of the total sample. This suggests that H&M's appeal and customer preferences are primarily influenced by younger and middle-aged demographics in Coimbatore. The study sample shows a slight majority of female respondents, indicating that understanding female preferences is particularly crucial for H&M's marketing and product strategies in Coimbatore. A significant portion of respondents have completed postgraduate education (38.3 Percent), followed by undergraduates (22 Percent). This suggests that H&M's target audience in Coimbatore is relatively well-educated, potentially influencing their brand perceptions and purchasing behaviors. The largest occupational group among respondents is private employees (35

Percent), followed by students (26.7 Percent). This indicates that working professionals and students are key demographics for H&M in Coimbatore, influencing their marketing strategies towards these segments.

PREFERENCE OF H&M BRAND

Understanding consumer preference is pivotal for brands like H&M operating in the competitive retail market. According to recent primary data collected in Coimbatore city, this study examines the preference of consumers towards the H&M brand.

TABLE-2 RESPONDENTS PREFERRING THE H&M BRAND

S.NO	OPTION	NO. OF. RESPONSES	PERCENTAGE
1	yes	26	43.3
2	No	34	56.7
	Total	60	

Source: Primary Data.

The data reveals that out of a total of 60 respondents surveyed, 26 respondents expressed a preference for the H&M brand, while 34 respondents indicated a preference for other brands or no preference towards H&M. This dichotomy in preferences underscores the varying factors that influence consumer decisions, ranging from brand perception to product offerings and shopping experience. This report delves into the insights provided by respondents who favour or do not favour the H&M brand, aiming to uncover the underlying reasons and preferences shaping consumer behaviour in Coimbatore. By understanding these dynamics, H&M can strategize effectively to enhance brand appeal and meet the expectations of its target market.

SATISFACTION LEVEL OF CONSUMER

Consumer satisfaction is a critical metric for assessing the success and appeal of a brand like H&M in the retail landscape. Based on primary data collected in Coimbatore city, this study examines the satisfaction levels of consumers with the H&M brand.

TABLE-3- SATISFACTION LEVEL OF CONSUMER

S.NO	OPTION	NO. OF. RESPONSES	PERCENTAGE
1	Highly satisfied	10	16.7
2	satisfied	32	53.3
3	Neutral	16	26.7
4	dissatisfied	2	3.3
5	Highly dissatisfied	nil	nil
	total	60	

Source: Primary Data

According to the data, out of 60 respondents surveyed, a majority of 42 respondents expressed satisfaction with the H&M brand. Specifically, 10 respondents reported being highly satisfied, while 32 respondents indicated satisfaction. Additionally, 16 respondents remained neutral in their satisfaction levels, reflecting a varied spectrum of consumer sentiment towards H&M.

This report delves into the factors contributing to consumer satisfaction, as well as areas that may require improvement to enhance overall customer experience. By understanding these insights, H&M can formulate strategies to maintain and elevate satisfaction levels, thereby solidifying its position in the competitive retail market of Coimbatore.

AWARENESS ON H&M BRAND

Brand awareness plays a pivotal role in shaping consumer behaviour and market presence. In the context of Coimbatore city, this study explores the levels of awareness regarding the H&M brand among consumers, based on primary data. The data from the survey highlights various sources through which respondents become aware of the H&M brand.

TABLE-4- AWARENESS ON H&M BRAND

S.NO	BASIS	RANK 1	RANK 2	RANK 3	RANK 4
1	FRIENDS	36	11	6	4
2	FAMILY	7	22	13	3
3	C0-WORKERS	9	14	15	7
4	TELEVISION OR NEWSPAPER	15	12	10	10

Source-Primary Data

The above table clearly depicts 36 respondents give rank 1 for friends and 22 ranked 2 for family and 15 ranked 3 for co-workers and 15 ranked 1 for television or newspaper.

REASON FOR PREFERRING H&M BRAND

Understanding the factors that influence consumer preferences is essential for brands like H&M to tailor their offerings and enhance customer satisfaction. Based on primary data collected in Coimbatore city, this study investigates the reasons why consumers prefer the H&M brand.

TABLE-5- REASON FOR PREFERRING H&M BRAND

S.NO	OPTION	NO. OF. RESPONSES	PERCENTAGE
1	CONVENIENCE	19	31.7
2	SIZE OF PURCHASES	30	50
3	FITNESS	37	61.7
4	TEXTURE AND COLOR	35	58.3
5	COMFORT	23	38.3

6	SATISFACTION	13	21.7
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Source- Primary Data

According to the above table more than 61 percent of people say that they use H&M brand for their fitness. And 58.3 percent of people say that they use for its texture and color. 50 percent of people use it for the size of purchase. This report delves into each of these factors, analyzing their impact on consumer preferences and shedding light on areas where H&M excels in meeting customer needs. By leveraging these insights, H&M can refine its product offerings, marketing strategies, and customer engagement initiatives to further strengthen its market position and appeal in Coimbatore.

WORDS ASSOCIATED WITH H&M BRAND.

The perception and associations that consumers have with a brand can significantly influence their purchasing decisions and overall satisfaction. In the context of Coimbatore city, this study examines the key words that consumers associate with the H&M brand, based on primary data.

TABLE-6- WORDS ASSOCIATED WITH H&M BRAND.

S.NO	OPTION	NO. OF RESPONSES
1	QUALITY	38
2	BRAND IMAGE	26
3	PRICE	22
4	SERVICE	18

Source- Primary Data

The above table shows that majority of the consumers prefer quality with 38 responses and 26 respondents prefer brand image. 22 respondents prefer price. 18 respondents prefer service.

FINDINGS

1. Friends and family play significant roles in brand awareness, highlighting the importance of word-of-mouth marketing.
2. Traditional media channels like television and newspapers also contribute to brand visibility, albeit to a lesser extent compared to personal networks.
3. The primary reasons for preferring H&M include fitness attributes (61.7 Percent), texture and color choices (58.3 Percent), and the size range available (50 Percent).
4. Convenience (31.7 Percent) and comfort (38.3 Percent) also influence consumer choices, reflecting a balance between practical and emotional factors.
5. Quality (38 responses) and brand image (26 responses) are strongly associated with H&M, emphasizing its reputation for high-quality fashion and a positive brand perception.
6. Price (22 responses) and service (18 responses) are also noteworthy, indicating areas where H&M's positioning and customer experience can be further optimized.

SUGGESTION

- Collaborate with influencers and brand ambassadors to amplify positive word-of-mouth and enhance brand advocacy.
- Introduce loyalty programs or exclusive offers to reward frequent shoppers and increase retention rates.
- Implement personalized recommendations and tailored shopping experiences both online and in-store to enhance convenience and satisfaction.
- Strengthen training for staff to improve service delivery and responsiveness, aligning with customer expectations and enhancing satisfaction.
- Increase investment in digital marketing channels such as social media and online advertising to reach a broader audience beyond traditional media.
- Foster community engagement through local events and partnerships to further build brand awareness and connections with consumers.
- Continuously emphasize the value proposition of H&M products in terms of quality relative to price to reinforce consumer perceptions of affordability and quality.
- Introduce innovative designs and sustainable fashion lines to appeal to environmentally conscious consumers and differentiate from competitors.
- Establish robust feedback mechanisms to regularly gather insights from customers about their experiences and preferences, enabling agile adjustments and improvements.

CONCLUSION

H&M has been developed as a strong and sustainable brand where the product is well adapted to the needs of the consumer. They have shown the market through their marketing that fashion is not very expensive, they brought the runway clothes into the daily life of people. H&M uses different marketing strategies to promote its brand and increase sale, but they are slow to adapt to online sales. In the year 2021, their focus is to increase online sales as people are shifting to online shopping. 139 H&M also uses environment-friendly products through their brand they also make their consumer aware of sustainability. In the process of developing the brand, H&M creates its brand awareness through advertisements, stores, media, and websites. H&M offers new fashion, high quality, and reasonable price to satisfy consumers' self-image and need. Through the corporate social responsibility strategy, it develops a good image of the company. Besides, H&M keeps a close relationship with consumers, which helps H&M develop its brand and brand loyalty all over the world.

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**STRATEGIC APPROACHES AND CONSUMER PERCEPTIONS IN RELATION TO BRAND MILTON:
A STUDY ON MARKETING STRATEGIES, BRAND POSITIONING, AND CONSUMER BEHAVIOR**

Dr. K. Deepa, Assistant Professor, Kumaraguru College of Liberal Arts and Science, Coimbatore.

Ms. Nivetha S, B.Com PA, Kumaraguru College of Liberal Arts and Science, Coimbatore

Ms. Pavithra Manoharan, B.Com PA, Kumaraguru College of Liberal Arts and Science, Coimbatore

ABSTRACT

Milton's strategies offer valuable insights for brands seeking to achieve and maintain a competitive edge. As one of India's leading manufacturers and dealers of houseware products, Milton, along with Claro, Treo, and Spotzero, operates under the Hamilton Group of Companies. Milton consistently secures its top position across India. According to a recent study on the Milton Industries official website (2021), the company's net profit reached Rs. 2.65 crore by December 2021. Furthermore, the brand's effective supply chain management and strategic positioning contribute to making Milton the preferred choice among consumers.

Keywords: *Milton, Strategies, Consumer Perception, Supply Chain*

INTRODUCTION

Kitchen is the kingdom of the home queens. Kitchenwares are mostly used for two purpose. Mostly the cookwares are used the cooking activities like for fire or on a stove, blending, grinding, baking, mixing and measuring. Or like in the case of storing purpose we store it in food as in solid or liquid forms in the refridgerator and other. and also the different groceries and spices in different quantities. Storage in form of lunch, breakfast, dinner and snacks for kids and family at any occasions.

In this district it is found that most of the women are working professionals so these sort of kitchenwares are mostly used. Some utensils are used in routine manner of day to day basis. products the Milton brand

also have its own innovative unique strategy to make it be in the spotlight like updating its own products by benchmarking strategy and using different product variants and which can easily make the consumers to have the idea about the product on the market. Milton was found in the year of 1938 and it is an Australian listed investment company. Chairman of the brand Milton is Robert Millner and its managing director is Frank Gooch. Brand Milton was manufactured only in United States.

STATEMENT OF THE PROBLEM

The researcher has gave the first priority to the brand and thought to research about the brand in unique manner. The researcher mostly use the products of the brand Milton after his/her satisfaction on the brand product usage, the researcher got the idea to know about the ideas of the consumers of the same brand of his locality. After all this is the first research made in the home-ware items in Coimbatore. Mainly to check the consumers perspective about the brand Milton. And the researcher also found that the brand is use world wide in daily life of the consumer.

OBJECTIVES

- Understanding the marketing strategies implemented by Milton Brand.
- Measuring the brand awareness and the consumer perception of the Brand Milton.

This part of the paper will focus on studying the various strategies implemented by Milton in India and the way they want to position themselves amongst the consumers in India.

MILTON: THE BRAND FOR COOKWARE

Milton, a name that recalls with warm nostalgia, the past when every household enjoyed the convenience of fresh produce in a classic pan, shiny steel tiffin and sturdy water bottle. Today, in today's ever-changing times, Milton has grown and expanded on that convenience with a line of household products focused on meeting the needs of the modern consumer. Milton is constantly inspired by people's journeys and constantly strives to make life easier with modern products. Thus, enabling and revolutionizing a progressive lifestyle, one innovation at a time. The brand working with decided group of people, including Marketing, Sales and Logistic resources. The brand hope that knowing Milton is produced in the USA sets the customers mind at ease as you enjoy the benefits of using Milton to teach customers child how to be a healthy, happy and courageous eater. For Milton, the aim is to produce high quality products with the majority of Milton products being produced in the United Kingdom or France following the highest manufacturing standards.

At the early stage of Milton, the produced household plastic products. Milton as a partnership firm produced homeware products in 1970s. The company has established a network of over 55,000 retailers. To strengthening their brand the introduced new effective and innovative homework products which brings convenience in daily life of the customer. All and also, they launched the product which are inspired by the day-to-day life of modern Indian customer. The brand also offers a wide range of homeware products and

kitchenware product portfolio which includes 30 types Steel thermobaric, 20 types of casseroles, 43 types of lunch boxes, 20 types of water bottles, 8 types of water jugs, 3 types of water filters, 12 types of vacuum flasks, 2 types of ice pails and packs, 5 types of electric tiffins, and an electric kettle. Milton also produced baby care products about to 36 products. The later on introduced glassware's and chinaware products. Then they launched some domestic appliances like hand mixers, sandwich toasters, hair dryers and more. They had new launches of household products namely Non-stick ware, Water Purification System, Microwavable Containers of various sizes, water purification system, Pet Bottles or Jars of different sizes and shapes, Soft Thermoware products,

Founded in 1972, Milton today boasts a heritage spanning more than 50 years, as well as an established network of 55,000 dealers and a range of manufacturing units strategically located around the land. This drives Milton to continuously grow, develop and bring fresh air to every home through its product lines. As the year 2020 marks Milton's 50 years of presence in India. It has been recognized as one of the prestigious brands on a global stage. The Milton brand honoured with "Brand of the Year" award at the World branding Awards 2019. Change is constant, but to turn it into an opportunity for innovations, is what defines Milton's motto - 'Kuch Naya Sochte Hai'. At Milton, every day is an introspection over thoughts and ideas to create something better than yesterday, perhaps a better tomorrow where lifestyle is continuously changing and our innovations serving as the catalyst of this constant evolution.

REVIEW OF LITERATURE

Smith (2020) explores how Brand Milton's innovative marketing strategies have bolstered its market position. The study highlights the effectiveness of personalized advertising and digital engagement in capturing consumer attention and fostering brand loyalty. The research demonstrates that Milton's strategic use of technology and consumer data has led to a significant improvement in brand perception, making it a key player in the competitive landscape.

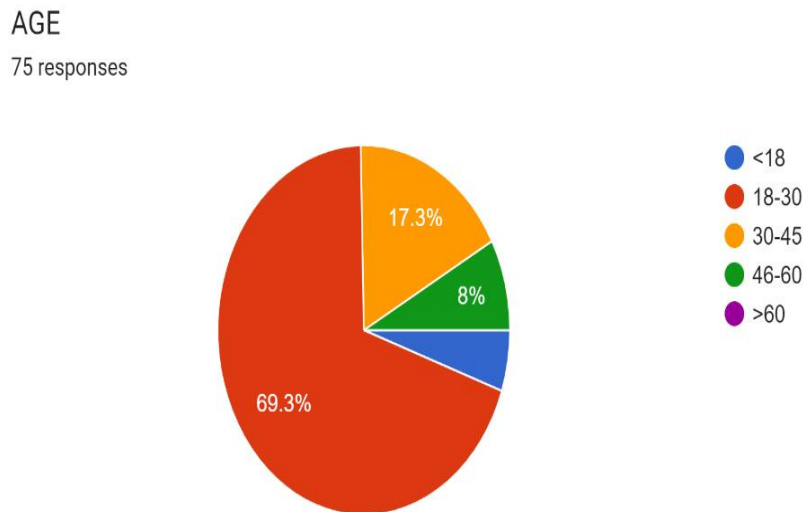
Johnson and Lee (2021) examine the relationship between consumer behavior and brand loyalty towards Brand Milton. Their study reveals a strong positive correlation between brand trust and consumer loyalty. The authors attribute this to Milton's consistent brand messaging and high-quality product offerings. The findings suggest that maintaining a trustworthy brand image is crucial for sustaining consumer loyalty and enhancing brand reputation.

RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

The study is carried on in the city of Coimbatore. Convenient Sampling method has been used for the study. A structured questionnaire in the form of Google Forms had been curated and circulated to gain the response regarding the awareness and usage of Milton products. Responses have been received from 75 respondents. Simple Percentage Analysis tables were prepared and the interpretation is expressed in the form of graphs through MS Excel.

RESULTS AND DISCUSSION

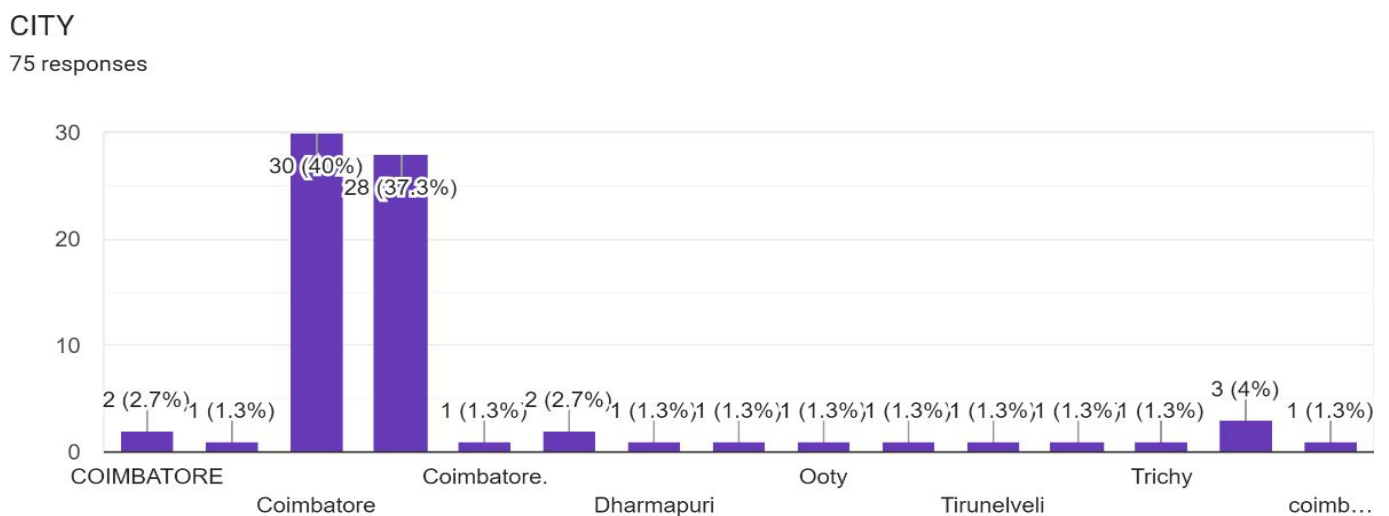
Chart No.1
Age of the respondents



Source: Primary data

Most of the consumers are on the age group of 18 to 30 from the group the research has conducted. nearly 17 Percent are on the age group of 30 to 45. And 8 Percent are in the age group of 46 to 60. And 5 Percent are on the age of less than the age of 18. So this research give the clear view of the brand Milton among all the different age group of consumers in the market .

Chart No. 2
Place of the respondents



Source: Primary data

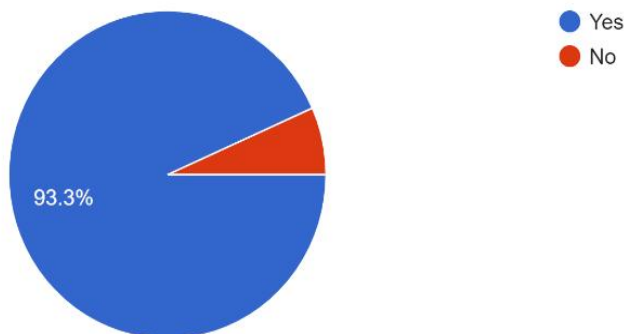
The consumers from the various cities are included in the research like majority are from Coimbatore, and from other cities including Ooty, Tirunelveli, Trichy, Chennai, Dharmapuri, Karur, etc., and mostly focused on the state Tamilnadu.

Chart No. 3

Awareness about Milton

Have you ever heard about the Brand Milton before?

75 responses



Source: Primary data

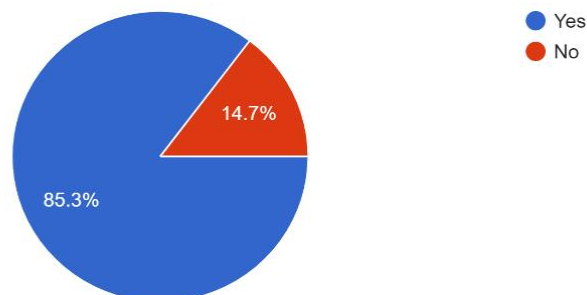
About the question of the awareness of the brand Milton, almost 94 Percent of the people are aware of the brand and its showcase the popularity of the Milton brand in Tamil Nādu.

Chart No. 4

Experience on using Milton products

Do you have experience on using the products of Milton Brand?

75 responses



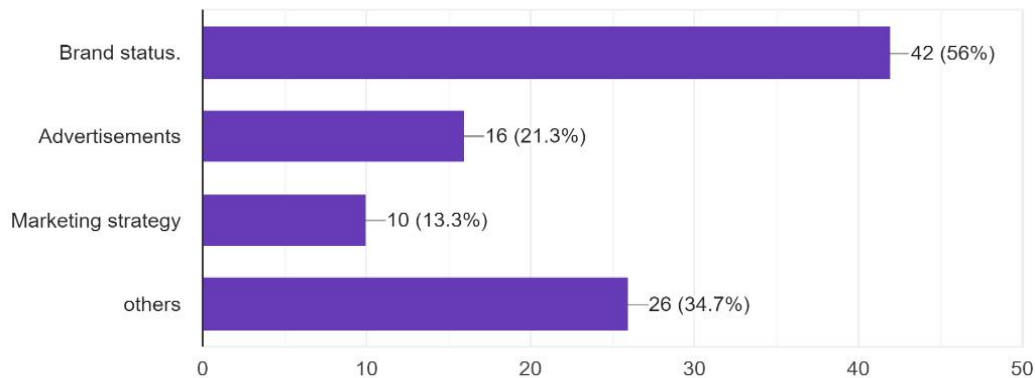
Source: Primary data

As per the above Pie chart almost 85 Percent are using the products of Milton brand and mentioned as good trusted brand in the homeware products of India.

Chart No. 5**Expression of interest in using Milton products**

What made you to have interest on using the Milton Brand products?

75 responses



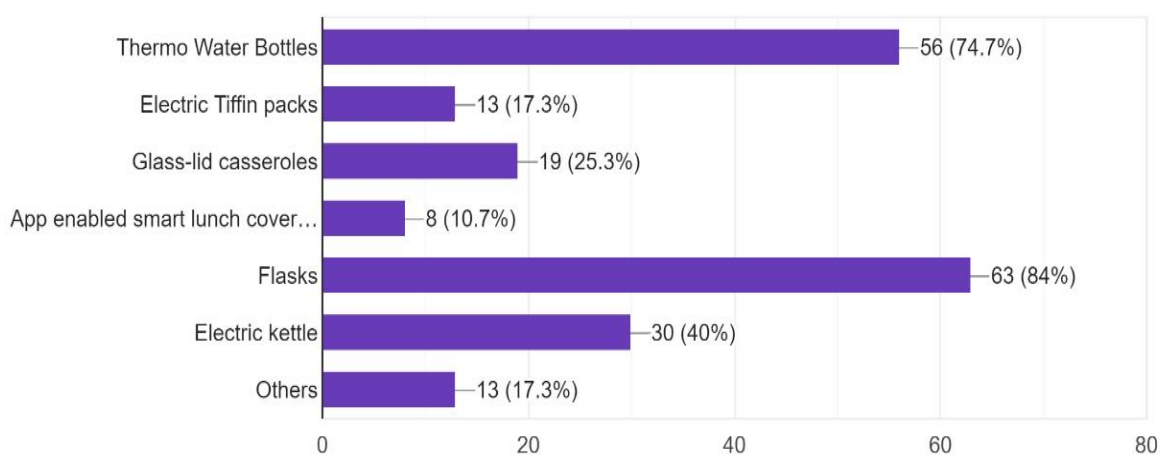
Source: Primary data

As per the above bar diagram, most of the population around 56 Percent are using the Milton products for the status of the Brand Milton, and 21 Percent are using it for the interest created by the Advertisements. The 13 Percent scholars over the market, analyze the strategies and use the Milton products, and also almost 35 Percent use the Milton for the other reasons like product innovations, stylish designs, affordable prices, etc.

Chart No. 6**Popular Products from Milton**

What are the products you have heard on Milton Brand before?

75 responses



Source: Primary data

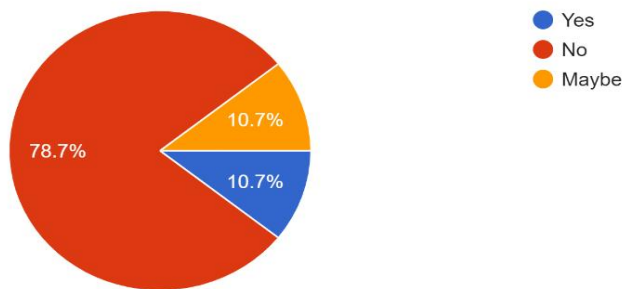
The Milton brand is mostly famous for its water bottles and its flasks. where almost 80 Percent of consumers are using bottles and flasks. Also, other products like tiffin packs, glass lid casseroles, app enabled lunch covers, kettle, other products like stationery products are also mostly used by the consumers.

Chart No. 7

Difficulties in using Milton Products

Have you ever faced any difficulties in using Milton products?

75 responses



Source: Primary data

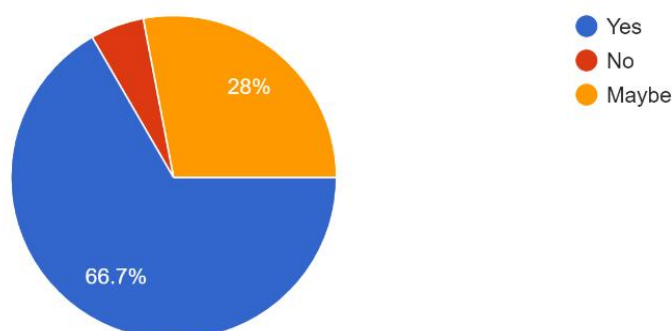
Milton products are mostly user friendly where we can easily study the ideas of the people that nearly 80 Percent are comfortable with using the Milton products. 11 Percent are not sure whether they are under the case of faced the difficulties on using the Milton products. The difficulties like higher cost, low knowledge about the product usage etc.

Chart No. 8

Recommendations to others

As a consumer, will you advice/ promote the Brand Milton to others?

75 responses



Source: Primary data

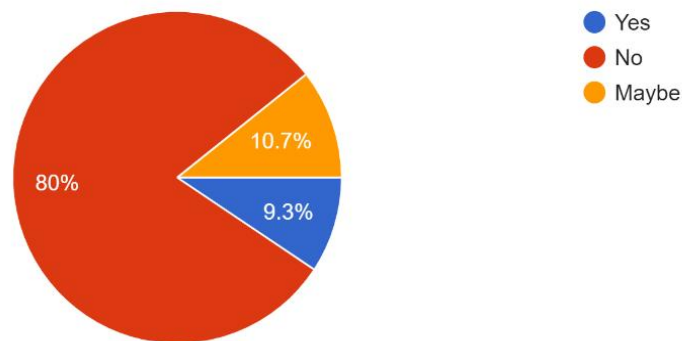
Most of the consumers are ready to advice others consumers about the merits and demerits of the Milton product and also 67 Percent of the consumers are ready to promote the brand status of Milton to the other end consumers.

Chart No. 9

Bad experiences with the products of Milton

Have you ever had any bad experiences with the milton brand ?

75 responses



Source: Primary data

As per the above chart, it clearly shows that 80 Percent almost of the consumers are good with using the Milton products without any bad experiences but 9 Percent of consumers faced some bad experience like high cost, bad quality etc.,

CONCLUSION

The brand Milton always decide to produce hygienic and easy to handle products. For the customer's comfort in use of the Milton products in daily life ,the are still working on .With the help of Milton housewares ,its easy to carry and enjoy the food in any occasions. They also make creative and innovative in promoting their brand all over the continents through the advertisements which create enthusiasm and tempts their customers to buy and make use of it. It also plays an vital role in the life of school & collage students and business and working colleagues. The brand also been a memory of houseware product that gave convenient life. The quality of the brand's product also been a goodwill of the company and has formed a huge reputation in the world of business. The products of Milton also gone for laboratory test to ensure the worthiness of each items, in the sense of customer to use without any worries and hesitation. Every time they are proving and achieving their customer's comfort zone and came across their competitors and leading the best houseware produce producer. They also one of the brands whom work for the consumer satisfication and who observed the latest taste of their customer . In other words, they are the authors of change, innovation, and evolution in the modern era.

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**EXPLORING SUSTAINABLE INNOVATIONS: APPLICATIONS OF COCONUT SHELL IN
PRODUCT DEVELOPMENT**

Dr. N. Sridevi, Associate Professor, Kumaraguru College of Liberal Arts and Science, Coimbatore.

Netthra P S, III B. Com PA, Department of Commerce, Kumaraguru College of Liberal Arts and Science, Coimbatore.

Pratosh K, III B. Com PA, Department of Commerce, Kumaraguru College of Liberal Arts and Science, Coimbatore.

ABSTRACT

This article investigates the potential applications of coconut shells in product design with a focus on sustainability. Coconut shells, a byproduct of coconut processing, are largely underutilized despite their promising mechanical and chemical properties. Through a comprehensive review of existing literature and case studies, this article highlights various innovative ways to incorporate coconut shells into products across various industries. In addition, the article addresses the environmental benefits and challenges associated with the use of coconut shell, providing recommendations to overcome the obstacles and maximize its potential as a material.

KEYWORDS

Coconut Shell, Sustainable Innovations, Product Development, Traditional Material

INTRODUCTION

In the drive towards sustainability and environmental protection, the exploration of renewable resources has become important in the product development process. Among these resources, the humble coconut shell emerges as a surprisingly versatile and environmentally friendly material. This introduction explores the innovative uses of coconut shells in product development, showing how this often-overlooked by-product is transformed into the foundation of sustainable innovation.

The use of coconut shells in product development is not only a testament to human ingenuity but also reflects a broader commitment to the principles of a circular economy. Coconut shells, traditionally considered agricultural waste, are turned into countless products, from activated carbon and charcoal to sustainable packaging solutions, home décor and even composites biology for the automotive and construction industries. This transition from waste to valuable resource illustrates the potential of natural materials to reduce environmental impact, minimize waste and promote more sustainable production cycles. In addition, the application of coconut shells in product development is also a ray of hope for areas with abundant coconut production sources.

By valuing each part of the coconut, communities can open up new economic opportunities, promote local entrepreneurship, and reduce dependence on unsustainable raw materials. This approach not only supports environmental sustainability but also contributes to socio-economic development, by empowering communities and promoting more equitable resource distribution. As we delve deeper into the application of coconut shells in product development, it becomes clear that the road to sustainability is paved with innovation, creativity and a deep respect for nature. Through the lens of using coconut shells, we explore sustainable design principles, the challenges of integrating natural materials into modern manufacturing processes, and the global impact of adopting sustainable practices. This poll is a call to action, inspiring industries, designers, and consumers to rethink their relationship with natural resources and harness the potential of these materials.

OBJECTIVES

- To raise awareness about the potential of coconut shells as a sustainable material for product development.
- To educate readers about the environmental benefits of utilizing coconut shells compared to traditional materials.

REVIEW LITERATURE

Thilagashanthi, T., Gunasekaran, K. & Satyanarayanan, K.S. (2023) in the article “Durability properties of treated coconut shell-used concrete for sustainability “has discussed about the absorption capacity of coconut shell aggregates (CS) is 20-25 times that of adsorption due to their inherent porosity.315 Percent and thus improve its durability performance when used in concrete production. Therefore, this study investigated the effects of CS aggregates treated with six different treatment methods on the durability performance of concrete produced with treated CS.Treated coconut shell concrete (TCSC) exhibits better performance in terms of durability properties compared to untreated coconut shell concrete (CSC).Among them, TCSCT5 shows better performance in durability properties, such as 7.54 Percent in water absorption test, 11-7.Therefore, the results of this study show that that CS aggregate treatments promote the production of durable concrete when used as coarse aggregate by significantly reducing the water absorption capacity of CS aggregates.

Ajien A, Idris J, Md Sofwan N, Husen R, Seli H (2023) in this article “Coconut shell and husk biochar: A review of production and activation technology, economic, financial aspect and application” has discussed There is enormous potential for value addition when coconut shells and rice husk biomass are converted into biochar and there is little research, which makes this review article important. This article specifically introduces production and activation technology, financial and economic aspects and

applications of biochar from coconut shells and rice husk biomass. Due to their favourable properties, coconut shells and activated rice husk biochar show potential as valuable adsorbent materials for industrial and environmental applications including biodiesel production, capacitive deionization, soil reclamation, water treatment and carbon sequestration. Production and activation technology, economic and financial aspects as well as application potential of coconut and coconut shell biochar are moving towards value-added biomass for income generation, especially in the coconut industry.

THEORETICAL FRAMEWORK

Composition of coconut shell

Physical characteristics

Coconut shell is the hard, fibrous shell that covers the outside of the coconut (*Cocos nucifera*). They have a distinctive appearance, with a rough, brown, wooden appearance. The size and thickness of coconut shells vary depending on factors such as coconut variety, age and environmental conditions during growth. The outer surface of the coconut shell is covered with Fibers that protect the inner core. These Fibers, known as coir Fibers, are commonly used in various industries because of their strength and durability. Coconut Fiber contributes to the overall strength of the coconut shell.

Chemical composition

The chemical composition of coconut shells is mainly organic, consisting of complex compounds that contribute to its structural integrity. The main ingredients include cellulose, lignin, hemicellulose and many minerals.

Cellulose: Cellulose is a polysaccharide and the main component of plant cell walls. In coconut shells, cellulose provides strength and stiffness, contributing to the overall stiffness of the material.

Lignin: Lignin is another essential ingredient found in coconut shells. It is a complex polymer that improves the stiffness of cell walls, making coconut shells resistant to rot and decomposition.

Hemicellulose: Hemicellulose is a heterogeneous group of polysaccharides that, along with cellulose and lignin, contribute to the structure of coconut shells. It plays a role in binding cellulose Fibers together.

Minerals: Coconut shells contain many different minerals, including potassium, sodium, calcium and magnesium. These minerals are essential for the structural integrity of the coconut shell and can influence its properties.

Structural properties

The unique composition of coconut shells imparts a number of desirable structural properties, making them suitable for a variety of applications: Hardness and durability: Cellulose content and high lignin contribute to the hardness and durability of coconut shells, making them resistant to abrasion and decay.

Water resistance: The presence of lignin in coconut shells helps them resist water absorption, preventing rot and fungal growth.

Low thermal conductivity: Coconut shells have low thermal conductivity, making them useful in applications where thermal insulation is required.

Biodegradability: Despite its high durability, coconut shells are still biodegradable and decompose naturally over time, in accordance with sustainability principles.

Exploitation and processing

Harvesting coconuts

The process of shelling coconuts begins with harvesting coconuts. Coconut trees usually start producing coconuts around 6 to 10 years old and continue to produce fruit for several decades. Harvesting involves climbing tall palm trees or using specialized tools to chop coconuts. It is essential to ensure that the coconut is mature enough to have optimal shell quality.

Shelling method

After harvesting, the coconut shell must be separated from the coconut. This extraction process involves several steps:

Peeling: The outer shell of the coconut, also known as coconut Fiber, is removed to reveal the hard-shell underneath. Traditional methods include peeling coconuts by hand, while mechanized peelers are also used in larger-scale operations.

Cleaning: After peeling, the coconut shell is cleaned to remove remaining shell Fibers and other impurities. This can be done by brushing, rinsing or air blowing.

Drying: Cleaned coconut shells are then dried to reduce moisture. The drying process can occur naturally through exposure to sunlight or using industrial drying methods. Proper drying is important to prevent Mold growth and ensure shell stability.

Processing techniques

After exploitation, coconut shells undergo many different processing techniques to create different products. The main processing methods include:

Carbonization: One of the most common processes is carbonization, in which coconut shells are heated in the absence of air to produce activated carbon. This involves subjecting the shell to high temperatures, creating a porous structure with increased surface area, making it effective for adsorption purposes in various industries, such as water filtration and filter' air.

Crushing and grinding: Coconut shells can be crushed or crushed into smaller particles to produce raw materials for various applications. The size reduction process is often a prerequisite for further processing such as producing charcoal from coconut shells or combining coconut shell powder into composite materials.

Chemical Treatment: In some cases, chemical treatment may be applied to coconut shells to change their properties for specific uses. These treatments may include bleaching, activation, or impregnation with certain chemicals to improve the material's properties.

Traditional uses and modern applications

Category	Sub-Category	Examples
Traditional Uses		
	Cultural and Artistic	s, cups, vases- Traditional musical instruments (e.g. coconut shell peanut)- Intricate ornaments and decoration
	Household Appliances	en utensils (ladles, spoons, scrapers)- Oil lamp holder
	Historical Significance	in rites and ceremonies- Traditional medicine construction materials (walls, roofs, floors)
Modern applications		
	Activated Carbon Production	water filtration- Air and gas filtration
	Agriculture and Horticulture	soil conditioner- Mulch materials
	Construction Materials	Composite materials (panels, boards, roofing)- Heat insulation
	Energy Production	Bioenergy (biochar production)- Coconut shell charcoal fuel for cooking and industrial applications)
	Consumer Products	Activated carbon filters (water and air purifiers)- Crafts (jewellery, accessories, home decorations)
	Automotive and Industrial Applications	Interior components (interior panels, seat backs)- Surface treatments (polishing, surface finishing)

In modern times, coconut shells find applications in various sectors, including activated carbon production for filtration, agriculture as soil conditioner, construction for composite materials and insulation, energy production through biochar, consumer products like activated carbon filters and crafts, and automotive and industrial uses such as automobile components and abrasives.

Environmental Impact

The environmental impact of coconut shells is an essential aspect to consider, especially as sustainable practices become increasingly important. Understanding how the exploitation, processing and use of coconut shells affects the environment is essential to evaluate their overall ecological footprint. Here are the key points regarding the environmental impact of coconut shells:

Biodegradability

Natural biodegradation: Coconut shells, being an organic material, are biodegradable biology. Over time, they decompose naturally, returning nutrients to the soil. This property minimizes the long-term impact on the environment when coconut shells are discarded or used in applications that lead to their decomposition.

Carbon Footprint

Carbon Sequestration: Coconut trees absorb carbon dioxide during their growth, thus contributing to carbon sequestration. Using coconut shells for various applications sequesters carbon, thereby minimizing the overall carbon emissions associated with their production and use.

Renewable Resources: Coconuts are a renewable resource and coconut cultivation does not contribute to deforestation or environmental degradation. Sustainable coconut farming practices further enhance the positive environmental impact of coconut shells.

Recycling Initiatives

Waste Reduction: Coconut shells can be reused in various industries, thus reducing the amount of waste generated. Recycling initiatives, such as the production of activated carbon or coconut-based composites, contribute to a more sustainable and circular approach.

Community Recycling: In some areas, community initiatives involve the collection and recycling of coconut shells. These efforts not only reduce waste but also create economic opportunities for local communities.

Industrial processing

Energy consumption: Industrial processing of coconut shells, especially in the production of activated carbon or composite materials, can involve energy-intensive processes. Adopting energy-saving technologies and renewable energy sources can help reduce environmental impact.

Chemical Use: Some treatment methods may involve the use of chemicals. Careful management and handling of these chemicals is necessary to prevent environmental pollution.

Transportation

Carbon footprint: Transporting coconut products over long distances can contribute to carbon emissions. Processing and using coconut shells locally can help reduce the environmental impact associated with transportation.

Supply chain sustainability: Implementing sustainable supply chain practices, such as promoting fair trade and ethical sourcing, can contribute to a sustainable coconut industry more for the environment.

Coconut shells in industry

Coconut shells have been widely used in many different industries thanks to their unique properties and durability. From manufacturing to construction, coconut shells contribute to creating innovative solutions and environmentally friendly practices. Here is an exploration of how coconut shells can be used in various industrial sectors:

Textiles and fashion:

Fiber production: Coir, extracted from coconut shells, is a Strong and durable natural Fiber. It is used in the textile industry to make ropes, carpets, and geotextiles. Coir's resistance to degradation by saltwater makes it particularly suitable for marine applications.

Fashion Accessories: Artisans and designers are integrating coconut shells into the fashion industry by creating accessories such as jewellery, buttons and earrings. The natural aesthetics of coconut shells add a unique and environmentally friendly touch to fashion products.

Composite materials:

for automobiles: Coconut shells are used as fillers in the production of composite materials for automobile components. Coconut shell composites provide a lightweight and durable alternative to traditional materials, contributing to energy savings and reducing the environmental impact of transportation.

Interior components: Materials derived from coconut shells can be used to produce interior components such as dashboards and door panels. The use of coconut shells in automotive applications is in line with the auto industry's growing emphasis on sustainable practices.

Construction:

Composite construction materials: Coconut shells are used to produce composite materials for construction purposes. These materials combine coconut shells with polymers or other Fibers, providing a sustainable alternative for many applications, including panels, boards and roofing materials.

Heat insulation: The low thermal conductivity of coconut shells makes it suitable as a heat insulation material. Insulation products made from coconut are used in construction to improve energy efficiency and reduce environmental impact.

Agriculture and Horticulture

Soil conditioner: Crushed coconut shells or coir are used as soil conditioners in agriculture. They improve soil structure, provide aeration and improve water retention, thus contributing to better plant growth.

Mulch Materials: Ground coconut shells are used as effective mulch in farming. Pods help control weed growth, retain soil moisture and contribute to overall plant health.

Energy production

Bioenergy: Coconut shells are a biomass resource used to produce bioenergy. Through processes such as pyrolysis or gasification, coconut shells can be converted into biochar, providing a renewable energy source.

Charcoal production: Coconut shell charcoal is a sustainable alternative to traditional charcoal. It is used as a clean fuel in culinary and industrial applications.

Innovation and Research

The versatility of coconut shells has fuelled continuous innovative research and development in various fields. Researchers and industries are exploring new ways to exploit the unique properties of coconut shells to find sustainable solutions. Below is an overview of recent innovations and research areas related to coconut shells:

Sustainable materials development

Bio composite: Researchers are studying the use of coconut shells in the development of biological composite materials. These materials, which combine coir Fibers or granules with biodegradable polymers, offer environmentally friendly alternatives for a variety of applications, including packaging and construction materials.

Bioplastics: Components derived from coconut shells are being studied as potential additives in bioplastic production. These biodegradable plastics can help reduce the environmental impact of conventional plastics.

Potential future applications

Medical and pharmaceutical advances: Ongoing research is exploring the potential uses of materials derived from coconut shells, e.g. such as activated carbon, in advanced medical applications. This includes drug delivery systems, wound healing technology and advanced medical devices.

Nanotechnology: Nanoparticles made from coconut shells are being studied for their unique properties. These nanoparticles could find applications in fields such as drug delivery, water filtration, and innovative materials with improved mechanical and thermal properties.

Scientific research

Environmental sanitation: Researchers are studying the effectiveness of materials derived from coconut shells in environmental sanitation. This includes the use of activated carbon to remove pollutants and contaminants from soil and water, thereby contributing to sustainable environmental management.

Carbon capture and storage: Coconut shells, especially in the form of biochar, are being studied for their carbon capture and storage (CCS) potential. Biochar can sequester carbon in soil, thereby reducing greenhouse gas emissions and improving soil fertility.

Waste Recovery

Circular Economy Initiative: Innovation focuses on creating circular economy models for coconut shell waste. These initiatives involve developing technology to effectively process and recycle coconut shells, thereby reducing waste and maximizing resource use.

Energy storage: Coconut shells are being studied as potential precursors to carbon materials used in energy storage devices, such as supercapacitors. This research aims to contribute to the development of sustainable and efficient energy storage technologies.

Agricultural advances Improved.

agricultural practices: Research aimed at optimizing coconut farming practices to improve productivity and sustainability. This includes exploring intercropping techniques, pest control strategies, and initiatives to improve soil health.

Disease resistance: Efforts are being made to develop coconut varieties with increased resistance to common diseases. This research aims to ensure the long-term viability of coconut cultivation and minimize the impact of pests and pathogens.

Challenges and opportunities

Although coconut shells offer many benefits and applications, their exploitation, processing and use also have challenges. Recognizing these challenges and opportunities is crucial for the sustainable integration of coconut shells into various industries. Here is an overview:

Economic Challenges

Fluctuations in market demand: Demand for coconut shells and products derived from them is subject to fluctuations. Economic uncertainties, changes in consumer preferences and global market dynamics could impact the economic viability of coconut-related industries.

Price fluctuations: Coconut shell prices can be affected by factors such as weather, market demand and geopolitical events. Price fluctuations can pose challenges for businesses that rely on coconut shells as their main resource.

Environmental Concerns

Agricultural Activities: Although coconut farming is generally considered environmentally friendly, certain agricultural practices, such as monocultures, can lead to land degradation and loss of biodiversity. Sustainable agricultural methods should be encouraged to minimize environmental impact.

Energy intensity of processing: Industrial processing of coconut shells, especially the production of activated carbon, can involve energy-intensive processes. Balancing the benefits of coconut-based products with their energy consumption is important for environmental sustainability.

Innovation opportunities

Waste recovery: Turning coconut shell waste into valuable products is an innovation opportunity. Research and development focused on efficient waste recovery methods, recycling initiatives and circular economy models can create new economic and environmental opportunities.

Technological advances: Technological advances, including more efficient processing methods and sustainable energy sources, can improve the overall sustainability of coconut-related industries. Investing in advanced technology can lead to more environmentally friendly and cost-effective solutions.

Sustainable Agriculture Initiatives

Agroforestry Practices: Encourage agroforestry practices, in which coconut trees are integrated into diverse and sustainable agricultural systems, helping to sustain Maintain ecological balance and reduce the environmental impact of coconut farming.

Certification Programs: Support and promote certification programs for sustainable coconut farming practices that can provide market incentives for environmentally conscious producers. These programs can enhance the reputation of coconut products in the global market.

Community Empowerment

Fair Trade Practices: Emphasis on fair trade practices in the coconut industry ensures that farmers receive fair compensation for their products. Fair trade initiatives contribute to community development and poverty reduction in coconut producing areas.

Skills Development: Investing in skills development of local communities involved in coconut-related industries can improve their capacities. This includes training in sustainable agricultural practices, processing technology and business skills.

Legal support

Environmental regulations: Governments and regulators can play a central role in promoting sustainable practices. Implementation and enforcement of environmental regulations related to coconut cultivation, processing and waste management can ensure responsible industrial practices.

Incentive schemes: Governments can introduce incentive schemes to encourage businesses and farmers to adopt sustainable and environmentally friendly practices. Financial incentives, tax breaks or subsidies can bring about positive changes in the coconut industry.

FINDINGS

- Coconut shell is profoundly biodegradable, making it an eco-friendly elective to engineered materials such as plastic. Its normal composition permits for secure deterioration without causing hurt to the environment.

- In spite of its lightweight nature, coconut shell shows momentous quality and toughness, making it reasonable for different applications in item plan. Its stringy structure gives great support properties, advertising openings for the improvement of vigorous and long-lasting items.
- Coconut shell can be changed into a wide extend of items, counting but not restricted to enacted carbon, crafted works, furniture, building materials, and agrarian items. Its flexibility permits for assorted applications over distinctive businesses, contributing to asset productivity and squander decrease.
- Coconut shell has a one-of-a-kind stylish offer characterized by its characteristic surfaces and designs. Joining coconut shell into item plan can improve visual request and make unmistakable, eco-friendly items that resound with ecologically cognizant buyers.
- Utilizing coconut shell as a crude fabric can offer taken a toll reserve funds for producers, especially in locales where coconuts are copious. By repurposing a squander item, companies can diminish generation costs whereas advancing supportability.

SUGGESTIONS

- Partner with local coconut farmers or cooperatives.
- Ensure a steady supply of coconut shells while supporting local communities.
- Allocate resources for ongoing R&D.
- Explore new applications and innovative uses of coconut shell.
- Evaluate and improve existing processes, products, and business models.
- Embrace feedback to drive innovation and maintain competitiveness.

CONCLUSION

Coconut shell, a by-product of the versatile coconut, plays a multifaceted role with significant contributions to various industries and global sustainable development efforts. From traditional uses in local culture to modern applications in industries such as agriculture, textiles, automobiles and energy, coconut shells demonstrate adaptability and eco-friendly properties. Traditional uses of coconut shells reflect cultural practices and their historical significance, while modern applications demonstrate their suitability in meeting contemporary challenges. Activated carbon production, agriculture, construction and energy are just some of the sectors that benefit from the sustainable properties of coconut shells. While the environmental impact of coconut shells is generally positive, challenges such as market volatility, energy intensity of processing and environmental concerns in agriculture need to be carefully considered. As applications for coconut shells continue to grow, addressing challenges and seizing opportunities is essential for the sustainable development of the industry. In short, the coconut shell is a symbol of

flexibility, sustainability and innovation: a resource that connects traditional practices with modern advancements, contributing to a greener and sustainable future than.

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A COMPARATIVE STUDY ON FILPKART AND SHOPSY IN INDIA

Dr.Reshmi A Rajan, Associate Professor, Department of Commerce, Kumaraguru College of Liberal Arts and Science, Coimbatore.

AnishhFathimaa A, II B. Com Professional Accounting, Department of Commerce, Kumaraguru College of Liberal Arts and Science, Coimbatore.

Amirrdhavarsa PM, II B. Com Professional Accounting, Department of Commerce, Kumaraguru College of Liberal Arts and Science, Coimbatore.

ABSTRACT

This paper presents an overview of two prominent e-commerce platforms that compete in the competitive Indian market-Flipkart and Shopsy. The study's primary goal is to evaluate a number of factors, including the user interface, product offers, pricing strategies, delivery services, customer satisfaction, and both platforms' market penetration. Through the use of both qualitative and quantitative approaches, such as surveys, interviews, and data analysis, this study aims to shed light on the benefits, drawbacks, opportunities, and dangers affecting Shopsy and Flipkart. The study additionally delves into how customer preferences, legal frameworks, and technology developments affect the competitive environment in the Indian e-commerce market. The findings of this investigation will enhance knowledge of the strategies adopted by Flipkart and Shopsy for gaining a competitive advantage.

Keywords: Strategies of Shopsy and Flipkart, Advantages and Disadvantages of Shopsy and its benefits.

INTRODUCTION

The Indian e-commerce business has grown remarkably in the last few years as a result of factors which includes high access to the internet, smartphone usage, and changing preferences among consumers. Flipkart as well as Shopsy, two prominent competitors in this competitive market, have emerged as market leaders due to their distinctive product offerings and approaches in attracting the Indian customers. The purpose of this comparative analysis is to examine the subtle differences between these platforms' relative positive and negative aspects and positions on the market.

Walmart purchased Flipkart in 2018, a forerunner in Indian e-commerce that transformed the way people shopped by offering a wide range of products, consistent delivery, and a user-

friendly interface. Flipkart continues to come up with new ideas and expanding, going out to a variety of national audiences.

Shopsy a relatively recent entrant, has gained traction by harnessing the power of social commerce. Launched by Flipkart in 2021, Shopsy provides a unique platform for individuals to become entrepreneurs by curating and selling products through their social networks. With its innovative business model, Shopsy aims to empower micro-entrepreneurs and capitalize on the growing social commerce trend in India.

In conclusion, this comparative analysis aims to provide valuable insights into the strategies and performance of Flipkart and Shopsy and shed light on their contribution to India's evolving e-commerce ecosystem. Through an in-depth review of these platforms, we aim to provide recommendations to improve their competitiveness and meet the changing needs of Indian culture .

FLIPKART STRATEGY

Flipkart's Strategy India's online retail sector is controlled by Flipkart thanks to a complex strategy: Customer Centricity: highlighting the customer experience with an extensive selection of products, safe ways to pay, and simple navigation. Logistics Network: Building an efficient delivery network and supply chain to ensure prompt and effective order fulfillment. Exclusive Partnerships: To gain a competitive edge, partner with brands on exclusive launches and deals. Aggressive discounts and offers: Utilizing price parity and advertising campaigns to draw clients. Financial Services: To increase client involvement and loyalty, the company is branching out into domains like electronic payments and credit.



‘Naye India ke saath’

Hyper local Focus: Offering focused product offers and language support to cater for different Indian markets. Technology Investment: Providing specific suggestions and increasing operational efficiency via the application of AI and data analytics.

Working of Flipkart

How Flipkart Works Flipkart operates an online shopping site that connects sellers and buyers. Products are provided by sellers for buyers to look at and purchase. Flipkart receives requests, processes them, and delivers them on to the seller. The seller then uses Flipkart's logistics department or other courier services to ship the item to the buyer. After deducting its commission, Flipkart allocates the funds to the vendor after obtaining payment from the customer upon delivery. Support is also offered via the site for tracking orders, returns, refunds, and other questions. A broad range of goods, efficient transportation, a user-friendly interface, an affordable prices, various methods of payment, and excellent support for customers are all essential components in Flipkart's success.

BENEFITS OF SELLING IN SHOPSY

- 1.You pay the lowest cost for all Shopsy special fields and Flipkart verticals mentioned in the cost range of Rs 151–600.
- 2.No documentation or trademark registration mandatory.
- 3.No expert photography required. Sellers can take pictures using their smart phones and upload them.

**STRATEGY OF SHOPSY**

Study to understand your market. Identify your target audience. Understand who you're selling to and their tastes .Evaluate competition. Investigate successful sellers on Shopsy and other social shopping sites to learn from their strategies. Maximise your product offerings. High-quality images: Use clear, high-quality images from different points of view .Detailed Descriptions: Provide detailed and exciting product descriptions that highlight major features

and benefits. Relevant keywords: Use relevant terms to increase search exposure. Price Strategy Competitive Pricing: Set pricing that are competitive while preserving a healthy margin .Provide attractive offers and reductions that attract more buyers. Use social media. Promote on Social Platforms: Use Instagram, Facebook, and WhatsApp to showcase your Shopsy store and products. Influencer Collaboration: Work with influencers to reach a larger audience.

Customer involvement and engagement. Timely Communication: Respond quickly to client concerns and thoughts .To keep buyers, implement loyalty schemes or recommendation networks. Follow and assess performance. Sales Data: Examine your sales information regularly to figure out what products operate the very least .Customer suggestions: Pay close focus on consumer feedback and reviews so that they may make any changes that are required. Establish efficient transport .Reliable Shipping: Ensure that things deliver on time and consistency .Easy Returns: Provide a clear and easy refund policy .By focusing on these factors, you may develop an effective Shopsy approach.

ADVANTAGES AND DISADVANTAGES OF SHOPSY

Shopsy acts as a marketplace, connecting local sellers and producers with personal distributors, who are mostly women and families. Meesho allows licensees to advertise and market products through social media platforms such as Instagram, WhatsApp, and Twitter by offering an extensive decision of products in areas such as beauty, fashion, home, and kitchen at reachable costs. The business model of the business is based on commissions obtained each transaction, with suppliers receiving platform charges that ranges from 10% to 25%, based on the product category. Shopsy, on the other hand, is a social commerce platform that enables anyone on social media platforms to become a reseller of products showed on an online marketplace and earn a fee on every purchase. Vendors may list goods on Shopsy for sharing with friends. Can list their products on Shopsy as well as share them with friends and family using social networking sites such as WhatsApp and Facebook. Shopsy initially assessed a fee on each sale made through the platform, but as of the month of August 2021, Flipkart adopted a zero-commission schedule to attract more merchants. This method plans to widen online trading in India through enabling resellers to earn cash without any upfront decisions.

FLIPKART VS SHOPSY

Both Flipkart and Shopsy are e-commerce sites, though they cater to different market segments. Flipkart is a renowned online store with a wide range of goods across various groups, including groceries, clothing, and electronic devices. It focuses a focus on competitive pricing, an effective practical network, and extensive customer service. On the contrary, Shopsy is a more recent platform focusing on social commerce. Through social media connections, it enables individuals and companies to sell goods directly to customers. The primary benefits of Shopsy are its emphasis on social sharing, limited seller fees, and an easy onboarding process. While its product variety is expanding, it might not be as broad and thorough as Flipkart's. Flipkart is essentially an established traditional e-commerce behemoth, while Shopsy is an upcoming entrant to social commerce that takes an unusual approach to online.

REFERENCE FROM ARTICLES

1.Flipkart Shopsy: an Deep Investigation Flipkart realized the potential of online shopping and established Shopsy as a particular platform in this a forum. Shopsy offers a user-friendly interface, an extensive product catalogue dragged directly from Flipkart, and an effective reseller program. Shopsy has the following key features: Shopsy allows consumers to easily share product links and suggestions with their social networks. Focus on affordability: Shopsy prioritizes based on value products that speak specifically for the price-conscious Indian market. Shopsy is integrated with Flipkart's logistics and infrastructure, permitting efficient shipping and fulfilment through the company's existing practical network. Flipkart's strategy reason for establishing Shopsy is clear: to get into the fast-increasing online shopping market, reach fresh customer segments in Tier 2 and 3 cities, and take advantage of its current strengths to dominate.

2.Shopsy offered over 16 crore products with free delivery and it witnessed 43% of new users being first-time shoppers on the platform. Bengaluru: Throughout the fifth edition of Grand Shopsy Mela, its annual sale, that was held from June 11 to 16, Shopsy, a hyper-value online shopping site from Flipkart, experienced a 50% sprint in daily demand and a 43 per cent rise in new customers, the business mentioned on Wednesday.

In excess of 16 crore things were accessible to purchase, with free and pay on delivery alternatives.

"We are overwhelmed that our greatest selling event, the Grand Shopsy Mela, continues to be

an enormous hit. The CEO of Shopsy's enterprise, Prathyusha Agarwal, declared, "We will continue to develop and adjust to changing customer tastes through market research, while ensuring that our development path remains healthy." The retailer has more than 1.4 million sellers on the platform, including Shopsy sellers. Many sellers experienced a two to three-times surge in growth during the sale, with sellers from cities like Rajkot, Ghaziabad, Panipat, and Jaipur being top beneficiaries. – **Economic times**

3. Sellers on Flipkart facing issue in changing price, firm denies any intervention in pricing
Some sellers on Flipkart have lodged a complaint about issues facing trouble in variation of price in their products from succeeding May 18 the e-commerce company initiated a new commission rate card. The Walmart group firm, however, denied any role in affecting the pricing on the platform and said that it is working with sellers to help them gain knowledge about the new rate card policy. Several hundred of our customers are experiencing difficulties altering the price of their own goods. The maximum selling price (MRP) is the highest price that can be purchased in India, and suppliers are allowed to set their own costs. After Flipkart published the revised cost of the card on May 18, sellers showed discontent regarding their failure to alter their prices. Not every person suffers from the same issue. In the words of Vinod Kumar, Trustee, Forum for Online suppliers, Traders and Resellers (First India), just a small percentage of vendors are having this problem. – **Economic times**

CONCLUSION

Shopsy vs Flipkart

Shopsy and Flipkart serve different e-commerce markets. The renowned marketplace Flipkart offers outstanding logistics, an extensive range of goods, and reasonable costs. The customer experience is given importance, and there are multiple methods to pay and quick delivery. Shopsy, on the other hand, is a platform for social commerce that lets users sell products on social media. In contrast to Flipkart, it may have a smaller assortment of goods and less simple onboarding, yet it has less seller expenses. In the end, a user's feelings will dictate what Flipkart and Shopsy they prefer—Flipkart is more suitable for a broader range of products and it is mostly used by the higher class people while Shopsy is more inviting for customers who want to purchase products under budget and is mostly used by the lower and middle class customers. Also, it creates a social purchasing positive atmosphere. Hence the plan of the Flipkart is working as planned and receiving numerous profits as expected.

Feature	Flipkart	Shopsy
User Reviews	Generally higher	May vary
Logistics and delivery	More established network	May rely on external courier
Product selection	Wider variety	More focused

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**A STUDY ON BRAND POSITIONING AND CONSUMER PERCEPTION
TOWARDS MAMAEARTH PRODUCTS**

DR S.MUTHULEKSHMI, Assistant Professor, Department of commerce, Kumaraguru College of Liberal Arts and Science, Coimbatore.

SHIKHA.S, II Year B.Com., Kumaraguru College of Liberal Arts and Science, Coimbatore.

SHAMIKSHA.S.T, II Year B.Com., Kumaraguru College of Liberal Arts and Science, Coimbatore.

ABSTRACT

Mamaearth was founded in September 2016 by Ghazal Alagh and Varun Alagh holding its headquartered in Gurugram and focused in making skincare routines a little chic but with utmost care. Mamaearth is distinguished in the cosmetics industry of India as an online platform that offers natural and toxin-free skin care products. In a crowded skin care market Mamaearth's nourishing skin care line stands out of box by capitalising efficient and effective marketing strategies to revitalize with consumers. As consumers become highly concerned and conscious of their decisions in choosing a product, Mamaearth's natural skin care brand has become apparent leader in the market. This study ranges over the perspective of consumers loyalty towards the brand.

KEYWORDS: *branding, marketing strategies, consumer perception, eco-friendly Products.*

INTRODUCTION

In the recent decade, the cosmetics sector has seen a steady increase, as individuals become more concerned about their well-being with each passing day. The changing trend has also attracted several new participants to the market. This industry is congested, but a few companies have managed to get to the top and establish a reputation for themselves. One such prominent company is Mamaearth, a company that produces organic products made in a natural way with natural components that are devoid of toxins and other contaminants. Mamaearth has established itself as a viable cosmetics brand with the American Made Safe Certification, the first nontoxic mark for products currently in use. Despite initial skepticism, Mamaearth has successfully carved out a substantial market. The study examines Mamaearth's adaptation to the Indian market and its resurgence following regulatory challenges, offering valuable insights into how brands can penetrate and flourish in culturally distinct markets by influencing consumer preferences and behaviors. Extensive research facilitated the introduction of Mamaearth to tailor into Indian preferences. This astute move

enabled Mamaearth to secure a significant market share and establish itself as the most used skin care product.

OBJECTIVE

1. To know the Brand Positioning Strategies adopted by Mamaearth
2. To know the Consumer Perception towards Mamaearth

REVIEW OF LITERATURE

Ashwini V and Sreeramana Aithal in the article "**A Study on Performance Evolution of Indian Eco-friendly Cosmetic Brand: Mamaearth**" provides Mamaearth as a non-toxic personal care brand has kept its promises about goodness inside. It is a well-known brand with the mission of making the lives of mothers and pregnant moms look better and more attractive. The company's products are safe, toxin-free, and of standard quality for every parent and baby from head to toe. Mamaearth is a digital-first FMCG company with products available on D2C Platforms. In addition to creating safe green space through a high-quality plantation, the company creates jobs, develops infrastructure, conducts educational programs, and provides rural development programs to improve the standard of living in communities.

Trina Saha, Nirjhar Kumar, Fatema Jannat and Nazmoon Nahar (2021) in their research paper "**Influence of Social Media on Brand Positioning and Brand Equity**" provides Today social media is not just a tool of passing time, it is big marketing tool to speak directly with existing and potential customers. It helps to increase brand value with the engagement of a large number of audiences. This research is based on the relationship among social media, brand positioning and brand equity. The key factors of branding are brand awareness, brand loyalty, perceived quality, brand image, brand equity etc. The results of our study showed that there is positive relationship among social media and brand positioning and brand equity

Gupta, S. (2019) in their paper "**Social Media Strategies for Brand Positioning: Insights from Mamaearth.**" provides how Mamaearth, a consumer goods company, utilizes social media to position its brand in the market. This paper might include strategies, case studies, and analysis of social media campaigns that have been effective for Mamaearth. It could provide valuable insights for marketers looking to enhance their brand positioning through social media channels.

“A Study on Consumer Satisfaction Towards Mamaearth Products” by S. Johnsirani (2023): This paper examines consumer satisfaction with Mamaearth products, focusing on the brand's initial target market of mothers. The study discusses how Mamaearth leveraged word-of-mouth and social media influencer marketing to build trust and loyalty among its customers. It also analyzes the challenges the brand faced in expanding its market reach and how it refined its marketing strategies to better target its desired customer cohort.

STATEMENT OF THE PROBLEM

Even though Mamaearth has entrenched itself as the lead of the natural and sustainable skincare brands, it faces few problems. Differentiating itself from competitors in a crowded market, where natural and sustainable claims are becoming increasingly common. Addressing consumer skepticism and mistrust of skincare brand's environmental and social claims. Expanding product offerings to meet diverse customer needs while maintaining brand cohesion and focus. Leveraging digital channels to enhance customer activity and loyalty. Maintaining price competitiveness while ensuring fair labor practices and sustainable sourcing. By addressing these challenges, MamaEarth can continue to grow, innovate, and strengthen its position as a trusted leader in the natural and sustainable skincare market. Increasing brand awareness and reaching a wider audience beyond its existing customer base.

RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

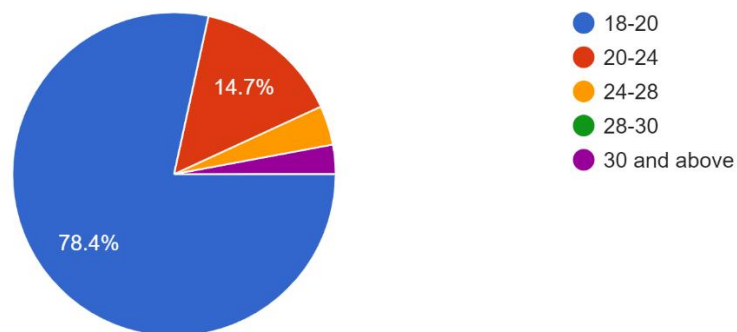
This study on brand positioning and consumer perception towards Mamaearth products involves a mixed-method approach, utilizing both primary and secondary data. Primary data is collected through a structured questionnaire targeting a sample size of 102 respondents selected using a random sampling method to ensure a diverse and representative sample of current and potential consumers. The questionnaire is designed to gather demographic information, consumer perceptions, purchasing behavior, and brand positioning insights. Secondary data is sourced from academic journals, industry publications, and relevant online resources to provide contextual background and support the primary data findings. This comprehensive approach aims to offer a nuanced understanding of consumer attitudes and the market position of Mamaearth products.

DATA ANALYSIS

This research involves quantitative methods, using statistical software to analyze primary data from 80 respondents. Descriptive statistics will summarize demographic information and general consumer perceptions. This data is used to validate and contextualize primary data findings. The results are interpreted to understand the impact of Mamaearth's brand positioning on consumer perception, providing insights into their effectiveness and areas for improvement.

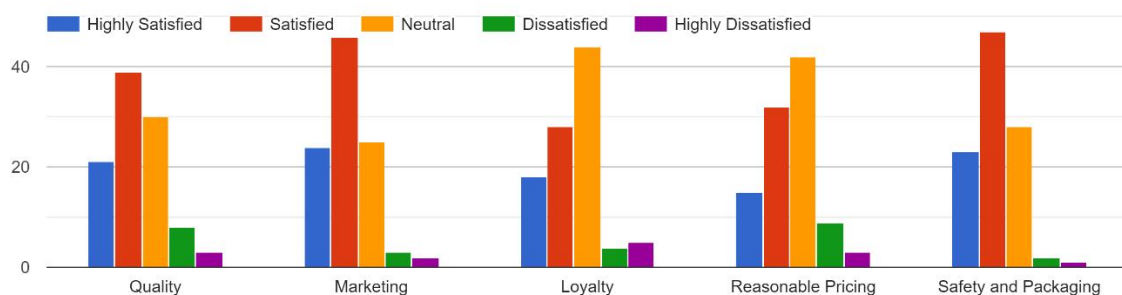
INTERPRETATION

Figure 1. Age of the respondents



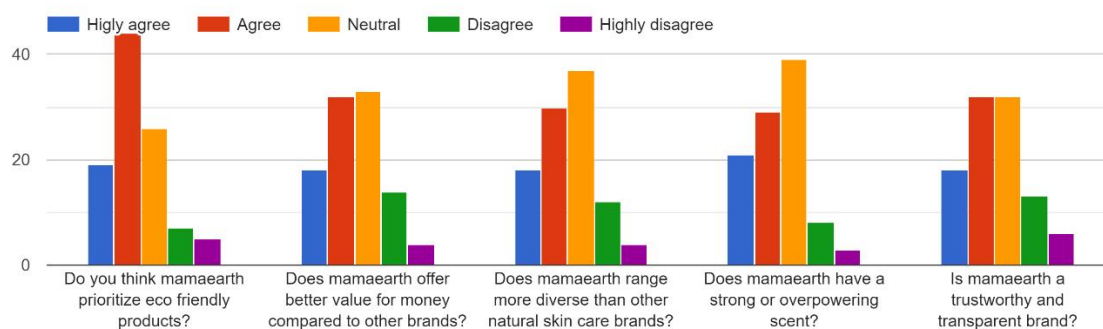
According to the survey most of the Mamaearth products are used by students aged 18 to 24. Students in this age group are often concerned about using products with natural and safe ingredients. Mamaearth is known for its natural and toxin-free products, which appeal to those looking to avoid harsh chemicals. College students often have limited budgets. Mamaearth provides effective products at reasonable prices, making them accessible for students.

Figure 2. Brand positioning strategies



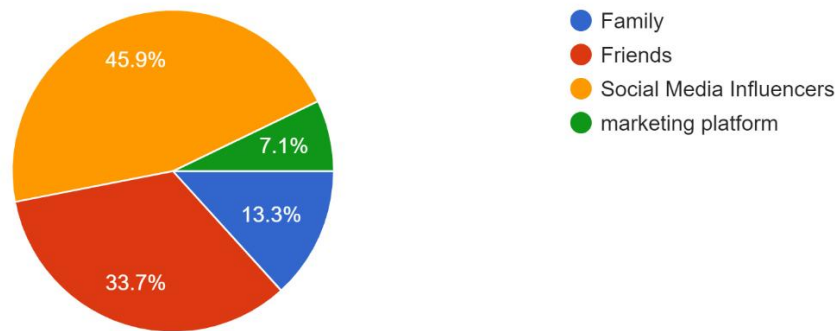
Out of 102 people surveyed, 46 expressed significant satisfaction with Mamaearth's marketing strategies and product quality. This indicates that nearly half of the respondents appreciate the brand's effective promotional methods, likely driven by engaging social media campaigns, influencer collaborations, and clear messaging about their natural and eco-friendly values. The high satisfaction with product quality suggests that the products meet or even exceed their expectations, which is crucial for customer retention and building brand loyalty. However, these same respondents have mixed or neutral comments regarding loyalty and pricing. They might feel that while the products are effective, they are somewhat expensive for regular use, or they don't perceive sufficient rewards for repeat purchases. Despite these reservations, the respondents are highly satisfied with the safety and packaging of Mamaearth products. They appreciate the brand's commitment to secure and environmentally friendly packaging solutions, which resonates with their values and enhances their overall positive perception of the brand. This combination of factors reflects a generally favourable view of Mamaearth, tempered by specific concerns about pricing and loyalty incentives.

Figure 3. Consumer perception



Most of the individuals prefer Mamaearth for their eco-friendly products. This means nearly half of the respondents (44 individuals) choose Mamaearth over other brands. This preference highlights the growing consumer demand for sustainable and environmentally conscious products. It's commitment to using natural ingredients and eco-friendly packaging resonates strongly with many consumers, making it a popular choice in the market. However, they have neutral comments on the pricing, the diverse range of products compared to other skincare brands, and the strong or overpowering scent. Additionally, there are mixed comments regarding the transparency of the brand.

Figure 4. Influence on the product purchase



According to the survey half of the students purchased Mamaeearth products based on the brand's presence and promotions on social media platforms. This suggests that its strategic use of social media marketing is highly effective. The visually appealing posts, informative videos, and interactive campaigns likely play a significant role in creating awareness and driving purchase decisions among this demographic. In addition to social media influence, a significant portion of the customers were influenced by recommendations from family and friends. This indicates the importance of word-of-mouth marketing for Mamaeearth. Personal endorsements from trusted sources such as friends and family members often carry more weight than traditional advertising, as they are perceived as more genuine and reliable. Social media helps in creating initial interest and engagement, while personal recommendations from family and friends help in converting interest into actual purchases. Together, these factors contribute significantly to the brand's customer acquisition and retention strategies.

FINDINGS

Mamaearth enjoys a strong brand positioning and positive consumer perception, particularly for its marketing efforts and commitment to eco-friendly products. Consumers are highly satisfied with the brand's marketing strategies, which have effectively communicated the company's values and product benefits. The quality of Mamaearth's products also receives favorable reviews, reinforcing trust and loyalty among users.

The eco-friendly nature of Mamaearth's products is a significant factor in its appeal, with many consumers appreciating the brand's sustainable practices. However, opinions on pricing strategies are mixed, indicating some ambivalence about the cost relative to value. Additionally, there are varied reactions to the scent of the products, with some finding it strong or overpowering. Despite these mixed emotions, the overall consumer perception of Mamaearth remains positive, especially regarding its marketing, quality, and eco-friendly initiatives.

SUGGESTIONS

1. To enhance Mamaearth's market position, the company should improve customer loyalty with rewards programs, keep prices competitive by lowering production costs, and ensure consistent quality with strong quality checks.
2. To boost its market position, Mamaearth should introduce innovative products like vegan and cruelty-free options and invest in sustainable and appealing packaging.
3. Collaborating with influencers and eco-friendly organizations can increase brand visibility and credibility. Launching educational campaigns about the benefits of natural products will reinforce its eco-friendly commitment.
4. Expanding into new markets, improving customer service, and developing robust loyalty programs will enhance consumer engagement.
5. Publishing regular sustainability reports can transparently communicate the company's environmental efforts, building trust and loyalty among consumers.

CONCLUSION

Mamaearth has successfully entrenched itself in the Indian market by prioritizing affordability, and convenience, preference making it a regular usage product among diverse consumer groups. They have positioned themselves as a key player in the natural and toxin-free personal care market. Through a focused commitment to safe, effective, and environmentally friendly products, the brand has garnered a loyal customer base and carved out a distinct niche. The increasing competition in the natural personal care sector necessitates continuous innovation and differentiation. The digital landscape offers vast opportunities for growth. Optimizing e-commerce platforms and enhancing digital presence will allow Mamaearth to tap into the growing segment of online shoppers and improve overall customer engagement. By enhancing transparency about product ingredients, sourcing, and manufacturing processes, and by providing exceptional customer experiences, Mamaearth can build stronger, long-term relationships with its customers. Sustainability and ethical practices are at the core of Mamaearth's brand promise. By maintaining and effectively communicating these values, the brand can resonate deeply with the environmentally conscious consumer segment and differentiate itself from competitors. By focusing on innovation, consumer trust, digital engagement, and sustainability, Mamaearth can continue to thrive and lead the natural personal care industry. Mamaearth's innovative marketing strategies and adaptation to local tastes have fostered strong consumer loyalty.

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BRAND VOICE AND PERSONALITY IN THE CONTEMPORARY WORLD

Dr.Reshmi A Rajan, Associate Professor, Department of Commerce, Kumaraguru College of Liberal Arts and Science, Coimbatore.

VIBEESSHINI D, B.Com, Kumaraguru College of Liberal Arts And Science, Coimbatore.

ABSTRACT

In the contemporary marketplace, the importance of a well-defined brand voice and personality has never been more critical. This research explores the multifaceted dimensions of brand voice and personality, emphasizing its role in differentiating brands, fostering customer loyalty, and driving business success. The theoretical framework provides a historical perspective and key concepts essential for understanding brand communication. The focus is also placed on the humanization of brands, where defining personality traits and employing effective storytelling techniques create emotional connections with the audience. Furthermore, the research highlights the growing emphasis on values and purpose, illustrating how purpose-driven marketing and CSR resonate with modern consumers. The study also delves into the advanced tools and technologies, such as AI and social listening tools, that brands leverage to optimize their voice and stay relevant in an ever-evolving digital landscape.

Keywords: contemporary, brand voice, brand personality, values

INTRODUCTION

In the contemporary marketplace, the significance of a well-defined brand voice and personality is paramount. Brand voice is the distinct personality and style of communication used by a brand to convey its messages to its audience and brand personality is the set of human characteristics associated with a brand. A distinct and consistent brand voice not only helps in differentiating a brand but also plays a pivotal role in fostering customer loyalty and driving business success. As consumers are overwhelmed with countless brand messages across various platforms, establishing a distinct and consistent brand voice is essential for differentiation and fostering customer loyalty. This research explores the multifaceted dimensions of brand voice and personality, highlighting their roles in creating emotional connections, emphasizing values and purpose, and leveraging advanced technologies like AI. By examining theoretical frameworks and real-world applications, this study aims to provide

insights and practical recommendations for developing successful brand communication strategies in today's dynamic business environment.

OBJECTIVES

1. To assess the humanization strategies
2. To evaluate the emphasis on values and purposes
3. To analyse advanced tools and technologies

REVIEW OF LITERATURE

1. **Wu and Chen's** research on **"Building Brand's Value: Research on Brand Image, Personality and Identification"** explores the impact of brand image, personality, and consumer identification on brand value. They argue that a strong brand image and a well-defined brand personality are essential for creating positive consumer perceptions and fostering loyalty. The study highlights how brand identification, where consumers see the brand as a reflection of their own identity, deepens emotional connections. By integrating these elements, brands can enhance consumer engagement and build long-term value.
2. **Sikka and Kumar's** study on **"Understanding Indian Millennials' Awareness Towards Brand Personality of Apparel Brands"** investigates Indian millennials' awareness of apparel brands' personalities. Their research reveals that millennials place significant importance on brand personality, which influences their brand preferences and purchasing decisions. The study highlights that factors like authenticity, modernity, and relatability are crucial in shaping millennials' perceptions of apparel brands. It also points out that effective brand personality communication can enhance consumer loyalty and brand differentiation.
3. **Simmon's** article **"I-Branding: Developing the Internet as a Branding Tool"** provides a conceptual framework for internet-based branding strategies, derived from a critical review of branding literature. It identifies four main elements essential for effective online branding: traditional branding principles adapted for the digital environment, and three additional themes specific to online contexts. The study highlights the interconnectedness of these elements in brand management and offers practical guidance for marketing planners to systematically develop and implement

internet-based branding strategies, enhancing marketing communication and customer relationship-building.

PROBLEM STATEMENT

In the contemporary marketplace, defining a consistent, authentic brand voice and personality is crucial for differentiation, fostering loyalty, and driving success. This research examines the theoretical foundations, humanization strategies, values-driven marketing, and advanced technologies that shape effective brand communication today.

RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

This theoretical research employs a comprehensive literature review and analysis of existing studies, and conceptual frameworks to explore and synthesize the multifaceted dimensions of brand voice and personality in the contemporary marketplace.

THEORETICAL FRAMEWORK

There are various theoretical frameworks that support the study of brand voice and personality in the modern world and aid in understanding how brands interact and communicate with their target audiences. Disciplines like psychology, marketing, and communication theory are incorporated into these frameworks. By integrating these theories, it would provide a robust theoretical foundation for understanding the complexities of brand communication and offers practical insights for brand managers and marketers.

1. “Brand Identity Theory”, developed by Jean-Noël Kapferer, posits that a brand is a holistic identity that encompasses several elements: physical appearance, personality, culture, self-image, reflection, and relationship.
2. Jennifer “Aaker's Brand Personality Framework” identifies five dimensions of brand personality: sincerity, excitement, competence, sophistication, and ruggedness. Each dimension encompasses specific traits that can be attributed to a brand, helping marketers craft a consistent and relatable brand voice.
3. “Communication Accommodation Theory” (CAT), developed by Howard Giles, suggests that brands must adapt their communication to match the preferences and expectations of their audience, fostering more effective and engaging interactions.
4. “Social Identity Theory”, proposed by Henri Tajfel and John Turner, explores how individuals categorize themselves and others into groups. Brands can leverage this

theory by creating a brand personality that aligns with the social identities of their target audience, fostering a sense of belonging and loyalty.

HUMANIZATION OF BRANDS

Giving brands human-like qualities, traits, and motions aims to establish a stronger emotional bond with customers. This process is known as "Humanization of Brands." In the modern world, humanization is essential to defining a brand's voice and personality because consumers are looking for more real and relatable interactions with brands. Identifying distinct personality traits that represent the essence of the brand is the first step in humanizing it; good storytelling is a potent tool for this. Companies that communicate with empathy and understanding are more likely to be seen as compassionate and customer focused. Consumers are more interested in authenticity and transparency than ever in the digital age. Humanized brands communicate in an honest and transparent manner, owning up to their errors. Customers value brands that are sincere and direct, so transparency helps to establish credibility and trust. Humour is a potent humanization tool that increases a brand's likeability and approachability. Companies that use humour in their marketing leaves a lasting and favourable impression. Hence humanisation of brands play a vital role in voice and personality of a brand.

EMPHASIS ON VALUES AND PURPOSE

Today's consumers are increasingly looking for brands that align with their own values and beliefs. They want to support companies that have a positive impact on society and the environment. Brand differentiation creates a unique identity and helps a brand to stand out. The brands that clearly communicate their values and purpose often fosters trust, loyalty and build stronger relationships with their audience. A genuine commitment to values and purpose enhances a brand's credibility and stimulates an authentic connection with its audience.

TOOLS AND TECHNOLOGIES

Insights into consumer trends and competitor analysis are provided by brand management platforms and social media monitoring tools. These tools also provide audience engagement, content scheduling, and performance analytics across social media channels. The monitoring tools facilitate the comprehension of public opinion and brand engagement. The automation tools and AI creates copy for a range of marketing materials, maintaining the consistency of

the brand voice across media. AI-driven chatbots can interact with clients in a manner that embodies the brand's essence, offering tailored answers while upholding a unified voice. A full – featured CRM platform includes tools for customer service, sales, and marketing. This would enable the business to monitor and evaluate customer interactions, gain insights from the consumers and guarantee a consistent brand experience by connecting with the target audience.

MAJOR OBSERVATIONS OF THE STUDY

1. Focusing on values and purpose can turn a brand into more than just a business; it can become a meaningful part of consumer's lives.
2. Leveraging the tools and technologies available can streamline the process of maintaining a strong, consistent brand voice and personality, allowing the brand to effectively connect and engage with the audience.

RECOMMENDATION OF THE STUDY

1. Brands should identify and articulate specific personality traits that reflect their core values and mission. This clarity will guide all communication efforts, ensuring a consistent and authentic brand voice across all platforms.
2. Focus on creating communications that evoke positive emotions such as joy, empathy, and trust. Emotional connections enhance brand loyalty and make the brand more memorable to consumers.
3. Regularly assess how the brand voice and personality are perceived by the audience. Be open to feedback and willing to make adjustments to stay relevant and engaging in an ever-evolving market.

CONCLUSION

For businesses to succeed, stand out from the competition, and win over customers, voice and personality consistency are essential. Using theoretical frameworks such as Brand Identity, Brand Personality Framework, and Humanizing brands through storytelling and emotional connections improves relatability and builds trust. It is crucial to match brand voice with core values. In a crowded market, having a strong, recognizable brand voice and personality ensures long-term success, strengthens customer relationships, and increases loyalty.

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EXPLORING THE SUSTAINABLE AND VIABILITY OF ARECA PLATES AS AN ECO-FRIENDLY ALTERNATIVE TO DISPOSABLE TABLEWARE

- **Dr. K. Deepa**, Assistant Professor, Kumaraguru College of Liberal Arts and Science, Coimbatore.
- **R. Praanesh**, B. Com PA, Kumaraguru College of Liberal Arts and Science, Coimbatore.
- **C. P. Ashwin**, B. Com PA, Kumaraguru College of Liberal Arts and Science, Coimbatore.

ABSTRACT

This study explores the sustainability and viability of Areca plates as an eco-friendly alternative to traditional disposable tableware by analyzing secondary data. The research aims to evaluate the ecological benefits of Areca plates, focusing on their biodegradability, carbon footprint, and resource efficiency, in comparison to conventional disposable options like plastic and Styrofoam. Additionally, the study investigates the economic feasibility of Areca plates by reviewing their production costs, pricing, and distribution logistics. Consumer acceptance and market potential are also examined, assessing trends in eco-conscious behavior, willingness to adopt sustainable alternatives, and overall market demand. The findings from this research contribute to understanding the practical and sustainable applications of Areca plates in promoting environmental responsibility within the disposable tableware industry.

Keywords: Areca Plants, Eco- friendly disposable tableware, Biodegradable alternatives.

INTRODUCTION

The increasing awareness of environmental degradation caused by single-use plastic and Styrofoam products has heightened the need for eco-friendly alternatives in the disposable tableware industry. Among these alternatives, Areca plates, made from naturally fallen palm leaves, have gained attention for their biodegradability and minimal environmental impact. As they are produced without chemicals or synthetic materials, Areca plates present a potential solution to reducing plastic waste and carbon emissions, aligning with global sustainability goals.

However, for Areca plates to be widely adopted, it is essential to assess their economic feasibility and consumer acceptance. This study aims to evaluate both the ecological benefits and the market viability of Areca plates as an alternative to conventional disposable tableware. By analyzing secondary data, the research seeks to understand whether Areca

plates can serve as a practical, cost-effective solution that meets consumer demand for sustainable products while promoting environmental responsibility.

OBJECTIVES OF THE STUDY

1. To Evaluate the ecological benefits of Areca Plates in comparison to traditional disposable tableware
2. To investigate the economic feasibility, consumer acceptance and market potential of Areca Plates as an eco-friendly alternative to conventional disposable tableware.

STATEMENT OF THE PROBLEM

The increasing environmental concerns associated with traditional disposable tableware, such as plastic and Styrofoam, have led to a growing demand for sustainable alternatives. Despite the availability of eco-friendly options like Areca plates, there is limited understanding of their true ecological benefits, economic feasibility, and market potential. This study seeks to address this gap by evaluating the sustainability of Areca plates in comparison to conventional disposable tableware, and by investigating the factors influencing consumer acceptance and the broader viability of Areca plates as a practical alternative in the global market for disposable tableware.

THE ECOLOGICAL BENEFITS OF ARECA PLATES IN COMPARISON TO TRADITIONAL DISPOSABLE TABLEWARE

In recent years, the ecological impact of disposable tableware has become a pressing global issue, particularly with the widespread use of plastic and Styrofoam products. These materials, known for their durability and low production costs, have dominated the market but are also responsible for severe environmental damage. Plastics, which take hundreds of years to decompose, contribute significantly to landfills and ocean pollution, while Styrofoam, derived from petroleum, releases harmful chemicals during production and disposal. These issues underscore the need for biodegradable alternatives like Areca plates, which are gaining attention for their sustainability.

Areca plates, made from the naturally fallen leaves of the Areca palm, offer several ecological benefits. Unlike plastic and Styrofoam, which are manufactured using non-renewable resources and toxic chemicals, Areca plates are entirely natural and biodegradable, decomposing within 60 to 90 days without releasing harmful substances. This makes them an

ideal option for reducing landfill waste and pollution. In addition, the production process of Areca plates is energy-efficient, relying on minimal water and no synthetic chemicals, which further reduces their carbon footprint. Contemporary environmental concerns, such as the push for reducing plastic waste and adopting circular economy practices, highlight the growing relevance of Areca plates as a sustainable alternative to traditional disposable tableware. Their use also aligns with global initiatives, such as the United Nations Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs), which call for responsible consumption and production practices.

However, despite their ecological advantages, Areca plates face challenges in large-scale adoption due to higher production costs and limited consumer awareness. Thus, while their environmental benefits are clear, addressing these economic and awareness barriers is crucial for their broader adoption in the marketplace.

THE ECONOMIC FEASIBILITY OF ARECA PLATES

The economic feasibility of Areca Plates as an eco-friendly alternative to conventional disposable tableware depends on several factors.

1. Raw Material Cost

Areca plates are made from naturally fallen Areca palm leaves, a renewable resource. These leaves are abundantly available in regions with Areca palm cultivation, especially in South India and Southeast Asia.

Cost Advantage: As the leaves are a by-product of Areca nut farming, their cost is relatively low. However, collection, transportation, and processing costs may vary based on the region.

2. Manufacturing Process

The process involves cleaning, drying, and compressing the leaves into various plate shapes using heat and pressure.

Machinery Costs: Initial investments in machinery for processing and pressing leaves can be significant. However, small-scale producers may operate with less advanced equipment, reducing upfront costs.

Labor Costs: In regions with affordable labor, this becomes a cost-efficient process. Manual labor or semi-automated setups are common, and economies of scale can reduce per-unit costs as production increases.

3. Market Demand

Growing awareness of environmental concerns and bans on plastic in many countries have led to a surge in demand for biodegradable alternatives.

Competitive Pricing: Areca plates are priced higher than plastic alternatives but comparable to other eco-friendly options like bamboo or paper plates. As eco-friendly products gain popularity, consumers may be willing to pay a premium.

4. Logistics and Distribution

Shipping and handling costs can impact the overall price, especially for international markets. Areca plates are lightweight but can be bulky, leading to higher transportation costs.

Local production and sales can minimize these costs and make them more competitive compared to importing alternatives.

5. Environmental Incentives

Governments may offer incentives or subsidies for eco-friendly businesses, reducing the overall cost of production.

Tax Benefits and Grants: Some regions offer tax exemptions or grants for companies producing biodegradable products, which can improve the economic feasibility.

6. Competition

Areca plates compete with other eco-friendly alternatives such as paper, bamboo, and compostable plastic plates. The competitive advantage of Areca plates lies in their aesthetic appeal (natural, earthy look), sturdiness, and complete biodegradability.

Differentiation: Branding and emphasizing the uniqueness of Areca plates (e.g., chemical-free production, natural texture) can justify higher prices and create a niche market.

7. Scalability and Economies of Scale

Small-scale producers may face higher per-unit costs, but as production scales up, costs can be reduced significantly.

Market Expansion: Targeting restaurants, catering services, and environmentally-conscious consumers can enhance scalability and make the business more viable in the long term.

8. Sustainability and Long-Term Viability

With increasing restrictions on plastic use and consumer preference for sustainable options, the long-term outlook for Areca plates is promising.

Recycling and Composting: Areca plates are fully compostable and do not require industrial composting facilities, which is a significant advantage over some alternatives.

THE CONSUMER ACCEPTANCE OF ARECA PLATES AS AN ECO-FRIENDLY ALTERNATIVE

The consumer acceptance of Areca Plates as an eco-friendly alternative to conventional disposable tableware is influenced by various factors, including environmental awareness, price, functionality, and aesthetic appeal.

1. Environmental Awareness

Growing Concern for Sustainability: With increasing awareness about environmental issues like plastic pollution, many consumers are actively seeking eco-friendly alternatives to conventional disposable tableware. Areca plates, being biodegradable and compostable, appeal to consumers who prioritize sustainability.

Support for Plastic Bans: Many regions have implemented bans on single-use plastics, prompting consumers to look for alternatives. Areca plates align with this trend, as they are made from natural materials and do not contribute to landfill waste.

Marketing Impact: Brands and businesses that emphasize eco-conscious messaging can drive consumer interest. When marketed as a green, natural, and renewable option, Areca plates can enjoy higher acceptance.

2. Functionality and Performance

Durability: Consumers appreciate that Areca plates are sturdy and durable compared to paper plates or some other eco-friendly alternatives. They are leak-proof, heat-resistant, and can hold both hot and cold food without becoming soggy, making them a practical choice for events, picnics, and takeout services.

Biodegradability: The ability to dispose of Areca plates easily by composting at home or in nature increases their appeal, especially for eco-conscious consumers. Unlike some biodegradable plastics, they decompose quickly without requiring industrial facilities.

Versatility: The various shapes and sizes in which Areca plates are available allow for a wide range of uses—from casual picnics to upscale events—further enhancing consumer acceptance.

3. Aesthetic Appeal

Natural Look and Feel: The rustic, natural appearance of Areca plates is often seen as visually appealing. They provide an organic, earthy aesthetic that resonates with consumers who value environmentally friendly products or prefer a natural dining experience.

Event Settings: For weddings, outdoor events, and eco-themed parties, Areca plates are often chosen not just for their functionality but for their attractive, unique look that distinguishes them from conventional disposables.

4. Price Sensitivity

Higher Cost Compared to Plastic: Areca plates are generally more expensive than conventional plastic disposable tableware. For price-sensitive consumers, this may be a barrier to widespread acceptance, especially in lower-income segments or markets where cost is a primary factor.

Premium Segment: Consumers who are willing to pay more for sustainable, eco-friendly products are more likely to accept Areca plates. As awareness grows and economies of scale are achieved, prices may decrease, making them more accessible to a broader audience.

5. Health and Safety

Chemical-Free Production: Areca plates are free from chemicals, additives, or coatings, which appeals to consumers concerned about food safety and chemical leaching, often associated with plastic or coated disposable plates.

Safe for Food Use: Their natural composition ensures no harmful substances are released into the food, which is a significant factor for health-conscious consumers.

6. Cultural and Regional Preferences

Regional Acceptance: In areas where Areca palms are abundant, such as South India and Southeast Asia, Areca plates are already well-accepted. In these regions, the plates are often used in traditional or cultural settings, contributing to higher consumer acceptance.

Global Markets: As the plates gain traction in international markets, cultural exposure and consumer education will play a crucial role in driving acceptance. Positive feedback from early adopters and sustainable brands can help increase global demand.

7. Influence of Green Certifications

Eco-Labels and Certifications: Products with recognized eco-labels or certifications (such as compostability certifications) tend to be more readily accepted by consumers. Areca plates can leverage such certifications to build trust and highlight their environmental benefits, thus boosting consumer confidence.

8. Availability and Convenience

Ease of Access: For widespread consumer acceptance, Areca plates need to be easily available in retail stores, online, and through catering supply chains. If Areca plates become more accessible, especially in larger chain stores or sustainable product lines, acceptance will naturally increase.

Adoption by Businesses: Restaurants, caterers, and cafes adopting Areca plates for takeout or dine-in services can familiarize consumers with the product, further promoting its acceptance. Increased usage in the foodservice industry could make consumers more likely to adopt them for personal use.

9. Consumer Trends and Preferences

Influence of Trends: The rising trend of eco-conscious lifestyles, minimalism, and sustainable living supports the acceptance of Areca plates. Consumers who follow environmental trends, or those who are part of eco-conscious communities, are more likely to embrace such alternatives.

MARKET POTENTIAL OF ARECA PLATES AS AN ECO-FRIENDLY ALTERNATIVE TO CONVENTIONAL DISPOSABLE TABLEWARE

The market potential for Areca plates as a sustainable alternative to traditional disposable tableware is growing, driven by increasing environmental awareness and government regulations aimed at reducing plastic waste. As consumers become more eco-conscious, there is a significant shift towards green products, including biodegradable and compostable tableware. Areca plates, made from naturally fallen palm leaves, align with this shift, offering a guilt-free alternative to conventional plastic and Styrofoam options. According to market trends, the global eco-friendly disposable tableware market is expected to grow substantially over the next decade, with a strong emphasis on biodegradable products like Areca plates.

Key growth drivers for Areca plates include increasing governmental support for banning single-use plastics in many regions and the rise of sustainable practices among businesses and consumers alike. Sectors like the food service industry, events management, and eco-conscious businesses have started incorporating Areca plates into their offerings due to their aesthetic appeal, durability, and biodegradability. Additionally, their unique selling proposition (USP) as a product that requires no additional trees to be cut down for production positions Areca plates as a highly marketable solution for environmentally responsible consumers. However, the market potential also depends on addressing cost challenges and enhancing consumer education on the benefits of adopting eco-friendly alternatives. With strategic marketing, increased awareness, and innovations in cost reduction, Areca plates could capture a significant portion of the global disposable tableware market.

FINDINGS

A majority of respondents are aware of the environmental impact of plastic waste and express a preference for eco-friendly alternatives. Areca plates are well-positioned to benefit from this heightened environmental consciousness. Consumers who are informed about sustainability tend to favor biodegradable products like Areca plates.

Respondents report satisfaction with the durability and heat resistance of Areca plates compared to conventional paper or plastic disposables. Consumers appreciate that Areca plates can hold hot and cold food without becoming soggy or leaking. Areca plates' sturdiness and performance under diverse food types make them a functional alternative for everyday use and special occasions.

The natural look and feel of Areca plates, with their earthy textures and shapes, are appreciated by consumers. Many respondents favor them for outdoor events, weddings, or eco-friendly gatherings due to their rustic and organic appearance. The visual and tactile appeal of Areca plates enhances consumer willingness to use them for occasions where presentation matters.

While consumers express a preference for eco-friendly tableware, a common concern is the higher cost of Areca plates compared to conventional disposable options like plastic or paper. Although there is a willingness to pay a premium for sustainable options, broader acceptance could be limited in price-sensitive markets unless costs come down.

Consumers appreciate that Areca plates are chemical-free and pose no risk of contamination or harmful leaching, unlike some plastic alternatives. Health-conscious consumers are particularly drawn to Areca plates for this reason. Areca plates' safety for food use is an important factor driving consumer trust and preference.

In regions with strict plastic bans or government incentives for sustainable products, there is significantly higher adoption of Areca plates. Regulatory measures play a crucial role in shifting consumer behavior toward eco-friendly alternatives. Areas with government policies that support biodegradable products see higher consumer acceptance of Areca plates.

Catering businesses, restaurants, and eco-conscious event planners show a high level of interest in Areca plates for both aesthetic and functional reasons. Consumers who are exposed to Areca plates in these settings are more likely to consider them for personal use. Professional sectors such as catering and hospitality are potential growth areas for Areca plates due to their eco-friendly and visual appeal.

In lower-income or cost-conscious segments, where price is a primary decision factor, Areca plates face challenges in acceptance. Many consumers opt for cheaper disposable alternatives despite environmental concerns. Affordability remains a key factor in consumer adoption, especially in markets where disposable tableware is used frequently.

Respondents who had been exposed to eco-friendly marketing or had prior knowledge of Areca plates were more likely to accept and recommend the product. However, many potential consumers remain unaware of Areca plates as an option. Increasing consumer education and awareness through targeted marketing campaigns can improve the visibility and acceptance of Areca plates.

In regions where Areca palm trees are abundant, such as South India, consumers are already familiar with Areca plates, leading to higher adoption rates. Conversely, in regions where the plates are less well-known, acceptance is slower. Cultural familiarity and availability play a significant role in consumer adoption, with higher acceptance in areas where Areca plates are locally sourced.

SUGGESTIONS

A detailed comparison between Areca plates and other eco-friendly alternatives (e.g., paper, bamboo, compostable plastic) would provide more insights into consumer preferences. This would help determine how Areca plates stack up in terms of price, durability, environmental impact, and aesthetic appeal.

By understanding the price point at which consumers are most likely to switch from conventional tableware, businesses can adjust pricing strategies to improve adoption.

Conduct a life cycle assessment (LCA) of Areca plates to quantify their environmental benefits compared to conventional disposables. This data can be useful in promoting the product's advantages to both consumers and regulatory bodies.

CONCLUSION

The study demonstrates that Areca plates have strong potential as an eco-friendly alternative to conventional disposable tableware, especially among environmentally conscious consumers. Their durability, natural aesthetic appeal, and biodegradability are major factors driving acceptance, particularly in event planning, hospitality, and catering sectors. However, higher costs and lack of widespread consumer awareness pose challenges to broader adoption, especially in price-sensitive markets.

To enhance consumer acceptance, manufacturers and marketers should focus on increasing consumer education about the benefits of Areca plates, leveraging government regulations like plastic bans, and finding ways to reduce production costs through economies of scale.

Furthermore, targeted marketing that emphasizes the health, safety, and environmental advantages of Areca plates will improve consumer trust and encourage more widespread use.

As the global shift toward sustainability continues and awareness of environmental concerns grows, Areca plates are well-positioned to become a popular, eco-friendly alternative in the disposable tableware market. With strategic pricing, increased accessibility, and enhanced marketing efforts, their adoption rate can significantly increase in both local and international markets.

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**“A STUDY ON AN EXAMINATION OF HOW MAGGI REPOSITIONED ITSELF
AFTER THE BAN”**

Dr. T. Usha Rani, Assistant Professor of Commerce, Kumaraguru College of Liberal Arts and Science, Coimbatore.

Jaganath G, B. Com PA, Kumaraguru College of Liberal Arts and Science, Coimbatore.

Midunarakavi S, B. Com PA, Kumaraguru College of Liberal Arts and Science, Coimbatore.

ABSTRACT

This research explores the strategic repositioning of Maggi noodles in India following the 2015 ban by the Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI) over safety concerns. The ban posed a significant challenge for Nestlé, Maggi's parent company. Through a mixed-methods approach, this study examines the various strategies Maggi employed to restore consumer trust and regain market share after the crisis. It includes a detailed analysis of Maggi's crisis management actions, such as public relations efforts, legal responses, and comprehensive safety revalidation. Additionally, it investigates the brand's innovative marketing tactics, like the 'We Miss You Too' campaign, which leveraged emotional branding to reconnect with its loyal customer base. The study also emphasises the role of digital media in Maggi's repositioning, highlighting how social media platforms were used to engage with consumers and spread positive messages about the product's safety and quality. The findings reveal that Maggi's successful comeback resulted from both strict adherence to regulatory standards and adaptive marketing strategies that effectively addressed consumer concerns. This case study offers valuable insights into brand resilience and the key elements of successful repositioning during a public relations crisis. Understanding Maggi's recovery process provides lessons for businesses on navigating regulatory challenges and the importance of transparent communication in rebuilding brand equity.

Keywords: Maggi, Repositioning, Ban of Maggi

INTRODUCTION

This research paper examines how Maggi, an iconic instant noodle brand by Nestlé, strategically re-positioned itself in the Indian market after a significant crisis in 2015, when it was banned due to allegations of excessive lead content and mislabel of mono-sodium glutamate (MSG). The study analyses the events leading to the ban, Nestlé's crisis

management responses, and the measures taken to restore consumer confidence and market presence. By exploring Maggi's marketing communications, consumer engagement, and brand-rebuilding initiatives, this paper provides insights into the resilience and adaptability of brands facing major challenges. The findings contribute to understanding crisis management and brand repositioning, offering lessons and best practices for marketers, brand managers, and industry stakeholders in navigating similar situations.

In 1882, during a meeting of the Swiss Common Good Society (Gemeinnützigen Gesellschaft), Dr. Fridolin Schuler, a physician and factory inspector, addressed the poor nutritional state of factory workers. He noted that female workers, having insufficient time to cook for their families, often resorted to cold meals or alcohol instead of nutritious warm meals. Factory canteens offered inexpensive food, but it lacked proper nutrition. This led to issues like malnutrition, stomach diseases, and high infant mortality rates. Schuler recommended diets rich in high-protein, easily digestible pulses and legumes and called for the availability of such meals in a quick-to-prepare and affordable form for the working class. Consequently, the society sought the involvement of companies like Maggi. Maggi's journey in India began in the early 1980s when Nestlé introduced Maggi noodles to the Indian market in 1983. At that time, instant noodles were relatively unknown in India, and Nestlé aimed to offer a quick, convenient, and affordable meal solution to the increasingly urban population.

Maggi's initial marketing strategy highlighted its convenience, appealing to working mothers and schoolchildren. The slogan "Fast to Cook, Good to Eat" underscored the product's easy and rapid preparation, aligning well with the busy lives of Indian consumers. The introduction of the masala flavour, tailored to the Indian taste with its unique spice blend, significantly contributed to Maggi's acceptance and popularity.

Over the years, Maggi became a beloved brand in India, expanding its product range to include various Flavors and types, such as Maggi Atta Noodles and Maggi Oats Noodles, to meet the changing preferences and health-conscious trends of consumers. Maggi also diversified into other culinary products like soups, sauces, and seasonings. Despite facing challenges, notably the 2015 controversy over alleged high levels of lead in its noodles, Maggi managed to regain its market position through stringent quality control measures, adherence to safety standards, and effective communication with consumers. The brand's resilience and strong emotional connection with Indian consumers have cemented its status as a staple in Indian kitchens.

OBJECTIVES

- To explore Maggi's entry strategy in the Indian market.
- To analyse the pre- and post-effects of the Maggi ban in India.
- To analyse the repositioning strategies implemented by Maggi after the ban
- To assess the effectiveness of these strategies in rebuilding consumer trust and market share
- To provide insights and recommendations for other companies facing brand crises

REVIEW OF LITERATURE

Pallavi Rajain & Rupa Rathee (2019) Maggi is a globally recognized brand that needs little introduction, having been introduced to the Indian market by Nestle India in 1983. It quickly became one of the most influential brands in India. However, in 2015, the trust of many consumers was shaken when tests revealed that Maggi noodles contained levels of MSG (Monosodium Glutamate) and Lead beyond the prescribed limits. This led to a nationwide ban ordered by the Bombay High Court, resulting in the recall and destruction of all Maggi variants. The brand suffered a significant loss in value, estimated at Rs. 1300 crore. Maggi, a beloved staple for over three decades in India, faced a crisis. The case delves into the events surrounding the ban, detailing the timeline of discoveries and actions taken when it was found that Maggi noodles exceeded permissible levels of MSG and Lead. It also explores the strategies implemented to revive the brand post-ban, including leveraging emotional connections, television advertisements, and exclusive availability at select stores.

Gohardings (2023) The comeback of Maggi is a fantastic success story, and even after the catastrophe, Nestle was able to hold onto its market share and win back the trust of consumers. They succeeded in doing this by taking advantage of consumers' sentimental affinity to the brand. Even though Maggi was under a five-month restriction, it took advantage of the feeling. Nestle started making short films with the slogan "We miss you, Maggi" around a month before the ban ended. They aggressively marketed the videos on social media to arouse nostalgia in viewers. These commercials addressed worries about the safety of the product and were specifically directed towards mothers and young adults. The nostalgic memories that Maggi had brought to people's lives were portrayed in the marketing efforts, which struck a chord with the target population.

Navleen Kaur & Gurloveleen Kaur Children's most popular and favoured quick food product, Maggi Noodles, became mired in controversy over the ingredients' unethical

use. It was determined that consumer safety posed a risk, which led us to provide a thorough analysis complete with specific data and statistics. The causes of harmful posture and its consequences are the main topics of the study. Food regulatory agencies severely questioned Nestle India's corporate social responsibility in light of the test results. The problems mentioned above deteriorated the company's public relations. It forced us to pay closer attention to its crisis management plans and its state of repositioning.

STATEMENT OF PROBLEM

The problem addressed in this research study is to conduct a thorough literature review to understand existing research on how Maggie repositioned itself after its ban in the year 2015, due to the addition of ingredients like monosodium glutamate (MSG) in their products and the sales up lifted due to their effective marketing strategies.

STRATEGIES USED BY MAGGI TO ATTRACT INDIAN HOUSEHOLDS

Maggi has successfully attracted Indian households through a variety of strategies, making it a household staple:

1. **Localized Flavors and Products:** Maggi adapted its products to suit Indian tastes, introducing flavours like masala that align with local preferences. They also offered healthier options like Maggi Atta Noodles and Maggi Oats Noodles to appeal to health-conscious consumers.
2. **Emphasis on Convenience:** The brand highlighted the ease and speed of preparation with its "2-minute noodles," making it an attractive option for busy families and working individuals. The slogan "Fast to Cook, Good to Eat" emphasized this convenience, resonating with those who have limited time for meal preparation.
3. **Targeted Marketing Campaigns:** Maggi's marketing efforts focused on different segments of the population, such as working mothers, children, and young adults. The advertisements depicted relatable everyday situations, creating an emotional connection with consumers. The use of popular celebrities and influencers in endorsements further increased the brand's appeal.
4. **Engagement with Children:** Understanding the influence of children on household purchases, Maggi designed fun and engaging campaigns aimed at younger audiences. Promotions, contests, and activities related to Maggi products helped build a loyal customer base from a young age.

5. **Innovative Product Variants:** Maggi kept the brand exciting by regularly introducing new flavours and limited-edition variants. This approach maintained consumer interest and encouraged repeat purchases.
6. **Widespread Availability:** Maggi ensured its products were easily accessible across India, from urban supermarkets to small rural shops. This extensive distribution network made it convenient for consumers to purchase Maggi products regardless of their location.
7. **Community Engagement and Trust Building:** Following the 2015 controversy regarding alleged high levels of lead, Maggi took swift action to address concerns, conducted rigorous quality checks, and communicated transparently with consumers. These efforts helped rebuild trust and loyalty among Indian households.
8. **Cultural Integration:** Maggi integrated itself into Indian culture by becoming a part of everyday meals and special occasions. The popularity of recipes incorporating Maggi noodles further embedded the brand in the culinary habits of Indian households.

Through these strategies, Maggi has not only attracted but also retained a significant presence in Indian households, becoming synonymous with quick and tasty meals.

BAN OF MAGGI

In 2015, India's Food Safety and Standards Authority (FSSAI) banned Maggi noodles over concerns about high levels of lead and monosodium glutamate (MSG) found in the product. This decision followed reports from various states indicating that Maggi did not meet safety standards. Nestlé India complied by recalling the product across the country, but faced legal battles as they disputed the results.

After extensive testing and legal proceedings, the Bombay High Court lifted the ban in August 2015, allowing Maggi noodles to return to the market. This episode highlighted the critical need for rigorous food safety regulations and transparency, leading to greater consumer awareness and more stringent oversight in the food sector.

REPOSITIONING OF MAGGIE AFTER THE BAN

In 2015, India's Food Safety and Standards Authority (FSSAI) banned Maggi noodles over concerns about high levels of lead and monosodium glutamate (MSG) found in the product. This decision followed reports from various states indicating that Maggi did not

meet safety standards. Nestlé India complied by recalling the product across the country, but faced legal battles as they disputed the results.

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SALES OF MAGGIE BEFORE AND AFTER ITS BAN

Sure, here's an updated tabular representation of Maggi's sales before the 2015 ban, during the ban, and its recovery up to 2024:

Period	Sales (INR Crores)	Market Share	Notes
2014	2,500	70%	Dominant market leader
Q1 2015	600	70%	Consistent high sales
June 2015	0	0%	Nationwide ban imposed due to safety concerns
Post-Ban 2015	0	0%	Sales halted, product recall in progress
Q1 2016	250	30%	Gradual reintroduction after clearance by regulators
Q3 2016	1000	50%	Recovery with aggressive marketing and trust rebuilding
2017	2000	60%	Near pre-ban sales levels, regaining market share
2018	2200	65%	Continued growth with new product variants and marketing strategies
2019	2300	67%	Strengthening market presence and expanding product range
2020	2400	68%	Stable growth despite COVID-19 pandemic challenges, increased home consumption
2021	2500	70%	Fully regained market position, strong brand loyalty
2022	2600	72%	Introduction of new Flavors and health-oriented products
2023	2700	73%	Continued market dominance, innovative marketing campaigns
2024	2800	74%	Sustained growth, focus on sustainability and health-conscious consumer trends

This table provides an overview of Maggi's sales trajectory from before the ban in 2015 through its recovery and growth up to 2024. The figures are approximate and based on general trends reported in various sources.

FINDINGS

Based on the analysis of Maggi's repositioning efforts, the findings of this study indicate several key strategies that contributed to the company's success. Maggi focused on rebuilding trust through transparency, engaging with consumers, and improving product quality through stringent quality control measures. The company also leveraged digital marketing and social media platforms to disseminate positive brand messages and engage with its target audience effectively. These efforts resulted in a gradual recovery of consumer trust and a subsequent increase in market share.

SUGGESTIONS

Drawing from the findings, this research article suggests several recommendations for companies facing similar crises in the future. These include transparent communication, proactive engagement with consumers, implementation of strict quality control measures, leveraging digital platforms for brand promotion, and continuous monitoring of the repositioning process. By following these recommendations, companies can increase their chances of successfully repositioning themselves post-crisis.

CONCLUSION

Maggi's rebound after the ban is a prime example of effective crisis management and brand resilience. By implementing rigorous quality assurance measures and maintaining transparent communication, Maggi successfully restored consumer trust. Strategic marketing initiatives, including celebrity endorsements and direct consumer engagement, played a crucial role in revitalizing the brand's image.

Introducing healthier product options highlighted Maggi's responsiveness to evolving consumer preferences. The restructuring of their supply chain and the establishment of strategic partnerships ensured a seamless market re-entry and reinforced their presence on store shelves.

Market research and sales data revealed improved consumer perception and a steady recovery in market share, indicating a successful strategic repositioning rather than simply returning to pre-ban conditions.

Maggi's experience underscores the significance of transparent crisis management, strategic marketing, and continuous innovation. The lessons from their journey provide a valuable blueprint for managing brand crises, emphasising the need for resilience and adaptability in the ever-changing food industry.

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THE IMPACT OF BRAND CONSISTENCY ACROSS PHYSICAL AND DIGITAL CUSTOMER TOUCHPOINTS

Dr. N. Manicka Mahesh, Professor, Department of Commerce, Kumaraguru College of Liberal Arts and Sciences, Coimbatore.

Santhosh MM, III B. COM PA, Department of Commerce, Kumaraguru College of Liberal Arts and Sciences, Coimbatore.

Lokshika S, III B. COM PA, Department of Commerce, Kumaraguru College of Liberal Arts and Sciences, Coimbatore.

ABSTRACT

In today's omnichannel landscape, customers interact with brands across a multitude of touchpoints, both physical and digital. This research delves into the critical role of brand consistency in crafting a seamless and impactful customer journey. The core question researchers explore is this: how does maintaining consistent brand messaging, visuals, and values across all touchpoints influence customer loyalty and trust? This study employs a discrete yet insightful approach, examining the effectiveness of brand communication strategies. This research investigates the role of technology in bridging the gap between physical and digital experiences. Understanding the challenges faced by brands in achieving consistency will be crucial. A competitive analysis will shed light on how successful brands are harmonizing their touchpoints. The ultimate objective of this research is to illuminate the path towards stronger brand-customer relationships. The aim of this research is to develop methods for measuring brand loyalty and trust directly linked to consistency efforts. Identifying disparities between intended brand messaging and the customer experience across various touchpoints is paramount. By understanding consumer preferences for brand interactions, companies can tailor their approach for maximum impact. Finally, pinpointing the implementation challenges associated with maintaining consistency will equip brands with actionable strategies for overcoming these hurdles. This research promises valuable insights for brands seeking to build enduring customer loyalty in a competitive digital age. By orchestrating a symphony of consistent touchpoints, brands can cultivate trust, enhance brand perception, and ultimately drive business success.

KEYWORDS

Brand Consistency, Customer Touchpoints, Customer Loyalty, Digital Customer Experience

INTRODUCTION

Customers today encounter brands through a dynamic mix of physical stores and digital channels. This ever-expanding web of touchpoints necessitates **brand consistency**, where a brand presents a unified voice and experience across all interactions. This chapter introduces the core question driving this research: how does brand consistency across touchpoints influence customer loyalty and trust in the digital age? We explore the effectiveness of brand

communication, the role of technology, challenges faced by brands, and competitive landscapes. Ultimately, this study aims to illuminate the path to stronger brand-customer relationships by measuring loyalty and trust tied to consistency, identifying touchpoint disparities, understanding consumer preferences, and pinpointing implementation hurdles. This research empowers brands to build enduring customer loyalty in a competitive digital age.

OBJECTIVE OF STUDY

1. To measure the general Brand Loyalty and Trust among consumers.
2. To identify impact of Touchpoint Disparities and Consumer Preferences on brand loyalty.
3. To identify the Challenges on the Implementation of brand loyalty on physical vs digital touch points.

REVIEW OF LITERATURE

Aisha Muthaffar and et.al., (2024) in this paper “From Digital Touchpoints to Digital Journeys: How Shopping Mindsets Influence Appraisal of Omnichannel Journeys” examines the impact of consumer shopping mindsets on the evaluation of omnichannel experiences. Through three experiments and a survey, the study finds that consumers with a maximiser mindset perceive the quality of their omnichannel journey more positively than those with a satisfice mindset. This relationship is mediated by consumers’ self-efficacy evaluations and moderated by the quality of the omnichannel configuration. The research provides valuable insights for retailers aiming to optimize digital omnichannel interactions and engage digitally savvy consumers effectively.

Sahara H and et.al., (2022) in the article “Digital Touchpoints Effectiveness and its Impact on Consumer Brand Engagement in Biotechnology Start-Up" The paper explores the effectiveness of digital touchpoints and their impact on consumer brand engagement specifically within the biotechnology start-up sector. The literature review within the article extensively discusses the role of digital touchpoints in shaping consumer perceptions and engagement, highlighting the importance of a cohesive digital strategy in enhancing brand value and loyalty. It draws from a range of studies to underscore the significance of

consistent and meaningful interactions across various digital platforms, and how these interactions contribute to a stronger brand-consumer relationship.

STATEMENT OF PROBLEM

In today's digital age, effective brand communication is no longer confined to a single message or channel. This research delves into the "effectiveness of crafting consistent brand narratives" across all touchpoints, from social media interactions to in-store experiences. Researchers will examine how a unified brand voice, messaging, and visual identity can resonate with customers and foster stronger brand recognition.

Technology plays a pivotal role in bridging the gap between physical and digital brand experiences. This research will investigate how advancements in areas like marketing automation and data analytics can be leveraged to ensure "consistency across all platforms." This research will explore how technology can personalize communication for individual customers while maintaining a cohesive brand identity.

Achieving brand consistency presents a unique set of challenges for businesses. This research will identify the key hurdles faced by brands, such as siloed internal departments, fragmented marketing strategies, and the sheer volume of touchpoints to manage. Understanding these challenges will be crucial in developing actionable strategies for overcoming them.

Competitive analysis is essential for understanding how successful brands are harmonizing their touchpoints. This research will examine the strategies employed by industry leaders in maintaining brand consistency. By analyzing their successes and potential shortcomings, valuable insights that can be applied to various brand contexts can be gleaned.

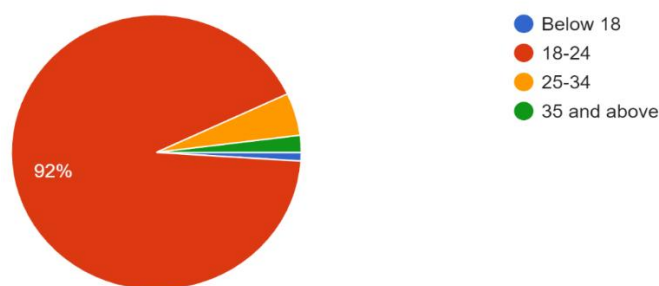
RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

This study employs quantitative research design using a structured questionnaire to investigate the impact of brand consistency across physical and digital customer touchpoints. The population comprises students in the class, with the entire class invited to participate using convenience sampling. Data will be collected through an online questionnaire distributed via a survey platform, with responses gathered over a specified period and reminders sent to maximize participation. The questionnaire includes demographic questions, Likert scale questions, and multiple-choice questions related to brand consistency. Data will be analyzed using descriptive statistics and cross-tabulation, with statistical software SPSS is

employed to generate visual representations. Ethical considerations include informed consent, ensuring participant anonymity and confidentiality, and adherence to institutional ethical guidelines. The study acknowledges limitations such as sampling and response bias, which may affect generalizability and accuracy. Expected outcomes include insights into students' perceptions of brand consistency, the impact on brand loyalty and trust, and identification of challenges brands face in maintaining consistency, providing valuable data for understanding and improving brand communication strategies.

RESULTS AND DISSCUSION

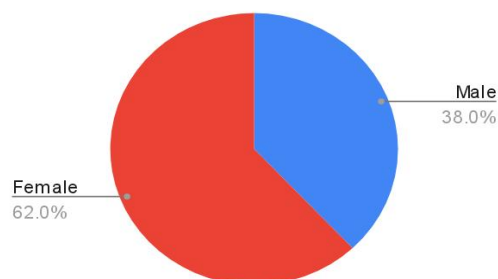
1. Age



Source: Primary Data

The age distribution of survey respondents, with a clear majority (92 percent) falling within the 18-24 age group. This demographic represents the most significant portion of the sample, suggesting a potential focus on the preferences and perceptions of younger consumers in the study on brand consistency across physical and digital touchpoints.

2. Gender

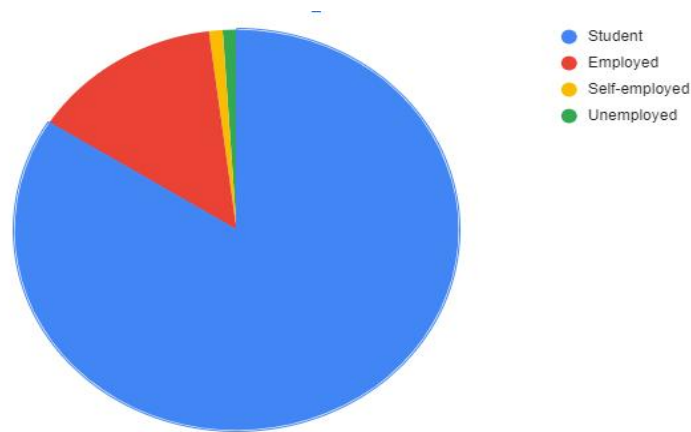


Source: Primary Data

The gender distribution among 100 respondents. It reveals a predominantly female representation, with women constituting 62 percent of the sample, while men comprise 38

percent. A small percentage of 10 percent chose not to show their gender. This gender imbalance suggests a potential focus on female perspectives in the study on brand consistency across physical and digital touchpoints.

3. Occupation



Source: Primary Data

The occupational distribution of the 100 survey respondents. The majority of participants, constituting 84 percent, are students, indicating a significant focus on the student demographic in the research on brand consistency across physical and digital touchpoints. The remaining 14 percent are divided among employed, self-employed, unemployed, and retired individuals. This occupational bias suggests a potential emphasis on the perspectives and experiences of students in the study.

4. Interaction of brand under different platforms

Particulars	Mean Value	Rank
Social Media (e.g., Facebook, Instagram, Twitter)	4.42	1
Brand Website	3.40	4
Mobile Apps	4.06	2
Email Newsletters	2.51	6
Physical Stores	4.03	3
Customer Service (phone or in-person)	2.60	5

Source: Calculated Data

The table clearly depicts that social media is the platform which helps the customer to interact with brands since it has the highest mean value of 4.42 and has been ranked as first, the second rank has been allocated for mobile apps since this element has the mean value of 4.06 and the third rank is for the element named physical stores which has got the mean value of 4.03. The platforms where the

customers interact least is brand website, customer service (phone or in-person) and email newsletter which had the mean values of 3.40, 2.60 and 2.51, respectively.

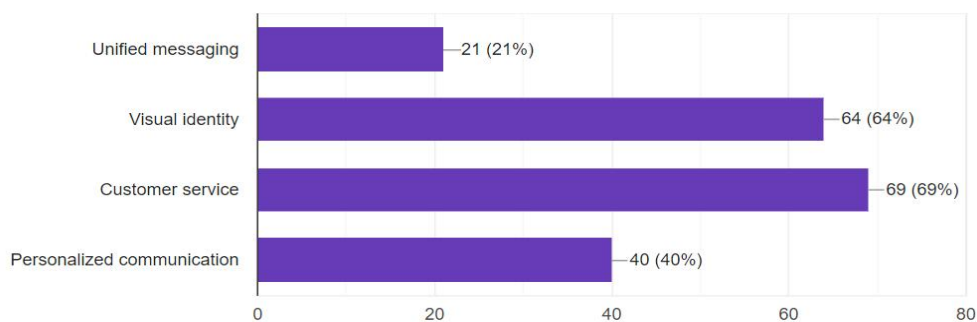
5. Online and offline presence of brands affects the perception.

Particulars	Value	DF	Asymp-sig
Age	155.420	2	0.000
Brand inconsistencies in its online and offline presence that affects the consumer perception of that brand	62.120	5	0.000

Source: Calculated Data

The chi-square value of 62.120 with 5 degrees of freedom and a p-value of 0.000 indicates a highly statistically significant relationship between the perception of brand inconsistencies and the factor under study when analyzed with these degrees of freedom. Since the p-value (0.000) is less than 0.05, we reject the null hypothesis, suggesting that there is a significant relationship between age and the perception of brand inconsistencies.

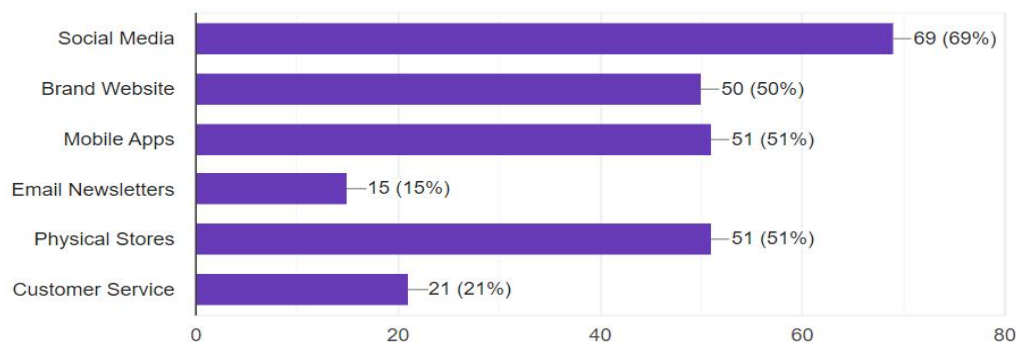
6. Focus areas to improve the consistency across touchpoints.



Source: Primary Data

The perceived areas where brands should focus to improve consistency across touchpoints, as rated by 100 respondents. Customer service appears as the top-rated area, with 69 percent of respondents highlighting its importance. Visual identity follows closely with 64 percent, emphasizing the significance of keeping a consistent visual appearance. Personalized communication and unified messaging garnered 40 percent and 21 percent respectively, showing a need for improvement in these areas. These findings suggest that brands should prioritize enhancing customer service and visual identity to strengthen overall brand consistency. Additionally, efforts should be made to improve personalized communication and unified messaging to create a more cohesive brand experience across touchpoints.

7. Platforms for engaging with brands.



Source: Primary Data

The preferred platforms for engaging with brands, as selected by 100 respondents. Social media emerges as the most popular platform, with 69 percent of respondents indicating their preference. Brand websites and mobile apps share the second spot with 50 percent and 51 percent respectively, highlighting the importance of digital channels. Email newsletters and customer service receive lower preference, with 15 percent and 21 percent, respectively. Physical stores garner a moderate preference of 51 percent. These findings suggest a strong inclination towards digital platforms for brand engagement, with social media taking the lead. Brands should focus on optimizing their social media presence and enhancing their website and mobile app experiences to effectively connect with their audience.

8. Likely to remain loyal to the brand.

Particulars	Value	DF	Asymp.sig
Gender	5.760	1	0.013
How likely are you to remain loyal to a brand that maintains a consistent identity across all its touchpoints?	6.200	4	0.815

Source: calculated data

The chi-square value of 5.760 with 1 degree of freedom and a p-value of 0.013 indicates a statistically significant relationship between gender and the likelihood of remaining loyal to a brand that maintains a consistent identity across all its touchpoints. Since the p-value (0.013) is less than the commonly used significance level of 0.05, we reject the null hypothesis. This suggests that gender significantly influences the likelihood of remaining loyal to a brand when it maintains consistency across its touchpoints.

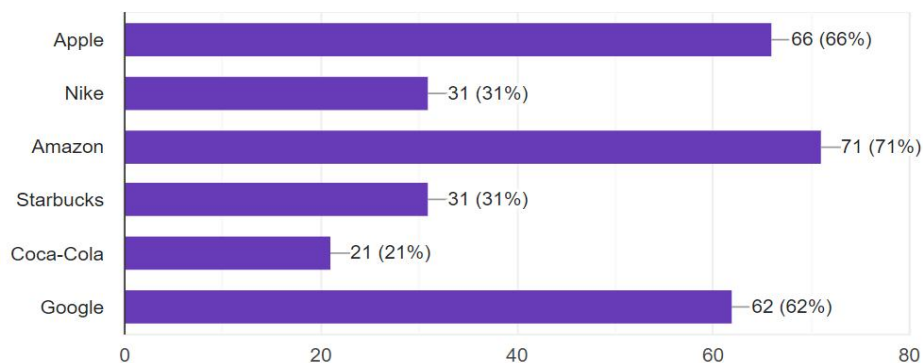
9. Challenges faced while maintaining consistency across different touchpoints.

Particulars	Mean Value	Rank
Siloed departments (Complexity in department)	2.85	5
Fragmented marketing strategies	2.96	4
Volume of touchpoints to manage	3.17	1
Technological limitations	2.98	3
Language and culture nuances	3.06	2

Source: calculated data

The table clearly depicts that volume of touchpoints to manage is the major challenge faced in maintaining consistency across different touchpoints since it has the highest mean value of 3.17 and has been ranked as first, the second rank has been allocated for language and cultural nuances since this element has the mean value of 3.06 and the third rank is for the element named technological limitations which has got the mean value of 2.98. The challenges that the customers think least for maintaining consistency across different touchpoints are fragmented marketing strategies and siloed departments which had the mean values of 2.96 and 2.85, respectively.

10. Brands that maintain consistency across different touchpoints



Source: Primary Data

The perceived brand consistency across various touchpoints, as rated by 100 respondents. Apple emerges as the top-rated brand, with 66 percent of respondents believing it excels in maintaining consistency. Google and Amazon follow closely with 62 percent and 71 percent, respectively. Nike and Starbucks share the same perception level at 31 percent, while Coca-Cola trails with 21 percent. This data indicates a strong perception of consistency for Apple, Google, and Amazon, suggesting effective brand management strategies across different touchpoints.

11. Consistency of the below elements in the brand

Particulars	Mean Value	Rank
Visual identity (e.g., logo, colors)	4.06	1
Messaging and tone of voice	3.29	5
Customer service experience	3.29	5
Product quality and packaging	3.59	2
Online experience (website, mobile app)	3.42	3
Offline experience (physical stores)	3.37	4

Source: calculated data

The table clearly depicts visual identity have the highest consistency in the brand since it has the highest mean value of 4.06 and has been ranked as first, the second rank has been allocated for product quality and packaging since this element has the mean value of 3.59 and the third rank is for the element named online experience (website, mobile app) which has got the mean value of 3.42. The consistency that the customers think least for the brand are offline experience (physical store), messaging and tone of voice and customer service experience which had the mean values of 3.37, 3.29 and 3.29, respectively.

12. Importance of maintaining consistency of brand across their touchpoints

Particulars	Values	DF	Asymp.sig
Age	155.420	2	0.000
How important is it for you that the brands you interact with maintain consistency across their touchpoints?	45.900	4	0.000

Source: calculated data

The chi-square value of 155.420 with 2 degrees of freedom and a p-value of 0.000 indicates a highly statistically significant relationship between age and the importance placed on brands maintaining consistency across their touchpoints. Since the p-value (0.000) is less than the commonly used significance level of 0.05, we reject the null hypothesis. This suggests that age significantly influences how important individuals find brand consistency across touchpoints.

13. Recommendation of brand to others

Particulars	Values	DF	Asymp.sig
Age	155.420	2	0.000
How likely are you to recommend a brand to others if you find their touchpoints consistent?	40.500	4	0.000

Source: calculated data

The chi-square value of 155.420 with 2 degrees of freedom and a p-value of 0.000 indicates a highly statistically significant relationship between age and the likelihood of recommending a brand to others based on consistent touchpoints. Since the p-value (0.000) is much less than 0.05, we reject the null

hypothesis. This indicates that age significantly influences the likelihood of recommending a brand when its touchpoints are consistent.

FINDINGS

Visual identity, including elements such as logo and colors, had the highest consistency with a mean value of 4.06. product quality and packaging ranked second with a mean value of 3.59 . Online experience, encompassing websites and mobile apps, had a mean value of 3.42, placing it third . A significant relationship exists between age and the importance placed on brand consistency across touchpoints (Chi-square value of 155.420, p-value 0.000) . Age also significantly influences the likelihood of recommending a brand if its touchpoints are consistent (Chi-square value of 155.420, p-value 0.000). These are the top areas where brands should focus to improve consistency across touchpoints, with 69 percent and 64 percent of respondents respectively highlighting their importance . Social media emerged as the most popular platform for brand engagement, with 69 percent of respondents indicating their preference.

SUGGESTIONS

Prioritize improving customer service as it is highlighted as a crucial area for maintaining brand consistency.

Focus on keeping a consistent visual appearance across all touchpoints.

Given the preference for social media and digital platforms, brands should optimize their social media presence and enhance their website and mobile app experiences.

Efforts should be made to improve personalized communication and unified messaging to create a cohesive brand experience.

Invest in technology that supports the seamless integration of various touchpoints to overcome technological challenges .

CONCLUSION

The study concludes that maintaining brand consistency across physical and digital touchpoints significantly influences customer loyalty and trust. Brands that effectively manage consistency in their visual identity, customer service, and online experiences tend to have higher customer engagement and are more likely to be recommended by their customers. Age and gender are significant factors influencing perceptions of brand consistency and loyalty. Brands should prioritize improving their customer service, visual identity, and digital platforms to strengthen overall brand consistency and build enduring customer relationships in the competitive digital age.

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